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Happening today

● **IRAN'S FOREIGN** Minister Abbas Araghchi will visit China. This comes ahead of Chinese President Xi Jinping's meeting with US President Donald Trump on September 24.

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RBI files caveat in High Court over Tata Sons listing issue

George Mathew
Mumbai, September 15

THE RESERVE Bank of India (RBI) has filed a caveat petition in the Bombay High Court in connection with the mandatory listing of Tata Sons, seeking to ensure that the central bank is heard before the court passes any order if a petition is filed in the matter.

The caveat appears to be a pre-emptive move by the RBI to ensure that the court considers its explanation and position regarding its decision to reject Tata Sons' plea to deregister as a Core Investment Company, a move that requires Tata Sons to list on the stock exchanges.

A person aware of the development said the RBI may have expected Tata Sons to pursue legal recourse against its decision.

The RBI did not respond to an email from *The Indian Express* for a response.

On September 11, the RBI rejected the application of Tata Sons, seeking to remain an unregistered core investment company. Instead, the central bank directed the company to "ensure full compliance with all guidelines/instructions," effectively requiring Tata Sons to undertake an initial public offering (IPO) and list its shares on the stock exchanges.

The listing of Tata Sons has been one of the key issues dividing the trustees of Tata Trusts which collectively hold about 66 per cent of the company through various entities.

The RBI's decision comes at a critical juncture for the Tata Group which is searching for a new chairman to replace N Chandrasekaran. With the board not unanimous on his

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

In shadow of student deaths, stark reminder: DU hostel projects are stalled, crawling

Only 1 of 24 Executive Council meetings in V-C Yogesh Singh's tenure discussed student housing, show records; it takes time, he says

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 15

IN MAY 2022, seven months after he took charge as Vice Chancellor of Delhi University, Prof Yogesh Singh told a press conference that two 1,000-bed hostels — one each for men and women in postgraduate classes — would come up at the university's Dhaka complex near North Campus within two years.

More than four years later, excavation is nearly all that has taken place at the site for one of these two projects. Work at the

THE BIG PICTURE

ONCE THERE WERE 5 STUDENTS [PAGE 15](#)

THE CITY [PAGE 3](#)
DELHI TO GET HOSTELS FOR 10,000 STUDENTS

site began only in April this year, a project official said.

On September 7, the day

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

EXPRESS special

● THE PROJECTS, THEIR STATUS

- **PROJECT:** Girls hostel/studio apartment complex, Dhaka Complex (1,050 seats)
Cost: ₹233.35 cr **Status:** HEFA loan sanctioned; work yet to start
- **PROJECT:** Nirbhaya residential accommodation, Dhaka Complex (1,000 seats)
Cost: ₹272 cr **Status:** Work held up; funds not yet disbursed
- **PROJECT:** Executive hostel/guest house at South Campus
Cost: ₹20.05 cr **Status:** Project yet to take off; funds awaiting to be released from University Development Fund
- **PROJECT:** New hostel building at South Campus
Cost: ₹22.81 cr **Status:** Documen-



PROJECT: HOSTEL CUM RESIDENTIAL BLOCK, DHAKA COMPLEX (1045 SEATS; LATER AUGMENTED TO -1456 SEATS)
COST: ₹318 CR; **STATUS:** BASEMENT WORK ON

tation work on, as per DU engineering dept

● **PROJECT:** Vertical extension of existing boys' hostels at Saramati and Aravali

● **Status:** CPWD conveyed project could not be implemented; long-

term plan to expand Saramati still in pipeline

● **PROJECT:** Extension of existing girls' hostel Geetanjali (vertically & horizontally)

Cost: ₹11.23 cr **Status:** Layouts being finalised

In HC, Govt backs plea to let same-sex partner take medical call for the other

Sohini Ghosh
New Delhi, September 15

SUPPORTING A plea filed by a same-sex couple in the Delhi High Court, the Union Ministry of Health and Family Welfare has said that those in a "non-heterosexual/ queer relationship" cannot be excluded from the existing legal framework of nominating their partners to take medical decisions on their behalf, "merely on account of

sex, gender or sexual orientation".

The ministry filed its response on September 9, ahead of the next hearing on Thursday. On August 20, the HC had questioned the Centre for its failure to respond to the petition.

The petition, filed in July 2025 by a same-sex couple who got married in New Zealand in December 2023, said there is "no framework which grants or recognises the rights of non-hetero-

sexual couples to act as a medical representative of their respective partners during medical treatment/emergencies."

The ministry, in its response, has affirmed that courts as well as legislation, like the Mental Healthcare Act, 2017, have recognised that a medical representative "can be any person", and not necessarily a blood relative or a "spouse" only.

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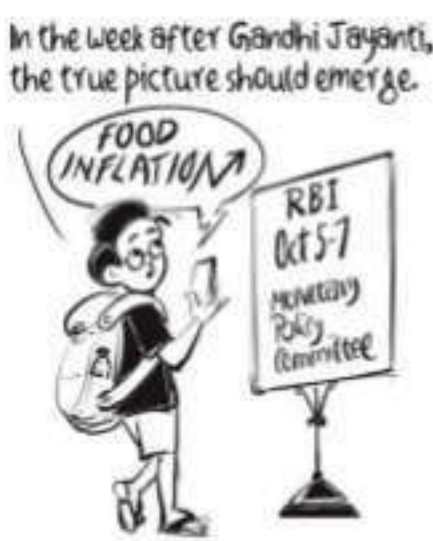


Pilot project

Congress leader Sachin Pilot with Charanjit Singh Channi and Amrinder Singh Raja Warring in Chandigarh, Tuesday. This was Pilot's first visit to poll-bound Punjab after being made Congress in-charge amid a feud between the two state unit leaders. [KAMLESHWAR SINGH P 6](#)

Business as Usual

By EP UNNY



SAUDI, HOUTHIS TRADE STRIKES AS CONFLICT GROWS P 14

Odisha rejects Staines killing convict Dara's plea for premature release

Sujit Bisoyi
Bhubaneswar, September 15

THE ODISHA government has rejected the plea of convict Rabindra Kumar Pal alias Dara Singh for premature release from jail. He is serving a life sentence for the 1999 killing of Australian missionary Graham Staines and his two minor sons who were burnt alive while sleeping in a vehicle in Mano-

harpur in Keonjhar district.

The State Sentence Review Board, which met on August 31, said it was "not inclined to recommend his (Dara Singh's) premature release at this stage".

On August 19, the Supreme Court had asked the Board to take a decision on his plea for premature release. On September 8, the bench of Justice Manoj Misra and Justice Vijay Bishnoi,

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

ED flags bankruptcy code frauds, 'disproportionate' haircuts as thrust areas

Deeptiman Tiwary
New Delhi, September 15

RED-FLAGGING frauds under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code (IBC), the Enforcement Directorate (ED) has identified "re-examination of collusive resolution cases involving disproportionately large haircuts through which promoters re-acquire assets" as a key thrust area.

This comes in the backdrop of the National Company Law Tribunal's (NCLT) August 25 order which allowed Essel Group founder Subhash Chandra to settle his personal insolvency proceedings by paying Rs 6.25 crore, against admitted claims of Rs 22,006.57 crore. On September 1, a five-member special bench of the NCLT stayed the settlement order.

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

● SEPTEMBER 22 MATCH PART OF CELEBRATIONS MARKING 75 YEARS OF BILATERAL TIES

Japan prepares ground for T20 with India, Sri Lanka pitches in, and sponsors line up

Venkata Krishna B & Shuvaditya Bose
Chennai, New Delhi, September 15

IN JANUARY this year, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar and his Japanese counterpart, Toshimitsu Motegi, exchanged cricketing gifts. Motegi's gift was the Japan cricket team's pink jersey, while Jaishankar handed him a bat autographed by Indian cricketers.

That proved to be a harbinger of sorts. The two countries are now set to play their first bilateral match at the Sano Inter-



The Sano International Cricket Ground, 100 km from Tokyo. [JCA](#)

national Cricket Ground, about 100 kilometres from Tokyo, on

September 22. Team India led by Shreyas Iyer will face the

Japan team captained by Kendel Kadowaki-Fleming in the T20 International.

The match is part of the celebrations to mark 75 years of diplomatic relations between the two countries. Following a meeting between Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Japanese Prime Minister Sanae Takaichi in July, the two sides had announced 2027 as the 'India-Japan Year of Shared Horizons' to mark the milestone.

"Suddenly, this wasn't just us wanting to attract a full member (of the International

»CONTINUED ON PAGE 2

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In a first, India starts exporting Hilsa to Bangladesh, most are from Gujarat

Ravik Bhattacharya
Kolkata, September 15

IN A role reversal of sorts, India is exporting Hilsa fish to Bangladesh, bucking the trend of the neighbour supplying the sought-after variety of fish that has the highest place of pride on Bengal's dining tables.

Around 500 tonnes of Hilsa, known as Ilish in Bengali, have been sent to Bangladesh over the past two months through the Petrapole land port on the international border in West Bengal. Traders expect an additional 150 to 200 tonnes of Hilsa to be exported to Bangladesh in the coming weeks.

Traditionally, Hilsa is brought in from Bangladesh when its government allows its import, generally during the Durga Puja festive season. Currently, Bangladesh has paused Hilsa exports to India.

"This is the first time Hilsa from our country is being exported to Bangladesh... Most of the catch is from Gujarat," said Syed Anwar Maqsood, secretary of the Fish Importers Association in Bengal and the Howrah wholesale fish market.

Speaking to *The Indian Express* from Petrapole, Kartik Chakraborty, secretary of Petrapole Clearing Agents Staff Welfare Association, said, "Earlier, we eagerly waited for Hilsa from the Padma river in Bangladesh. Later, its import was restricted. Now we are happy that fish from India is going to Bangladesh and people there like it."

A substantial portion of the Hilsa consignment is from Gujarat, particularly the Bharuch region, and some supplies have moved through the Howrah fish market in Bengal.

The traders said Hilsa with high roe content is attracting considerable demand in Chatogram, Sylhet and other districts of Bangladesh. Roe refers to fully ripe egg mass in female hilsa fish, also used to prepare delicacies. The roe is being processed for re-export from Bangladesh. "The fish exported has high roe content. The roe is extracted, packaged and then

re-exported, and the hilsa is salted, dried and sold in Bangladesh," said Maqsood.

"The export of Indian Hilsa to Bangladesh is not merely a trade phenomenon; it is a strong market signal reflecting exceptional consumer preference, economic value and regional demand for this iconic fish. It highlights Hilsa's potential as a high-value fishery resource capable of contributing to fishermen's livelihoods, food security, domestic consumption and regional trade. For West Bengal, this is an opportunity to develop a knowledge-driven, sustainable and value-added Hilsa economy through science-based stock enhancement, responsible fisheries management, post-harvest value addition and integrated market linkages," said Pradip Dey, director of Central Inland Fisheries Research Institute.

For West Bengal, which has a strong cultural association and an established fish marketing network centred around Kolkata and Howrah, the development presents ways to strengthen production, aggregation, cold-chain logistics, value addition, processing, branding and export-oriented fisheries enterprises.

Earlier, a team from the Fish Importers Association visited Dhaka in August and met Ataur Rehman Khan, the Commerce Secretary of Bangladesh, and urged him to lift the ban on the export of Hilsa to India.

"The Association also wrote letters to the Bangladesh Prime Minister and others for lifting the ban. Since July 2012, Hilsa imports from Bangladesh were restricted. In 2019, the government of Bangladesh started permitting imports only during Durga Puja festivities with a month's window. This does not work out," said Maqsood. "...But since the window is small, the imported quantity is very low. For instance, in September 2024, the quantity permitted was 2420 metric tonnes, but the actual import was 577 metric tonnes. In September 2025, 1,200 tonnes were permitted, but only 150 metric tonnes were imported".

Medical decisions

"Where a competent adult has nominated or otherwise authorised his/her partner to act on his/her behalf in the event of incapacity, there appears to be no medical or ethical rationale for excluding such person merely on account of sex, gender or sexual orientation of the partners, or because their union does not fall within the conventional understanding of marriage, subject always to applicable law and appropriate safeguards," it has said.

It has, however, maintained that the term "spouse", under Indian marriage laws, only applies to heterosexual couples, and relied on the Supreme Court's 2023 five-judge bench decision against legalising same-sex marriages.

The health ministry has said that the Ministry of Finance, in 2024, had also clarified that there was no restriction on same-sex couples on opening joint bank accounts, and the Department of Food and Public Distribution had also enabled them to be treated as members of the same household for the

purpose of ration cards.

"These measures demonstrate a consistent administrative recognition that relationships of care, dependence and mutual responsibility are not necessarily confined to formally recognised marital or blood relationships. In this backdrop, permitting a competent adult to nominate his/ her partner, including a partner in a non-heterosexual/ queer relationship, to take medical decisions on his/ her behalf in the event of incapacity would constitute a logical and tailored extension of the same principle, while respecting patient autonomy," the health ministry said.

Earlier, the Income Tax department had opposed pleas filed by same-sex couples in the Bombay and Karnataka High Courts, seeking to declare the term 'spouse' as defined in the Income Tax Act as unconstitutional, in relation to a provision that grants tax exemption on gifts exchanged between spouses. It had held that Indian marriage laws recognise only heterosexual couples as spouses.

SRIT board meeting, the trust cannot jointly nominate a representative with the Sir Dorabji Tata Trust. Such a joint nomination is required under the Articles of Association of Tata Sons to meet the quorum requirement for its annual general meeting (AGM).

The AGM of Tata Sons can be held only after the Sir Ratan Tata Trust, which holds a 23.56 per cent stake in Tata Sons, is able to obtain relief from the restraining order issued by the Maharashtra Charity Commissioner.

[FROM PAGE 1 | FULL REPORTS ON WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM] Student housing

after five students were killed in the building collapse in Satya Niketan, the Delhi High Court decreed the "absolutely inadequate number of hostels" in DU, which it said forced students to stay in "very dangerous" paying guest (PG) accommodation "causing threat to [their] life and security".

DU has been promising to address the shortage of student housing for years. But very little has moved during the tenure of Prof Singh, who became VC in October 2021. He begins a second five-year term next month.

The two hostels for men and women students promised by Singh in his 2022 press conference are stalled or crawling — so are at least four other housing projects for students announced during his tenure, records of the meetings of DU's Executive Council (EC) and Building Committee, project documents, and planning approvals show.

The minutes of just one of the 24 EC meetings held in Singh's tenure record a discussion on the student housing projects.

Mithuraj Dhusiya, who has been on the EC since February 2025, told *The Indian Express*: "Before the [Satya Niketan] incident, there had been no serious discussion on hostel facilities as part of the agenda. The key agenda items have mostly been related to AC (Academic Council) decisions, disciplinary matters, ICC (Internal Complaints Committee) issues, ad hoc teachers, fee matters, and the opening of new colleges."

Singh told *The Indian Express* on Monday that the requirement of clearances from multiple regulatory and administrative authorities had con-

tributed to the delays.

Some of these projects are stuck waiting for funds or approvals. Others are yet to start. Three of the projects are in the Dhaka complex, with a combined proposed capacity of more than 3,000 beds. Three other projects are in South Campus.

This is where each project stands.

DU'S DHAKA COMPLEX PROJECT: Hostel cum Residential Block

Location: Dhaka complex, close to Mukherjee Nagar
Capacity: 1,456 seats
Estimated cost: Rs 318 crore
Executing agency: NBCC (India) Ltd

Tender/ work awarded: September 2023

Scheduled completion: March 2025

STATUS: Construction began in April 2026; basement work underway. A top project official said that in a best-case scenario, completion is expected by 2028.

The project is being taken up under DU's Institution of Eminence program, funded mainly by the Union Ministry of Education. Officials said that the project had been delayed by 31 months even before construction began.

The work that was awarded in September 2023 with completion targeted for March 2025, saw bhoomi poojan only in September 2025 — six months after the deadline for completion had passed. Continuous on-ground work began in April 2026.

Officials attributed much of the delay to the need for clearances from agencies including the Delhi Fire Service, Delhi Urban Arts Commission, Na-

tional Highways Authority of India, Airports Authority of India, Delhi Jal Board, Delhi Metro Rail Corporation, the Environment and Forest Department, Delhi Development Authority, and Municipal Corporation of Delhi. A wholesale revision of the project's master plan layout was also required, a senior university official said.

On September 13, when The Indian Express visited the Dhaka complex site, workers were assembling the steel framework inside the foundation pit. The foundation slab had been cast and portions of retaining walls had been built.

A supervisor at the site said: "Once [the project management consultant] NBCC got the approvals, we began work in April this year." According to this official, if work continues uninterrupted, the facility can be delivered in "another 20 to 24 months".

However, a lot depends on curbs on construction that are expected after the air-pollution season begins in November, the official added.

A senior NBCC official said: "The project will take at least until 2028 for completion."

PROJECT: Girls' Hostel / Studio Apartment Complex

Location: Dhaka complex
Capacity: 1,050 seats
Estimated cost: Rs 233.35 crore

STATUS: The original proposal, to build accommodation for 700 women students belonging to the Economically Weaker Section (EWS), was approved by DU's Finance Committee in October 2021.

The Higher Education Financing Agency (HEFA) — a joint venture of the Ministry of Education and Canara Bank established to channel market-

scriptions, among others.

The revised MDR framework comes a day after the government notified that banks and service providers can't impose any charges on UPI payments of under Rs 2,000 and those made by RuPay debit cards.

Industry players have been repeatedly calling for the return of the MDR on UPI to help them meet their infrastructure and transaction settlement costs of around Rs 20,000 crore per year. While lower than 1-3 per cent charge that merchants must pay on debit and credit card payments, the 0.4 per cent fee on UPI payments will provide the money for continuous technological innovation and allow new fintech startups and technology companies to enter the digital payments space and compete with "well-capitalised tech conglomerates", NPCI said.

The MDR revenue will also fund investments in cyber security infrastructure, AI-driven fraud detection, and encryption upgrades, it said.

Since January 2020, there has been no MDR on RuPay debit cards and UPI transactions. This was to promote the adoption of digital payments across the country. To help meet some of the costs, the government has been subsidising payments of up to Rs 2,000 made to small merchants through its 'Incentive scheme for promotion of RuPay Debit Cards and low-value BHIM-UPI transactions (P2M)'. The incentive offered is capped at 0.15 per cent of the transaction value. Large merchants are not covered under this scheme.

The new fees apply only to person-to-merchant transactions. Person-to-person transactions will continue to be free. There are no monthly quotas, volume limits, or tiered caps on free UPI transactions for individuals, the Ministry of Finance said in a statement, adding that daily transaction limits of Rs 1 lakh-Rs 5 lakh enforced by banks and NPCI are "purely risk-management measures".

audiences, giving everyone an opportunity to see the impact a match can have, and also showcase what the Japan team can do," Miyajiri said.

"It feels real now. There is still some disbelief that we've managed to get this game together," said Japan captain Kadowaki-Fleming.

Anticipating a large crowd, the Sano cricket ground's capacity has been increased from 500 to 2,000. "We put tickets on sale about two weeks before the event... even before we were able to send out the emails announcing the sale, the tickets started going," Miyajiri said.

Not wanting to risk the quality of the cricket pitch, the JCA reached out to Sri Lanka Cricket (SLC) for assistance. SLC sent their groundsmen

based financing for capital assets in higher education institutions — approved a loan of Rs 161 crore for the project. The university said it would bear Rs 72.35 crore of the cost. Of this, Rs 64.68 crore has been released, but only Rs 1.7 crore had been utilised until April this year.

Officials said CPWD, the executing agency, would begin issuing various construction tenders for the complex in the coming weeks.

PROJECT: Nirbhaya Residential Accommodation

Location: Dhaka complex
Capacity: 1,000 women students, to be housed in two blocks of 500 beds each

Estimated cost: More than Rs 200 crore

Project announced: March 2024

STATUS: Awaiting disbursement of funds from the Ministry of Women and Child Development, the sole funding agency.

In March 2024, then Minister for Women and Child Development Smriti Irani sanctioned Rs 272 crore for the project, records show. However, the records show that the progress of the project was not discussed at subsequent EC meetings.

The three-acre project is proposed to comprise two blocks of 500 beds each, with "enhanced security, CCTV surveillance and gender-sensitive amenities". "The university is awaiting disbursement of funds from the Ministry of Women and Child Development," a senior official said.

IN SOUTH CAMPUS

● The proposal for the construction of a Rs 1796-crore project for a "New Hostel Building" in South Campus was approved in July 2025. In April 2026, the estimated cost was revised to Rs 22.81 crore, records show.

The project is to be funded

through DU's University Development Fund, but no money has been released so far, officials said. A land parcel adjacent to Geetanjali Hostel for Post Graduate Women on Benito Juarez Marg has been identified for the project and documentation work is ongoing, officials said.

● In July 2025, a Rs 11.23-crore expansion project for Geetanjali Hostel itself was approved, and the Central Public Works Department (CPWD) was asked to prepare the building plan. Work is ongoing to finalise the layout of the building, officials said.

Together, the New Hostel Building and the Geetanjali Hostel expansion are expected to add 150 seats. Geetanjali is one of the three university-run hostels at South Campus; the other two are the Saranmati Post Graduate Men's Hostel and the Aravali Post Graduate Men's Hostel.

In August 2025, the Building Committee approved a conceptual proposal for the vertical extension of the two men's hostels, and asked CPWD to prepare a plan, ensuring that no trees would have to be cut.

While CPWD indicated that increasing the height of Aravali hostel would not be feasible, Saranmati hostel would be expanded as part of the long-term measures to increase housing, an official from the Engineering Department said.

● Also in July 2025, the Building Committee approved a proposal for an "Executive Hostel/Guest House" at South Campus. The committee approved Rs 12.41 crore as the preliminary estimated cost, which was revised to Rs 20.05 crore in April 2026, records show.

This project too is to be funded through the University Development Fund, but no funds have been released yet. "The Executive Hostel is planned as a state-of-art-facility for the Faculty of Management

Studies (FMS) in South Campus," the Engineering Department official said.

The capacity gap

According to official figures, DU has 3,422 postgraduate hostel seats, while its colleges have another 3,788. The administration said another 1,622 university-level seats and 3,922 college-level seats are proposed, taking the combined capacity to 12,754.

More than 2.6 lakh students currently study in the university, a large percentage of whom are from outside Delhi and seek hostel accommodation.

Asked about the delay in the Dhaka complex and the status of the university's residential projects, VC Singh said the university was taking steps to increase accommodation for students.

"Construction takes its own time because Delhi has various bodies from which clearances are needed. We are very hopeful that the projects will see fruition and we will be able to provide more residential accommodation to students by the next academic year," he told *The Indian Express* on Monday.

On Tuesday, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta said the Delhi government will build hostels for 10,000 students studying in colleges and universities across the capital. "A large number of young people come to Delhi from different states to pursue higher education. After securing admission to colleges and universities, one of the biggest challenges they face is arranging safe and affordable accommodation," she said.

After the building collapse in Satya Niketan, DU had said in an official statement: "Work on several new hostel projects is set to begin in the near future. The university has been working earnestly on hostel facilities over the past few years; as a result, the total number of hostel seats at DU is set to more than double within a span of 4-5 years."

Dara plea Bankruptcy code

questioning the delay over a decision, said it cannot be kept "lingering".

"Why are you unnecessarily adjourning the matter? Take a decision. You want to reject it, reject it. We will deal with it," the bench said. The matter will be heard again on September 17.

The Board discussed the March 2025 recommendation of the Keonjhar district authorities who were of the view that Singh may be allowed premature release under certain conditions to maintain social harmony.

On August 28, the district authorities reported that on August 15, around 200-250 people associated with Dara Sena assembled outside the Keonjhar District Jail in connection with the proposed release of the convict, and provocative slogans were reportedly raised.

The Board, in its August 31 proceedings, said, "The district authorities report lacks specific recommendation and is inconclusive. In view of all the above-mentioned facts & circumstances, the Board is therefore not inclined to recommend his premature release at this stage."

On several occasions in the past – in November 2016, June 2019, December 2020, January 2022 and February 2023 – the Board had rejected Singh's plea on various grounds including the "societal ramifications in apprehension of communal disturbance in the area".

Following repeated rejection of his plea, Singh, who has been in Keonjhar jail since his arrest in January 2000, moved the Supreme Court in July 2024, seeking premature release.

Singh, who was 37 when he was arrested, belongs to Auraiya district in Uttar Pradesh. Handed the death sentence by a CBI court in September 2003, it was commuted to life imprisonment in June 2005 by the Orissa High Court. This was upheld by the Supreme Court in 2011.

In a statement, the ED listed the identification of some "core operational thrust areas" at its 36th Quarterly Conference of Zonal Officers (QCZO), held at the Indian Institute of Management, Bengaluru, on September 14-15. "Unearthing frauds under the Insolvency and Bankruptcy Code and the PMLA (Prevention of Money Laundering Act)" headed the list.

According to the agency, it "identified recurring malpractices including circumvention of Section 29A, inflation of related-party claims, manipulation of the Committee of Creditors, asset stripping and artificially large haircuts through which promoters regain control of assets".

Section 29A of the IBC prohibits defaulting promoters, wilful defaulters, and connected/ related parties from bidding for their own company during insolvency.

According to the agency, illustrative cases were also discussed during the conference. Asked if Chandra's case was discussed, an ED official said, "Many cases were discussed. I cannot specifically tell which ones."

"It is a serious problem and often clashes with our investigations. Companies often take shelter under IBC to escape prosecution. There are instances where related parties have bought back the company through resolution process, effectively handing over the company to people who sunk it," the official said.

The Subhash Chandra settlement highlights a larger concern over deep haircuts under the IBC, where creditors often recover only a fraction of what they are owed. Between FY2021-22 and FY2025-26, 1,077 cases were resolved under the IBC, with creditors recovering Rs 2.47 lakh crore -- an average

recovery of about 29% of admitted claims. In FY26, recovery fell to 20%, the lowest in five years, down from 37% in FY25, 28% in FY24, 39% in FY23 and 24% in FY22.

The ED said it also "analysed the legal tension between the moratorium under Section 14 and the immunity under Section 32A of the Code on the one hand, and attachment powers under the PMLA on the other".

Section 14 of the IBC provides for a "moratorium", leading to pause in legal action by agencies, while Section 32A grants immunity to a company's assets after a new, unrelated buyer (successful resolution applicant) takes over.

Various zones of the agency "were directed to identify red flags, obtain copies of applications relating to preferential, undervalued, fraudulent and extortionate transactions from resolution professionals, file intervention applications before the tribunal, and initiate independent investigations under the PMLA against the masterminds," the ED said.

The central debate around the IBC is whether it should prioritise reviving distressed companies or maximising recovery for creditors. The government maintains that the Code's primary objective is "resolution, not recovery". Banks, however, have raised concerns about asset valuation, saying divergent methodologies, inadequate accounting of assets and opacity in valuation can lead to excessive haircuts.

The agency also flagged co-ordination with the state police and other law enforcement agencies; fast-tracking of trials; aggressive pursuit of restitution of attached and confiscated assets to legitimate victims; and mandatory valuation of all confirmed attached properties by government-approved valuers.

like Makoto Taniyama and Wataru Miyauchi, who came through the school cricket system, moved cities just to play cricket," he said.

JCA is also asking its players to learn the game's terminology in Japanese, so that it isn't viewed as a foreign sport. "We've been developing the Japan way. We do want to be distinctly Japanese in the way that we do things in cricket, on and off the field," said Kadowaki-Fleming.

He added that baseball is also being tapped for cricketing talent. "I want cricket to be a genuine option for baseball players in schools. Once that happens, cricket will have its own Shohei Ohtani (baseball superstar) in a few years," he said.

CORRECTION & CLARIFICATION

PAGE 4, 15.9.2026

● The headline of the report on the MCD's survey of PG accommodation in Delhi wrongly said that "nearly 30%" of surveyed buildings had no layout approval. In fact, as the report itself said, the survey found that less than 30% of buildings had sanctioned plans. The error is regretted.

Japan

Cricketer Council) to inspire a new audience — it became a key event in the 75th anniversary celebration of friendship between the two countries. We were suddenly able to get the support of both governments in talking to our Indian counterparts," Japan Cricket Association (JCA) CEO Naoki Alex Miyaji told *The Indian Express*. Japan is an associate member of the ICC.

For a baseball-obsessed country trying to take cricket to the masses, the T20 International, ahead of the cricket matches at the Asian Games, has come as a shot in the arm. Sponsor and spectator interest

has been high, according to Miyaji, with Suzuki coming on board as title sponsor.

"Of course, you cannot talk about 75 years of friendship between India and Japan without talking about Suzuki. We also approached MUFG, the biggest bank in Japan, State Bank of India, and TCS, none of whom were JCA partners. We had really good responses," Miyaji said.

While a chunk of the JCA budget is being invested in the India-Japan match, Miyaji pointed to long-term benefits. "Our annual budget is somewhere between 200 and 300 million yen. This match is costing us about 100 million yen. The BCCI has supported this event. But more than the money, it is about bringing new

EXPRESS special

Funding among key hurdles in hostel infra expansion at affiliated colleges of DU

Sophiya Mathew
New Delhi, September 15

EVEN AS key Delhi University (DU) hostel projects are progressing at a slow speed, the campus accommodation expansion in its affiliated colleges is also not moving at the expected pace. Funding, space constraints, land-use restrictions, and a lack of resources are said to be among the major limitations, The Indian Express has learnt.

The preferred accommodation option for outstation students is the on-campus hostel facility that some DU colleges offer.

While the university's hostels have 3,422 seats, over 80 colleges affiliated to it collectively have 3,788 hostel seats.

This is still woefully short of the number of students enrolling in the university — a large chunk of whom come from other states. On average, roughly 2.8 lakh students enrol in undergraduate programmes annually in the university, and roughly 11,600 students enrol in PG programmes.

A red flag for years

The shortfall is particularly acute in DU's South Campus where only two colleges have hostels — Sri Venkateswara College has about 144 hostel beds and Maitreyi College 103. Lady Shri Ram College, which is also located in South Delhi, has around 150 hostel beds.

In comparison, several North Campus colleges are better off with St Stephen's having around 380 beds, Miranda House 361, Sri Guru Tegh Bahadur Khalsa College having around 357 and IP College for Women around 450.

The shortfall has been a red flag for years. For instance, in October 2020, citing a massive increase in enrolment after the expansion of student intake to accommodate the new Economically Weaker Section (EWS), senior officials at Shaheed Bhagat Singh College flagged the need for an urgent expansion of infrastructure.

Six years later, it still functions without a housing facility for its students, and caters to both evening and morning shift students.

Underlying factors

Different college administrators that The Indian Express spoke to over the years suggest that constraints vary from one campus to another. At some colleges, land availability on campus is a factor. For instance, Aryabhata College and Ram Lal Anand College in South Campus share a roughly 10-acre plot, limiting the scope for another large building.

South Campus colleges, such as Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College, also cite regulatory roadblocks because they are located on the protected forest area of the South Central Ridge.

• Numbers at a glance

Comparison against DDA prevailing/revised statutory norms (MPD-2021 / MPD-2041: 4.0 Ha / -9.88 acres).

College	Present Campus Area	vs Existing/ Revised Norm*
Sri Venkateswara College	15 acres	+5.12 acres surplus
Jesus & Mary College	14.1 acres	+4.22 acres surplus
Gargi College	13 acres	+3.12 acres surplus
ARSD College	12.31 acres	+2.43 acres surplus
Maitreyi College	10 acres	+0.12 acres surplus
Motilal Nehru College	9.87 acres	Meets norm (-parity)
Kamala Nehru College	9.35 acres	-0.53 acres deficit
Ram Lal Anand College	5 acres	-4.88 acres deficit
Aryabhata College	5 acres	-4.88 acres deficit
Delhi College of Arts & Commerce	5 acres	-4.88 acres deficit

* (MPD-2021: 4.0 HA / -9.88 AC)

Aryabhata College principal Manoj Sinha, said, "In the decentralised governance of Delhi University, a constituent college's internal Building Committee handles the initial structural and administrative project approvals, as the college administration acts as the immediate local custodian of its specific campus land."

Sinha emphasised that under the Delhi Preservation of Trees Act (DPTA), 1994, the legal definition of a tree is incredibly broad, meaning even substantial woody shrubs and saplings require formal protection.

Once the Delhi Environment department grants clearance, the executing agency —

typically Central Public Works Department (CPWD) — must legally enforce strict protocols to prevent tree damage, stated Sinha.

The historical nature of the campuses also throws up regulatory challenges. At Indraprastha College for Women, the Grade-I heritage status of the campus places restrictions on structural alterations and expansion.

Funding a key issue

Alongside all these factors, funding is an overarching issue. There is no student hostel at Jesus and Mary College, leaving outstation students dependent on paying guest (PG) accommo-

dations.

"We are a convent college. We don't have any trust as such to fund such massive infrastructure," said Principal Molly K A. After the building collapse at Satya Niketan on September 6, several women students took shelter inside the classrooms. "Till how long can I keep them in classrooms?," the Principal had told this paper at the time.

At Maitreyi College, which has a limited capacity of 103 beds, Principal Haritma Chopra said expansion requires resources not only for construction but also for staffing and services.

"The challenge with expansion is the availability of resources. We have to recruit housekeeping staff and ensure other amenities like a fully functional mess. It takes a few years, but we are certainly speeding up things," she said.

Aryabhata College's Manoj Sinha, who is also the President of the Delhi University Principals' Association, is blunt about the student housing gap. "DU is never going to accommodate everybody on the campus... There are more than five lakh students in the university, with approximately three lakh in regular programmes... You cannot keep adding students and expect the existing infrastructure to accommodate everyone," he said.

"Every college has different resources. The land parcels also vary in size. Some colleges have

16 acres, while some have very little land, such as five acres in the case of Aryabhata College and Shaheed Sukhdev College of Business Studies. This makes it difficult for colleges with smaller campuses to expand their infrastructure, including hostels," he added.

A former DU vice-chancellor said many colleges had been reluctant to take up hostel projects because of the financial and administrative resources involved, and that in earlier days, improved transport connectivity was thought of as a way to address growing student populations.

"Many colleges were not set up as residential campuses," he said. He said the varsity had previously added feeder bus services to Metro services as a way to improve access rather than focus on conventional measures like expanding residential provisions.

"But that model does not work for an outstation student," he said.

Some colleges continue to look for out-of-the-box solutions to this persistent problem. Miranda House Principal Bijayalaxmi Nanda said along with exploring vertical expansion to augment its capacity of 361 beds, the college is also exploring a "buddy system", drawing on models abroad where students without hostel rooms are matched with senior students or local hosts willing to accommodate them at home.

Govt to construct hostels for 10,000 students, says CM

Devansh Mittal
New Delhi, September 15

MORE THAN a week after a hostel building collapsed in South West Delhi's Satya Niketan, killing seven and injuring many others, Chief Minister Rekha Gupta on Tuesday said that the Delhi government will build hostels for 10,000 students studying in colleges and universities across the Capital.

"Delhi is not only the national capital, but also a major education hub. A large number of young people come to Delhi from different states to pursue higher education. After securing admission to colleges and universities, one of the biggest challenges they face is arranging safe and affordable accommodation," Gupta said, highlighting that the government is working to find a "permanent solution" to this problem.

Officials said construction will be carried out through various departments, including Health, Higher Education, and Women and Child Development. "Hostel construction was already underway or proposed at institutions including Ambedkar University, G.B. Pant Engineering College and Polytechnic, Indira Gandhi Hospital and Medical College, and Delhi Sports University. The initiative's scope will now be widened given the growing need," officials said.

The government, according to officials, plans to extend hostel facilities to students studying in any college or university in

Delhi, not just government institutions. A survey will be conducted to identify colleges with sufficient space for hostel construction, and the process will be expedited once locations are identified. Officials said land will also be acquired, if necessary.

The hostels will be built under a public-private partnership (PPP) model, Gupta said, to speed up construction while ensuring maintenance and facilities. "The government's responsibility would not end with the construction of hostels," she said, adding that it would also ensure students' safety, comfort and essential needs.

The government said a draft hostel policy is also being prepared. It, however, did not provide a timeline for the completion of these projects.

First panel meeting

Two portals will also be developed within 15 days — one to map students' data and another for PG owners to register their facilities and detail building age, structure size, and fire safety measures. This was decided on Tuesday at the first meeting of a high-powered committee on student accommodation and safety, formed by Lieutenant-Governor Taranjit Singh Sandhu to examine the shortage, safety standards and regulation of student housing.

Following the meeting, officials said that the Delhi Development Authority and the Urban Development department will identify suitable land parcels to build new hostels.

DRUG SMUGGLING CASE

'Drug kingpin' Virender Baisoya's son held, sent to 7-day police custody

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

THE SON of alleged drug kingpin Virender Baisoya, Rishabh (23), who was wanted by the Delhi Police Special Cell in connection with a drug smuggling case, was arrested soon after he landed at the Indira Gandhi International Airport from Dubai on Tuesday, officials said.

According to sources, a Red Corner Notice (RCN) and a Look Out Circular (LOC) issued against him were revoked on the directions of a Delhi court after his lawyer said Rishabh wanted to return to India to join the investigation. Police said he had been on the run since 2024.

On Tuesday, he was detained at the airport for a brief period, after which the Special Cell took him into custody. He was later produced before a court, which remanded him in police custody for seven days.

According to the Special Cell, Rishabh was allegedly operating from overseas at the behest of his father. In October 2024, on his father's directions, he allegedly handed over his uncle's car to one Jatinder Gill alias Jassi to transport a consignment of cocaine from Delhi to Punjab. Jassi was later arrested in Amritsar, and the vehicle, a Toyota Fortuner, was seized by the police with 1 kg of cocaine.

Police say Rishabh, who had been on the run since 2024, was allegedly operating from overseas at the behest of his father.

According to his lawyer Aditya Dhawan, however, Rishabh has been implicated in the case merely because he is Virender's son. "Since 2022, Rishabh had been pursuing an LLB (Hons) at the University of West London and was in India during his vacation, intending to return to London in October 2024 to resume his studies... As per the police chargesheet, Jatinder Gill alias Jassi does not state that the contraband was supplied to him by Rishabh. Instead, accused Tushar Goel allegedly disclosed that he had given 1 kg of contraband to Jatinder Gill for supply in Punjab," Dhawan said.

Dhawan further said that Rishabh had avoided the investigation out of fear of being falsely implicated and arrested after his uncle was allegedly arrested despite "having no role in the case".

Virender was brought back to India as part of the Narcotics Control Bureau's (NCB's) 'Operation Global-Hunt' after he was arrested in Dubai in June. He

was also arrested at the Delhi airport on August 14 by the agency soon after he landed from Dubai.

He was then taken to Pune for questioning by the NCB's Mumbai unit in connection with the seizure of 1,800 kg of methedrone from Pune and Delhi in a case dating back to 2024.

Earlier this month, the Delhi Police secured his custody in connection with a Rs 13,000-crore drug cartel case. In its chargesheet, the Special Cell named 19 accused. Fourteen of them had been arrested, including Tushar Goyal, an heir to two publishing houses. The remaining five, including Virender and his son, had been declared proclaimed offenders as they were absconding.

The seizures in the case took place in three parts, according to the chargesheet. On October 1, 2024, 562 kg of cocaine was seized in South Delhi's Mahipalpur. Tushar and three others were arrested. On October 10, another 208 kg of cocaine was seized from a shop in West Delhi's Ramesh Nagar. The third seizure took place on October 13, when officers of the Special Cell and Gujarat Police recovered 518 kg of cocaine, worth Rs 5,000 crore in the international market, during a raid at a firm called Aavkar Drugs in Gujarat's Ankleshwar.

'10-day custody should've given time to reflect': Swatantra gets bail

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 15

A DELHI court on Tuesday granted Swatantra Bharadwaj, a self-styled influencer, three weeks of interim bail for allegedly attacking the father of a student protester who participated in the agitation organised against the paper leak issue by the Cockroach Janta Party in July.

"Weighing all the circumstances, the Court takes into account that the applicant has been in custody for a little over 10 days... a period that should have afforded him time for reflection," said Additional Sessions Judge Saurabh Partap Singh Laler of the Patiala House Court in his order.

Bharadwaj had recently purportedly admitted to attacking the father of the student pro-

tester at Jantar Mantar in a video. On September 4, relevant sections pertaining to the Scheduled Castes and Scheduled Tribes (Prevention of Atrocities) Act, 1989 (SC/ST Act), were added to an earlier FIR registered against Bharadwaj over the alleged attack, amid a protest by CJP supporters and the Indian Youth Congress, as well as Lok Sabha MPs Chandra Shekhar alias Azad and Rajesh Ranjan alias Pappu Yadav.

In his order on Tuesday, the Judge added, "The case started with offences under Sections 115(2) and 126(2) BNS. These are bailable, and they carry a maximum punishment of one year and one month respectively. For more than two months, the investigating agency did not consider the applicant's arrest necessary."



Swatantra Bharadwaj

"...It is equally significant that the allegation of caste-based insult, although attributed to the very start of the occurrence, finds no mention in the complaint on which the FIR was registered. It surfaced for the first time about 10 weeks later. A belated allegation is not, for that reason alone, false; nor can this Court decide its truth at the threshold. It is nonetheless

Delhi Zoo worker attacked by monkey

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

AN EMPLOYEE of the Delhi Zoo was attacked by a bonnet macaque monkey while he was cleaning a night cell on Monday morning, zoo authorities said.

The employee, a daily-wage worker, was engaged through a contractor. A zoo official said that the worker sustained multiple injuries, including a severed finger and deep bites on both legs. The incident took place around 11.30 am on Monday, according to Delhi Zoo Di-

rector Sanjeet Kumar. The worker was taken to a hospital following the incident and was later discharged.

"A detailed assessment and enquiry into the circumstances leading to the incident are underway," Kumar told *The Indian Express*.

He also said that the zoo was strengthening corrective and preventive measures following the incident, including those relating to enclosure access, cleaning protocols, staff safety and animal handling.

"Detailed protocols for ani-

mal access, cleaning, etc. have been reiterated and circulated among the staff," Kumar said.

The incident involved a bonnet macaque housed in Beat No. 1 at the zoo. A zoo official said the animal had escaped its enclosure and entered a caretaker gallery, where it attacked the worker. The official also alleged that the enclosure's locking mechanism was "faulty".

The incident comes amid concerns among zoo staff over safety arrangements and deployment of staff around animal enclosures.

• Skywatch

Forecast:
September 16, 2026
Cloudy sky. Very light rain.

MAX: 33-35
1.2°C below normal

MIN: 23-25
0.1°C below normal

• **Sunrise:** 6:06 AM (September 16)
• **Sunset:** 6:26 PM (September 15)

• **Moonrise:** 10:59 AM (September 16)
• **Moonset:** 8:43 PM (September 15)

• AQI Tracker

Narela Satisfactory AQI: 96	Vivek Vihar Moderate AQI: 106
Sirifort Moderate AQI: 126	Najafgarh Satisfactory AQI: 71
● Good (0-50) ● Satisfactory (51-100) ● Moderate (101-200) ● Poor (201-300) ● Very Poor (301-400) ● Severe (401-500)	

• AT A TIME WHEN 'DECISION FATIGUE' SEEMS TO BE PREVALENT

At eateries offering limited menu, food enthusiasts spared of 'choice exhaustion'

Akriti Kanodia & Reva Thakkar
New Delhi, September 15

IT'S A weekday evening. Around 12 people are waiting at Benne, an eatery in Greater Kailash II's M Block. The menu is exhaustive and thus it does not exhaust the customers. "I like that I don't have to think about what to order before coming here. I know it's Benne Dosa," says Kavya, a student at Delhi University.

Benne means butter. The eatery gives customers three variations of butter dosa, along with some other accompaniments like Idli and filter coffee.

Aditya Vaidya, Head of Delhi Operations of Benne, says, "I feel that the restaurants that have a relatively smaller

menu tend to serve better food... If you have 50 items on the menu, the customer's attention gets divided."

However, it's not just Benne focusing on a limited menu. Many eateries across Delhi are building their identity around a signature food item, while others are cutting their menus.

Priyamvada Gupta co-founded Dumbo, a specialty sandwich eatery chain, last year with her husband Prateek Gupta. "I like a small menu because I'm otherwise going to spend 20 minutes on what's the best thing that I want to order," she says. Polka dot chairs, books and bright colours define the vibe at the cafe, according to her.

Along with her husband, Prateek, she also runs two fine-

dining restaurants but Dumbo — that has three outlets across Delhi, serving Italian Florentine ciabatta sandwiches with five vegetarian and non-vegetarian options — was no less than a passion project.

"We are inspired by Florence, Italy, where they have these sandwich shops (delis) that have an exactly similar menu and are just grab-and-go," she explains.

Similarly, Akhil co-founded Benne in 2024, inspired by "The Darshinis" in Karnataka — small fast-food eateries with only stand-and-eat options.

Benne essentially is a stand-and-eat space, but it has a small table for a group of six. "The whole point was to elevate and give a modern touch to a 'Darshini'. But we're still essentially



a Darshini," said Iyer.

Vaidya, who ran a restaurant in Maharashtra's Sangli before he joined Benne, highlights the benefits of having a limited menu: "For serving items quickly, a vast menu can't



(Left) Priyamvada Gupta at Dumbo; Benne offers limited options of Dosas

be an option. We have chosen efficiency over variety."

Gupta agrees, "It's easier to do 10 things well than 30."

Other Delhi eateries like The Khow Suey Shop and T's Tiramisu also have just one item to

offer. The Khow Suey Shop, as its name suggests, serves a Burmese-style Khow suey and offers three varieties.

In the narrow lanes of Safdarjung, where almost every restaurant serves a variety of north-eastern, Nepalese, Burmese, and Korean cuisine, sits Laphings Corner, which, much like any of the momo stall, has just chicken momos, vegetarian laphings, and non-vegetarian laphings.

Started in April this year, Kaala, which works on 'pay what you want mode', is a hole-in-the-wall coffee place in Shahpur Jat, which offers three varieties. Ajay, the founder and barista says, "People have too many options: macchiato, cappuccino. This is what has become of our cafe culture. I want

people to come only for coffee and pay what they feel so that they are present for the moment."

"People don't know what they want, but if you give them fewer options, they can make up their minds faster. Less is more," he adds.

Validating the idea followed by these founders, during a recent webinar, Luca Moreno, CEO and co-founder of Nextatlas, an AI-powered foresight and trend-predicting platform, and Sara Roversi, Founder and President of the Future Food Institute, spoke of the "exhausted eater".

"An exhausted eater is one

for whom even the act of deciding what to eat is overwhelming. This directly points to the menu options that exist.

Earlier, we used to have multiple cuisines when we went to a restaurant for variety. People wanted that huge palette to decide from; variety is what was craved. But in today's day and time, we see a sharp contrast. According to Nextatlas' analysis, conversations in the F&B industry concerning decision fatigue have grown by more than 114% over the past year. This is one of the pressing cultural shifts that is shaping our appetite today," said Moreno.



Panel probing IIT-Delhi student death given two more weeks to submit report

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

THE INDIAN Institute of Technology (IIT) Delhi has extended the tenure of an external inquiry committee which is investigating the alleged death by suicide of MSc student Rishikesh Kumar on its campus, giving it time until September 30 to conclude its proceedings and submit findings.

According to an official notification issued on Monday by Registrar Atul Vyas, the decision to extend the deadline was taken after a formal request made by the committee. It was initially expected to submit its report within two weeks of its formation.

The external committee was constituted on August 27 in the wake of widespread protests on the institute's campus following the death of 31-year-old Rishikesh, who allegedly died by suicide on August 22 after jumping from the sixth floor of the IIT's Lecture Hall Complex.

The death sparked rare campus mobilization. Students held demonstrations and class boycotts for at least a week, demanding an independent probe, systemic accountability, and reforms to campus mental-health and grievance mechanisms.

The committee, headed by retired Delhi High Court judge Justice Mukta Gupta, also comprises medical and administrative experts, along with student representatives.

The panel has been tasked with reviewing the specific circumstances and institutional interactions leading up to the tragedy, and assessing the functioning of administrative offices concerned and the current mental-health support systems.

It has also been asked to recommend procedural reforms to strengthen student welfare and redressal mechanisms on campus.

GURGAON HIT-AND-RUN

Driver who hit woman biker tried to flee after arrest: Cops



Accused Kalyan Bainsla

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, September 15

SOON AFTER he was arrested on Tuesday, gym owner and former kabaddi player Kalyan Bainsla, 33, accused of hitting a woman biker with his car in Gurgaon, allegedly dashed away to escape, said police. He, however, sustained injuries during the escape bid, officers added. Bainsla, who was arrested along with his cousin accompanying him at the time of the incident, has been booked in an attempt to murder case while other charges have also been added, officers said.

The police took suo motu cognizance of the case after the purported videos of the Golf Course Road hit-and-run incident were widely shared, showing a 27-year-old woman biker, Shivani Chauhan, getting rammed by a speeding car. She had also uploaded a video on social media, where she described the incident, saying that she feared for her safety.

As the dashcam and helmet-cam footage of the incident went viral, according to police, Bainsla gave interviews to television channels to present his version, allegedly switched off his mobile phone, and fled to evade arrest. Three special teams were constituted to trace him.

A team from the Crime Branch Sohna tracked him down and apprehended him on Tuesday near Rajgarh in Rajasthan. However, during the

custody transit, Bainsla, who hails from Chandhat in Haryana's Palwal, tried to escape. Along with him, the police also arrested his cousin, Lovenish Gurjar (34), a resident of New Colony in Palwal, who was accompanying him at the time of the incident.

"After being apprehended, the accused attempted to escape from police custody on the pretext of urinating, during which he sustained some injuries after falling. He was provided primary treatment at a hospital," a Gurugram Police spokesperson said.

Police also seized the white Maruti Suzuki Ciaz used that Bainsla was allegedly driving, which is registered in the name of an associate, an Army personnel currently posted in Assam, according to officers. Bainsla had borrowed the vehicle two days prior to the incident.

While the Gurugram Police had initially registered an FIR on Monday for rash driving under basic sections, an in-depth probe and forensic CCTV analysis prompted investigators to significantly escalate the charges. Police added BNS Section 109 for attempt to murder.

Based on the woman's detailed statement regarding harassment on the road, Sections 78 (stalking) and 79 (word, gesture, or act intended to insult the modesty of a woman) of the BNS were also invoked.

DCP (East) Sandeep Kumar confirmed that police have sought two days of remand for

‘Will think 10 times before hitting road again on a bike’

Abhimanyu Hazarika
Gurgaon, September 15

TWO DAYS after she was allegedly chased and rammed by a speeding car in Gurgaon when she was driving a superbike, Shivani Chauhan, 27, said on Tuesday that she was still coping with the trauma.

Earlier in the day, Shivani recorded her statement before a judicial magistrate under Section 183 of BNSS as police arrested two of the four men who were in the car at the time of the incident — driver Kalyan Bainsla and his cousin.

Speaking with *The Indian Express*, Shivani said, "I am still very traumatised. At night, the incident keeps playing in my mind, and does not let me rest. I will take a break from biking for now. The roads will still stay as unsafe for women as they were on Sunday. I will now think 10-12 times before leaving for biking, especially on my own."

She added, "My main aim is to speed up the process of justice in such cases...and see to it that the police and courts punish the guilty."

Recalling the incident, she said, "All men in the car kept making obscene gestures, making fun of my plight after I fell off my vehicle due to the impact of the collision. It is important for me to act so that a message can be sent. Why didn't they make him (prime accused) stop the car, everyone had the same mindset. No one looked back... to see if I was hurt or even alive for that matter."

the accused, who will be presented in court on Wednesday. "They made abusive comments and Bainsla to counter the narrative against him while on the run by giving interviews. He op-



Victim Shivani Chauhan

Shivani was accompanied by other bikers of a group. She has been pursuing the hobby for nearly a year. "This was not my first time on the Gurgaon route. Even in Cyber City, I have experienced road rage. This incident could have been much more dangerous. So I have to fight for other women riders. I will focus on cooperating with the authorities for now."

On her court submission, she said, "I said there were four people in the car...two others I couldn't see due to the tinted glass. That's not my fault. My hands and legs are still hurting," she added.

Her father, Roshan Chauhan, a member of AAP's trade wing, said she was still reeling from the shock of the incident. "She is still feeling bogged down. She did not tell me about the incident all day. I only found out through the news and social media," he said. Shivani too is an AAP volunteer and member of its youth wing. She contested the 2022 Delhi municipal polls from Kalkaji ward on the party ticket. She is a graduate in fashion design from the Footwear Design and Development Institute.

erates a gym and some properties of his. Attempt to murder is made out by his intent seen in the video, the girl was lucky to be having safety gear. Hence we have put in stringent sections."

RS 700-CRORE PROCUREMENT 'SCAM'

Illness can be treated in jail: Court denies bail to former Delhi health services chief

Nirbhay Thakur
New Delhi, September 15

A DELHI court on Monday denied the extension of interim bail on medical grounds to former Directorate General of Health Services (DGHS) chief Dr Vatsala Aggarwal, the primary accused in the alleged Rs 700-crore medical supplies procurement fraud case.

Aggarwal was earlier granted interim bail on humanitarian grounds on August 18 for four weeks. She had sought extension of interim bail for six weeks.

In his order on Monday, Special Judge Vidya Prakash of Rouse Avenue Court said, "A careful perusal of Discharge Summary...would show that she is not suffering from any life-threatening disease and she can very well be treated with such medical ailments inside the jail premises itself."

He added, "There is no substance in the argument raised on behalf of applicant/accused that she has been directed to avoid crowded places in view of her immunocompromised status, and thus, it would be difficult for her to avoid crowds inside the jail premises, if her interim bail is not extended. In order to provide congenial atmosphere and to ensure immunocompromised status of applicant/accused inside the jail, appropriate direction(s) can always be issued by the Court, which includes but not limited to take all necessary precautions and to provide all necessary medical treatment to the applicant/accused inside the jail premises itself."

During her admission, Aggarwal was found to have a severe blood infection and a fall in blood pressure. Her counsel had argued in court that her discharge summary had told the "immunocompromised patient to avoid crowded places,

which cannot be reconciled with confinement in a prison barrack".

The discharge summary said that she was suffering from "chronic bronchial asthma with community-acquired infection (Jail)", mixed sleep apnea, type II Diabetes and hypertension.

While denying her relief, the court gave directions to the Jail Superintendent to make necessary arrangements for her stay.

"...concerned Jail Superintendent shall also make necessary arrangements of adaptive Servo Ventilation with nocturnal oxygen therapy, as and when so required, inside the jail premises. Needless to mention here that in case it is not possible to do so, then, concerned Jail Superintendent shall ensure that the applicant/accused is immediately taken to a government hospital having such facility," the Judge said.

The primary accused in the alleged Rs 700-crore medical procurement fraud are Aggarwal, former Central Procurement Agency (CPA) Deputy Controller of Accounts Neeraj Chopra and Dr Vinod Kumar Ranga, the former Head of Office CPA. The case began with a Vigilance Department complaint that was converted into an FIR on June 2, and revolves around widespread irregularities, manipulated tenders, and the siphoning of public funds meant for medicines, surgical items, and hospital equipment.

The alleged irregularities first came to light in May this year when the Vigilance department conducted raids after receiving complaints at the offices of the CPA, which is the nodal agency responsible for procuring and supplying medicines, vaccines and medical equipment to Delhi government hospitals and healthcare facilities.

Woman gets call from 'Goldy Brar', caller demands Rs 200 crore

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

A 50-YEAR-OLD woman from North Delhi allegedly received two extortion calls from a foreign number during which the caller, who identified himself as Canada-based gangster Goldy Brar, demanded Rs 200 crore from her, police said Tuesday.

Police said an FIR has been registered in the matter. The said they are verifying information provided by the complainant, including the amount allegedly demanded by the caller. According to police, if confirmed, this would be the highest amount demanded in any extortion case reported in Delhi so far.

According to a police source, the complainant, a resident of Civil Lines, received the first call on September 7 around 10.44 pm. The caller allegedly told her that he had all the "information" about her, before demanding Rs 200 crore and also threatening her with "dire consequences".

She allegedly got another call during which the caller made a similar demand and issued a similar threat. It was after the second call that she approached the police, the source said. Police said that during the course of the inquiry, the complainant allegedly mentioned different amounts while speaking about the money demanded by the caller.

Niharika Bhatt, DCP (North), said, "An FIR has been registered at Civil Lines police station on receiving a complaint regarding an extortion call from a foreign number." She said that the complainant is allegedly involved in some family dispute following the death of her father-in-law and that the circumstances surrounding the alleged extortion call are being examined. "The amount demanded during the extortion call is being enquired into, with different amounts being mentioned by the complainant. Police are trying to establish the identity of the caller, his motive and if he has any link with Brar.



DISTRICT POLICE
HEADQUARTERS SAMBA
LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7925 dated 08.09.2026, that one person namely Nikhil S/o Mohan Lal R/o Vijaypur A/P Meen Sarkar Dass Mohalla Bari-Brahmana, has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and his missing report has been entered vide DDR No.25 dated 27.04.2026 of P/S Bari-Brahmana. His search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing person may be communicated on following contacts:-

1. PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001
2. SSP Samba's email ID :- ssp.samba@jkpolice.gov.in
3. SHO PS Bari-Brahmana:- 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing person is as under:-

Name:	Nikhil
W/O:	Mohan Lal
Permanent Address:	Vijaypur A/P Meen Sarkar Dass Mohalla Bari-Brahmana
Age:	18 yrs
Height:	5 Feet 06 Inch
Complexion:	Wheatish
Face:	ROUND
Body Structure:	Medium
Languages known:	HINDI
Attire:	T-shirt Pajama



No. CB/Look/2026/ **Sd/-**

Dated: -.09.2026 **Sr. Superintendent of Police,**

DIP NO. DIP/J-10481/26 DATE 15.09.2026 **Samba**



DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS KATHUA
E-mail: sspkathua@jkpolice.gov.in
Fax/Phone No.: 01922-234010

LOOK OUT NOTICE

On 08-09-2026, one lady namely Pinki Devi W/O Karam Chand R/O Village Dhar Kohar Tahsil Mahanpur District Kathua lodged a written report at P/S Basohli stating therein that on 04-09-2026 her daughter namely Sonia Devi, aged 23 years left the complainant house to Basohli for tying rakhi to her brother, along with her minor child namely Sheetal Devi aged 05 years and did not return home thereafter and have remained untraced till date. On this, missing report vide DD No. 05 dated 08-09-2026 has been entered at Police Station Basohli.

During the course of investigation, best efforts were made to locate missing individual, whereas she is still on-tracked.

As such Description Roll/Photograph of said missing individual is being shared with the appeal that anybody having clue/information about her whereabouts may inform us accordingly. The informer will be rewarded suitably:-

Description Roll :-

- Name Sonia Devi
- Father Karam Chand
- Husband Pawan Kumar
- Permanent Address Village Dhar Kohar
- Present Address Village Dhar Kohar
- Tehsil Mahanpur
- Police Station Basohli
- Age 23 years
- Height 05 Ft 03 inch
- Complexion Fair
- Build Normal
- Face Oval
- Eyes Black
- Languages known Hindi/ Dogri

PHOTOGRAPH


Any information related to the whereabouts of the subject may be communicated on following contacts:-

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

1. DPO Kathua- 01922-234010	(Phone/Fax)
2. dpokathua@jkpolice.gov.in	(Mail ID)
3. PCR Kathua- 01922-234311	(Phone/Fax)
4. Police Station Basohli - 9103007514	
5. SHO PS Basohli- 9186316022	

DIP NO. DIP/J-10468/26 DATE 15.09.2026

Sr. Superintendent of Police

NORTHERN RAILWAY
CORRIGENDUM

Ref : Tender Notice No. - 16/2026-2027 Dated - 27.05.2026 Sr. no. 06

(i) Tender No. - 15235293A due on 13.10.2026

1. In reference to above tender, the due date has been extended from 15.09.2026 to 13.10.2026. All other terms & conditions remain unchanged.

The corrigendum has been published on website www.ireps.gov.in.

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE **3184/26**



KERALA STATE ROAD TRANSPORT CORPORATION
Transport Bhavan , Fort P.O,
Thiruvananthapuram-695023
E-TENDER NOTICE



Name of Item	Last Date of Bid submission
10.00 x 20-16 PR Radial Tyre with Tubes and Flaps	22.09.2026, 06.00 PM
295/80 R 22.5 Tubeless Tyre	
255/70.R.22.5 16 PR Tubeless Tyre	
For the detailed tender document visit: www.etenders.kerala.gov.in , www.keralartc.com/tenders/purchase , e-mail: sr@kerala.gov.in	

sd/-
Chairman & Managing Director
15.09.2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C./ 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Ajay Kumar @ Sonu, S/o: Sompal Singh, R/o: Jhuggi No-N-86/B-102, Lawrence Road, Keshav Puram, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No.: 425/2019, U/s: 33 D.EX. ACT, P.S. Keshav Puram, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Ajay Kumar @ Sonu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Ajay Kumar @ Sonu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused **Ajay Kumar @ Sonu of P.S. Keshav Puram, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **29.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Sanyam Jain
JMFC-04, North West, Room No. 112, Rohini Courts, Delhi

DP/13008/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82(2) (ii) Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Vinod Kumar S/o Ved Prakash R/o H.No. I/117, Lal Kuan, Pul Prahladpur, New Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 208/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, PS Sun Light Colony, New Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Vinod Kumar** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Vinod Kumar** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Vinod Kumar** of case **FIR No. 208/2026, U/s 21/25/29 NDPS Act, PS Sun Light Colony, New Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **24.10.2026**.

By Order
Sh. Kumar Rajat
(Spl. Judge NDPS Act) ASJ
DP/12908/SE/2026 (Court Matter) Court No. 312, Saket Courts, New Delhi

NOTICE INVITING E-TENDER



Gujarat Energy Limited (GEL), desires to invite bids against Tender(s) under two bid system through e-tendering portal from eligible and interested parties for the following categories:

Tender ID	Tender Description
342619	Wet Lease of Type-3 MEGC CNG Cascade (6600 WL) Including Hydrotesting of The Cascade
342627	Supply, Installation, Testing & Commissioning of CNG Car Dispensers Including Comprehensive AMC
342632	Supply, Installation, Testing, Commissioning of CNG Booster Compressors Including Comprehensive O&M
343362	Hiring of Hydraulic Fracturing including Mud Acid Job Services for GEL operated Onshore Blocks on Callout Basis
344309	Selection of Architectural Consultant for Providing Comprehensive Architectural, Civil & Interior Design Services for the Proposed (GEL) Corporate Office Building at Vaishnodevi Circle, Ahmedabad
344241	Supply of various sizes of FRP sleeper across GEL locations
344225	Supply of Domestic Regulator Low Pressure Across GEL Locations

Interested bidders can access the Tender Documents and related updates on <https://geltender.nprocure.com> and <https://www.gujarat-energy.com/ggl-current-tender/>. Interested bidders are advised to regularly visit above websites to stay updated on the aforementioned tender.

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Jumman Khan S/o Dulal, R/o Street No. 1, Bihari Pur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **FIR No. 256/2021 u/s 457/380/411 IPC at P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Jumman Khan** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Jumman Khan** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Jumman Khan** accused of **FIR No. 256/2021 u/s 457/380//411 IPC at P.S. Khajuri Khas, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **18.11.2026**.

By Order: **Ms. Norma Jain,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03, Room No. 22, First Floor, North-East Distt., Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/13085/NE/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(SEE SECTION 82 Cr.P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused person(s) **Wasim S/o Md. Rahees R/o J-44, Street No. 1, Seelampur, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in Case **FIR No. 35/2024, U/s 25 Arm Act, PS Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a Warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** can not be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that the said accused person(s) **Wasim** of Case **FIR No. 35/2024, U/s 25 Arm Act, PS Welcome, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before dated **29.10.2026**.

By Order
Deepakshi Rana
Ld. Metropolitan Magistrate-03
Room No. 19, North-East Distt.
Karkardooma Courts, Delhi

DP/12875/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 84 Bharatiya Nagarik Suraksha Sanhita, 2023

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Mujahid @ Laddu, S/o: Jahid, R/o: Z-III, H.No. 27, Welcome, Delhi** has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in case **FIR No. 271/2019, U/s 25 Arms Act, P.S.: Welcome, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said accused **Mujahid @ Laddu** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Mujahid @ Laddu** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant).

Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Mujahid @ Laddu** accused of offence in case **FIR No. 271/2019, U/s 25 Arms Act, P.S.: Welcome, Delhi** and is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **16.10.2026**.

By Order
Ms. Deepakshi Rana
Judicial Magistrate First Class-03 Shahdara, Room No. 19 Karkardooma Court, Delhi

DP/12868/NE/2026 (Court Matter)

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

(See Section 82 Cr. P.C./84 BNSS)

Whereas complaint has been made before me that the accused **Rajesh @Chote** S/o Surender R/o T-236, Kabir Nagar, R.P Bagh, Delhi has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence in **FIR No. 563/20 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Bharat Nagar, Delhi** and it has been returned to warrant of arrest there upon issued that the said accused **Rajesh @ Chote** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said accused **Rajesh @Chote** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of said warrant). Proclamation is hereby made that **Rajesh @Chote** in **FIR No. 563/20 U/s 25/54/59 ARMS ACT, PS Bharat Nagar, Delhi** is required to appear before this court to answer the said complaint on or before **15.12.2026**.

By order
Ms. Anuradha Jindal
Additional Chief Judicial Magistrate
Court No. 101, 1st Floor
Rohini Court, Delhi

DP/13039/NW/2026

PROCLAMATION REQUIRING THE APPEARANCE OF ACCUSED PERSON

See Section 82 Cr.P.C.

Whereas complaint has been made before me that accused **Shawan @ Raju** S/o Munna H.No. 23, 24/2, 2, 4 Ground Floor, Gram Sabha, Vill. Libaspur City, Delhi-110042. Also at: 66 Futa Road, Near Kabir Mandir, Dharamshala Libaspur, Delhi-42 has committed (or is suspected to have committed) the offence **CR Case 3159/2023 & FIR No. 157/2023 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi** and it has been returned to a warrant of arrest thereupon issued that the said **Accused** cannot be found and whereas it has been shown to my satisfaction that the said **Accused** has absconded (or is concealing himself to avoid the service of the said warrant). Proceeding **u/s 82 Cr.P.C.** has been initiated in the case. Proclamation is hereby made that the said **Shawan @ Raju** accused of **CR Case 3159/2023 & FIR No. 157/2023 u/s 379/411/34 IPC at P.S. Patparganj Industrial Area, Delhi** is required to appear before this Court to answer the said complaint on or before **27.10.2026**.

By Order: **Shri P. Bhargav Rao,**
Judicial Magistrate First Class-05 (East), Room No. 03, Second Floor, Karkardooma Courts, Delhi.

DP/12557/ED/2026

BJP should bring UCC through Parliament, not backdoor: Omar

Naveed Iqbal
Srinagar, September 15

J&K CHIEF Minister Omar Abdullah on Tuesday said the BJP should bring the Uniform Civil Code (UCC) Bill through Parliament and not via different states or through a backdoor. “This is the job of Parliament. If they have the numbers, they should bring this [UCC] through Parliament,” Omar told reporters outside his home. He also said that given the reluctance of BJP’s own allies, the party will not be able to get the Bill passed in the House. “Not everyone in NDA is in agreement on this matter. From what I hear, the Janata Dal United (JDU) has said that this will not be implemented in Bihar,” Omar said. Stating that the UCC is “not

universal” if it does not apply to the whole country, the CM pointed out “the whole country is not a BJP-ruled state”. “If the UCC is applied only to BJP-ruled states, it is not a universal law,” Omar said, adding that “something of this nature should not be decided by individual states. It has to be decided by the country as a whole, which is represented in Parliament.” The J&K leader also pointed out that legislation such as “one nation, one election” or reservation, have not been brought to Parliament, “and now this one is also being routed through states.” On the recently concluded BRICS Summit, Omar called the joint declaration condemning the 2025 Pahalgam attack “a big thing”. He said, “Please see how

many allies of Pakistan were in that room. Therefore, for Pahalgam to even be mentioned at the summit is in itself a big success of our foreign policy.” On China lauding India’s foreign policy after Prime Minister Narendra Modi and Chinese President Xi Jinping met on the sidelines of the BRICS Summit in Delhi, Omar said, “Why do we look for certificates from others?” The danger with this, he added, is that “tomorrow, were China to say something against our foreign policy, then what will you do?” He said, “We should not give too much importance to what other countries say about our foreign policy, whether positive or negative. If they criticise us, we will say ‘do not interfere in our foreign policy.’”

SC issues notice to Education Secretary on contempt of court petition

New Delhi: The Supreme Court on Tuesday issued notice to Union Education Secretary T K Anil Kumar on a plea seeking initiation of contempt of court proceedings for allegedly failing to comply with its direction to consider a representation for recognition and monitoring of institutions imparting religious education to children below 14. A bench of Justices Dipankar

Datta and Sheel Nagu issued the notice on a plea by advocate Ashwini Kumar Upadhyay, who had earlier approached the court seeking its intervention. On May 11, the SC disposed of the plea, with a direction to the Centre “to look into the representation of the petitioner...and take an appropriate decision thereon within two months”. Upadhyay contended that though he forwarded his representation and the court order to the concerned authorities, he did not receive any response, leaving him with no option but to approach the court again. ENS

शुद्धि पत्र

पी.एम. श्री केंद्रीय विद्यालय क्रमांक-2, दिल्ली छावनी द्वारा विद्यालय भवन एवं स्टाफ क्वार्टर्स, फर्नीचर, बैंड/वाद्य यंत्र की मरम्मत, कैंटीन, किराये पर तम्बू सामग्री, खेलकूद, स्टेशनरी, मुद्रण (Printing) आदि कार्यों हेतु निविदा आमंत्रित करने संबंधी सूचना दिनांक 19 अगस्त 2026 को द इंडियन एक्सप्रेस समाचार पत्र में प्रकाशित की गई थी। उक्त निविदा में निविदा जमा करने की अंतिम तिथि 08 सितंबर 2026 निर्धारित की गई थी, जिसे अब बढ़ाकर 18 सितंबर 2026 कर दिया गया है। अतः इच्छुक निविदा दाता विधिवत भरी हुई एवं मुहरबंद निविदाएँ दिनांक 19 सितंबर 2026 तक विद्यालय में जमा कर सकते हैं।

प्राचार्य

Indian Institute of Science Education and Research Bhopal

(Estb. by Ministry of Education, Govt. of India)

Advt. No.: IISERB/DOAA/2026/02September 13, 2026

Admission for Academic Year 2026-27

Applications are invited for the semester commencing from January 2027.

Ph.D. Programme

(For National and International Students)

Natural Sciences Stream: Biological Sciences, Chemistry, Earth and Environmental Sciences, Physics.

Engineering Sciences Stream: Chemical Engineering, Data Science and Engineering (DSE), Electrical Engineering and Computer Science (EECS).

Humanities and Social Sciences Stream: Economic Sciences, Humanities and Social Sciences.

Details of qualification, eligibility, application form and application procedure are available on <https://www.iiserb.ac.in/admission>

Last Date for Submission of Application: October 12, 2026

(Updates, if any, shall be notified on the Institute website)

अधिष्ठाता शैक्षणिक

PUBLIC NOTICE

On instructions of my Client the public is informed that with reference to e-auction notice published by UNION BANK OF INDIA on 29-08-2026 regarding e-auction of the property on 17-9-2026 mentioned therein as Land & Hotel Building situated at PLOT NO 15, INDUSTRIAL AREA PHASE-1, CHANDIGARH

The following points are to be noted

STAY OF SALE CONFIRMATION OF PROPERTY

Hon'ble NCLT, Chandigarh Bench in IA 1335 of 2026 has on 14-09-2026 been pleased to stay the Confirmation of Sale.

Further note that the said notice as published by the Union Bank of India has concealed facts which were mentioned in earlier Auction Notices

1. Charge on Property of Fluer Hotels : on the above-mentioned property as per orders of Hon'ble Punjab & Haryana High Court in CR 1365 of 2022

2. Execution Petition wrt said property by Fluer Hotels pending in Distt Court Chandigarh

3. Litigation pending : SA 47/2023 wrt said property pending before Hon'ble DRT Chandigarh

4. Tenancy : Order and decree passed in CS 491/2016 titled H Singh v. Hind Motors

5. High Court Orders : Passed by Honorable Punjab Haryana High Court in CWP 14633 of 2024 wherein earlier auction was set aside and observed impossibility / illegality of the Auction and ordered refund of bidders deposit

6. Supreme Court : The Honorable Supreme Court in SLP 53794/2024 dismissed the appeal of the Bank against the above order

The present notice is published to bring the correct and complete facts or the notice of the General Public.

Issued under the instructions of Shri Ashish Gupta, Plot No 15 , Industrial Area Phase-1, Chandigarh.

Through counsel

Samarth Suri, Advocate

SUBROS And Associates

Advocates and Solicitors

232 Sector 19A, Chandigarh , 7009097337

गांधी स्मृति

प्रधानमंत्री नरेन्द्र मोदी जी के जन्मदिवस पर

RUN FOR VIKSIT BHARAT

वीरवार, 17 सितम्बर, 2026, प्रातः 6:00 बजे

स्थान :- मेजर ध्यानचंद नेशनल स्टेडियम

मुख्य अतिथि

हर्ष मल्होत्रा

केंद्रीय राज्य मंत्री

खटक परिवहन और राजमार्ग

विजय गोयल

उपाध्यक्ष, गांधी स्मृति एवं दर्शन समिति

पूर्व केंद्रीय मंत्री

GOVT. OF BIHAR

BIHAR COMBINED ENTRANCE COMPETITIVE EXAMINATION BOARD

I.A.S. Association Building, Near Patna Airport, Patna-14.

Website : bceceboard.bihar.gov.in / Helpdesk : helpdesk.bceceboard@bihar.gov.in

UNDER GRADUATE MEDICAL ADMISSION COUNSELLING

(UGMAC)-2026 for MBBS/ BDS/ B.V.Sc. & A.H./ B.F.Sc. in Govt. Medical / Dental / Veterinary Colleges / College of Fisheries and Private Medical / Dental Colleges of Bihar

Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/07 Dated 15.09.2026

Notice regarding Extended Online Counselling Programme for Round-2

In continuation to Adv. No. BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/05 & 2026/06 dated 11.09.2026, it is informed to all eligible & interested NEET(UG)-2026 qualified candidates and all concerned that as per Health Department, Bihar, Patna Letter no. 1279(1) dated 15.09.2026, 1 (One) New Pvt. Medical College "K. K. Medical College & Hospital, Rajgir, Nalanda" and 50 additional seats in "Himalaya Medical College & Hospital, Paliganj, Patna" has been added.

2. In the light of above, updated seat matrix has been uploaded on Board's website.

3. Accordingly, the online Registration & submission of Application Form-cum-Choice Filling/ Editing of Application form data / Editing of Choices (Round-2) schedule is hereby extended as given below;

4. Extended Important Dates for UGMAC-2026 Round-2 Counselling :

i. Updated Seat Matrix posting on Board's website 15.09.2026

ii. Last date of online Registration & submission of Application with payment through Debit Card/ Credit Card/ Net Banking/ UPI by Registered candidate/ Editing of Application Form data 17.09.2026 (11.59 pm)

iii. Consent for Round-2 with Payment (if any) from such candidates who have already duly submitted the Application Form earlier upto 17.09.2026 (10.00 pm)

iv. Publication of Rank Card 19.09.2026

v. Last date of Choice Filling / Editing of Choices & Locking 20.09.2026 (11.59 pm)

vi. Round-2 Provisional Seat Allotment Result publication 24.09.2026

vii. Downloading of Provisional Seat Allotment order (Round-2) 24.09.2026 to 28.09.2026

viii. Documents Verification and Admission 26.09.2026 to 28.09.2026

5. Rest of the terms / conditions for Round-2 Counselling mentioned in Adv. No.- BCECEB(UGMAC)-2026/05 Dated 11.09.2026 will remain the same.

Controller of Examination

Nepal Finance Minister likely to visit Delhi tomorrow, first since flash floods

Shubhajit Roy
New Delhi, September 15

IN WHAT would be the first bi-lateral visit after the August 26 flash floods, which left over 1,300 dead and 5,000 more unaccounted for in the Himalayan country, Nepal's Finance Minister Swarnim Wagle is likely to visit India later this week, sources in Delhi said. Wagle, the most-experienced minister in the current Nepal cabinet headed by Prime Minister Balendra Shah, is likely to arrive in Delhi on September 17-18. Here, he will meet his counterpart Nirmala Sitharaman, External Affairs Minister S Jaishankar, and key government officials. According to sources, Wagle is expected to discuss economic cooperation, post-disaster reconstruction and economic recovery during his two-day visit. After flash floods wreaked havoc in Nepal, India was quick to provide humanitarian aid and emergency power sup-

port. It delivered about 95 tonnes of aid material and disaster relief supplies. Additionally, India deployed tunnel rescue specialists, forensic experts, and medical teams. Sources hinted that the Nepalese Finance Minister's visit to India is likely to discuss additional financial support for his country. New Delhi had provided similar support after the 2015 Nepal earthquake. Many also see Wagle's visit as Kathmandu's efforts to make up for its earlier snub of India, when Nepal PM Balendra 'Balen' Shah refused to give audience to the Indian Ambas-

sador and his subsequent hesitation to meet Foreign Secretary Vikram Misri in May, which resulted in the latter's event being cancelled. The course correction, they say, began well before the flash floods, when, in June, Nepal's top leader Rabi Lamichhane of the ruling Rastriya Swatantra Party (RSP) party, visited Delhi. Here, he was received by India's leadership, including PM Narendra Modi and Home Minister Amit Shah. Wagle's visit is expected to build on that momentum and the recent signs of cooperation in the wake of the floods.

CENTRAL UNIVERSITY OF HARYANA

MAHENDERGARH (HARYANA) - 123031

Adv. No.: CUH/07/R/T/2026Date: 11.09.2026

EMPLOYMENT NOTICE

Online applications are invited from the Indian Nationals including overseas citizens of India for the positions of Associate Professor and Assistant Professor through Direct Recruitment in various departments. Online application form, Advertisement and other details are available on the University's Website www.cuh.ac.in. Any corrigendum, addendum, etc. will be uploaded on the University's website only. The last date for applying online is 15.10.2026.

REGISTRAR

A

NAAC

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

WORLD OZONE DAY

September 16, 2026

GLOBAL ACTION FOR A COOLER PLANET

Significance of World Ozone Day

World Ozone Day inspires us to choose environment friendly options in our daily lives, such as:

☒ Avoid using products containing CFCs.

☒ Use public transport or bicycle.

☒ Plant trees and increase greenery around us.

☒ Promote recycling.

Preserve the ozone layer, keep the Earth cool, and join hands for sustainable cooling.

DEPARTMENT OF ENVIRONMENT & CLIMATE CHANGE, HARYANA

South Block, 11th Floor, Anant Raj Building, Sector-22

Panchkula, Haryana, Telephone: 0172-2568601

Website: www.harenvironment.gov.in

Email-id: environment@hry.nic.in

Website: www.prharyana.gov.in

@Cmohry

@DiprHaryana

Information, Public Relations & Languages Department, Haryana

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epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi



Pandal Hopping

BJP PRESIDENT Nitin Nabin's packed schedule for the week includes a one-day trip to Maharashtra and back-to-back visits to pandals and temples across Mumbai and Pune on the occasion of Ganeshotsav. The "highly significant spiritual visit", as dubbed by the party, will begin with the BJP chief offering prayers at Shri Siddhivinayak Temple on Wednesday morning, followed by the renowned 'Lalbaugcha Raja' pandal, among others, before calling on prominent members of the NDA government. He will visit Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis's official residence at Malabar Hill and take part in the celebrations there. He will also visit the puja at Deputy Chief Ministers Eknath Shinde and Sunetra Pawar's homes nearby. Later, Nabin will visit pandals and temples across Pune, including the Shrimant Dagdusheth Halwai Ganapati Mandal.

New Address

THE NATIONAL Testing Agency (NTA) on Monday conducted a puja at its new office in the Government of India Press building on Minto Road. The ceremony was attended by the agency's senior officials, including its Director General. Earlier, the NTA headquarters was located in the Okhla area of South East Delhi. The shifting of the main office to Central Delhi comes amid the NTA's ongoing overhaul following the paper leak controversies. The nodal autonomous body conducts key entrance tests for admission to premier higher educational institutions.

Next Summit

TWO KEY social-sector ministries — Ministry of Women and Child Development and Ministry of Social Justice and Empowerment — are planning their departmental summits on the lines of the recent National Departmental Summit on Water hosted by the Union Ministry of Jal Shakti. The two-day summit, held earlier this month, was addressed by Prime Minister Narendra Modi, who is learnt to have praised the initiative of the ministry led by Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil.

• SUSPENSION OF CRPF DIG REVOKED

CRPF revoked Tuesday the suspension of DIG B C Patra who was earlier placed under suspension for allegedly sharing social media content critical of government during the passage of CAPF (General Administration) Bill, 2026. Patra is posted at the CRPF's Tripura Sector headquarters in Agartala. **ENS**

Six states sign Kishau pact; 10th water dispute resolution: Shah

Centre to bear 90% cost; dam to be built on Tons river

Harikishan Sharma
New Delhi, September 15

SIX STATES on Tuesday signed an agreement in the presence of Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil to implement the much-awaited Kishau multipurpose project which envisages construction of a dam on Tons River

Terming the agreement "historic", Shah said after Narendra Modi became Prime Minister, this is the "10th water dispute now set to be resolved".

Chief Ministers Yogi Adityanath (Uttar Pradesh), Pushkar Singh Dhami (Uttarakhand), Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu (Himachal Pradesh), Bhajan Lal Sharma (Rajasthan), Rekha Gupta (Delhi) and Nayab Singh Saini (Haryana) signed the agreement, a statement said.

As part of the project, a 232.6-metre-high Kishau Dam will be built on the Tons River, a tributary of the Yamuna, which will have a water storage capacity of 1,562 million cubic metres, irrigation capacity of 97,000 hectares of land and 1,476 million units of clean hydropower will be generated.

The proposed dam will be located 45 km upstream of Dakpathar, a town on the Uttarakhand-



Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Jal Shakti Minister C R Patil along with Chief Ministers Rekha Gupta, Bhajan Lal Sharma, Pushkar Dhami, Yogi Adityanath, Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu, and Nayab Singh Saini during the signing of the agreement in New Delhi on Tuesday. **ANI**

Himachal Pradesh border.

In a statement, the Union Home Ministry said that "Delhi will be the biggest beneficiary of the project." It will now be placed before the Union Cabinet for approval.

According to the Home Ministry statement, "Amit Shah said that the period from 2018 to 2026, under the leadership of Modi Ji, will be remembered as a period in which almost all water disputes, from Kashmir to Uttar Pradesh, were resolved. He said that the foundation for these resolutions was laid in meetings of the Zonal Councils and the Ministry of Jal Shakti efficiently took these agreements forward. He said that after becoming Minister of Jal Shakti, C R Patil took upon himself the responsibility of resolving long-pending disputes."

On June 16, this year, Shah chaired a meeting of CMs of the

• THE PROJECT

232.6-METRE-HIGH Kishau Dam will be built on Tons River

DAM WILL be located 45 km upstream of Dakpathar, a town on Uttarakhand-Himachal Pradesh border

WATER STORAGE capacity: 1,562 million cubic metres

IRRIGATION CAPACITY: 97,000 hectares of land

1,476 MILLION units of clean hydropower

six states where they agreed to sign an MoU for the implementation of Kishau Multipurpose Project. Patil was also present in the meeting.

During the meeting, it was decided that 90% of the cost of irrigation and drinking water supply component of the Kishau multipurpose dam project

— declared a national project in February 2008 — will be borne by the Centre as central assistance, while the remaining 10% financial burden will be shared by the six states.

After the signing, Sukhu told reporters, "The central government has in principle agreed that the estimated cost of Rs 2,000 crore on the power component of the state's side will be borne by the beneficiary states of Delhi, Rajasthan and Haryana."

"After the construction of the project, the state will get its share of 1,000 million units per year from the power component, which amounts to over Rs 1,000 crore. This is yet another addition to the state's financial resources... As per earlier calculations, Kishau project was expected to generate an annual income of around Rs 600 crore for Himachal. According to cur-

rent estimates, the state is likely to earn around Rs 1,200 crore annually once the project is completed."

Kishau is one of the three storage projects planned in the upper reaches of river Yamuna and its tributaries following an MoU signed on May 12, 1994 by Yamuna-basin states — undivided Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, and the NCT of Delhi regarding the allocation of Yamuna water.

The other two projects were Lakhwar and Renukaji, for which the MoUs have already been signed and are under implementation.

As per the 1994 MoU, an interim seasonal allocation of the annual utilisable flow of river Yamuna was made among the states. Of the total 11,983 billion cubic metres (BCM) of annual utilisable water of river Yamuna, the maximum allocation of 5,730 BCM was made to Haryana, followed by 4,032 BCM to UP, 1,119 to Rajasthan, 0,724 BCM to Delhi and 0,378 BCM to Himachal Pradesh.

When Uttarakhand was created in 2000, the 4,032 BCM share of water of undivided UP was allocated to UP and Uttarakhand as 3,721 BCM and 0,311 BCM, respectively. The project is planned to be executed through Kishau Corporation Ltd, a Joint Venture between Himachal and Uttarakhand governments.

WITH SAURABH PRASHAR, SHIMLA



CM Suwendu Adhikari in Purba Medinipur on Tuesday. **ANI**

Bypolls a test for minorities: Suwendu; BJP fields slain aide's mother in Nandigram

Atri Mitra
Kolkata, September 15

WITH BJP fielding the mother of his murdered aide from Nandigram, West Bengal CM Suwendu Adhikari Tuesday called the October 6 bypolls in two Assembly seats of the state a "test" for the minority voters and an opportunity for them to decide whether they want to be with his government.

"An opportunity has come before the minorities of Nandigram and Rejinagar to decide whether you want to stay with the government or not," Adhikari said in Nandigram as he accompanied Chandranath Rath's mother, Hasirani Rath, for the filing of nomination.

Chandranath was killed on May 6 days after the Assembly poll results, in which BJP stormed to power. "A historic opportunity has come to be with the government and join hands with the CM to get the work done in our area. If you want to be with the government and secure more opportunities, your test will be on October 6 in Rejinagar and Nandigram. I leave it to you whether you want to pass or fail the test," Adhikari said, who had vacated the Nandigram seat and retained Bhabanipur, necessitating the bypoll there.

The party has fielded its former Murshidabad district chief Sakharav Sarkar from Rejinagar seat, which was vacated by AJUP leader Humayun Kabir.

Asserting that BJP will win the bypolls by a "record" margin, Adhikari said, "I find that many minorities, those who don't vote for me or BJP, have come here." He reiterated that all BJP workers, who had suffered atrocities during TMC rule in Nandigram, would be provided with work, shelter and food.

"It is my responsibility to withdraw false criminal cases instituted against all BJP workers in Nandigram."

Responding to Adhikari's assertion, the Mamata Banerjee-led TMC faction's spokesperson Kunal Ghosh said, "It's not a question of majority or minority; all sections of society have to be won over by development initiatives," he said.

In a veiled reference to TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee and his associates, Adhikari alleged that the 'Bhaipogang' (nephew gang) was behind Chandranath's murder. He alleged that contract killers were paid Rs 2 crore. Adhikari said he had listened to call recordings involving people from Diamond Harbour that clearly pointed to the "bhaipogang", but refused to elaborate since the case is under trial.

LAND GRAB CASE

CID team takes Abhishek's arrested aide for search in house next to his residence

Sweetie Kumari
Kolkata, September 15

A CID team conducted a two-hour search at a property in Kalighat, located adjacent to the residence of TMC MP Abhishek Banerjee, with his personal assistant Sumit Roy, who was arrested last week in connection with his alleged involvement in the Salboni land-grab case.

Around 1pm Tuesday, the

CID team arrived at the property, which according to sources, belongs to Roy.

This comes after the arrest on Monday of three more suspects, Amit Ghosh, Nityananda Roy, and Laxmikanta Bhuiya, who are believed to be linked to the allegedly fraudulent land network. On Tuesday, CID produced Ghosh, Roy, and Bhuiya before the Medinipur CJM court. They were sent to 4-day CID custody.

Jharkhand SIR: Claims, objections deadline extended to September 30

Shubham Tigga
Ranchi, September 15

THE DEADLINE for filing claims and objections under Jharkhand's SIR has been extended for the second and final time, with eligible citizens now getting time until September 30 to seek inclusion or correction in the draft voter list, the CEO's office said on Tuesday.

The initial deadline was September 4, which was extended to September 15, Tuesday.

When draft rolls was published on August 5, the names of 43,61,987 voters were left out under the categories of absent, shifted, dead and duplicate. Of these, 763,903 were classified as dead, 15,92,194 as shifted, 14,50,810 as absent or untraceable and 68,283 as duplicate.

The Election Commission had also said notices would be issued to 63,24,116 voters for hearings as part of the claims and objections process.

2 YRS AFTER BHAGWAT BLAMED OTT FOR 'MORAL CORRUPTION'

'Need something like a censor board': RSS constitutes panel for curbs on OTT 'cultural pollution'

Shyam Lal Yadav
New Delhi, September 15

ABOUT TWO years after Rashtriya Swayamsevak Sangh (RSS) sarsangchalak Mohan Bhagwat called OTT (Over the Top) content a driver of "moral corruption", the Sangh has constituted an informal group to recommend ways to tackle what it terms "cultural pollution" on the video streaming platforms. *The Indian Express* has learnt.

Sources said this panel comprises several members including former vice-chancellors and pracharak engaged in the fields of education and culture.

A source in the RSS said that the panel, set up a few months ago, held its first meeting last month. "This is an informal group and a proposal will be made which will ultimately be submitted to the Union Ministry of Culture and other stakeholders in the central government to deal with the dirt coming out on OTT platforms," the source said. "We need some-

thing like a censor board to deal with this cultural pollution affecting our families and the young generation in particular."

Another source said: "There is no deadline given for the group but before making its proposal, we need wider consultations with the people in the field of law as well."

Bhagwat had targeted OTT content in his annual Vijayadashami address delivered in Nagpur on October 12, 2024. "The kind of things shown on OTT platforms are so disgusting that talking about it too would be indecent... There is a need to regulate it through law because it is also one of the big reasons for moral corruption," the RSS chief had then said, blaming the OTT platforms for alleged "perversion in society".

RSS sources said the move to form the panel was based on feedback from Kutumb Prabodhan, the Sangh activity that seeks to revive traditional family values, strengthen inter-generational bonds and promote social harmony. "Sangh function-

aries view OTT platforms as one of the sources of moral corruption," sources added.

Films shown in theatres are certified by the Central Board of Film Certification (CBFC), commonly known as Censor Board, under the Cinematograph Act, 1952. There is no equivalent regulatory body for OTT content, which is governed mainly by the Information Technology (Intermediary Guidelines and Digital Media Ethics Code) Rules, 2021, and related IT and criminal laws.

Some quarters have repeatedly sought to rake up "gaps in regulatory framework" for OTT content.

On July 22 this year, MoS for Information and Broadcasting L Murugan told Lok Sabha in response to a question that government had disabled 50 OTT platforms for public access in India over two years for displaying obscene content and for alleged violations of the IT Act, section 294 of the BNS, and section 4 of the Indecent Representation of Women (Prohibition) Act, 1986.

EXPRESS special

Inside BJP's plans for Punjab polls: 3 Cs — crime, corruption & chitta

Party looks to keep youth as focal point of its campaign

Jatin Anand
New Delhi, September 15

WITH PUNJAB likely to see Assembly polls in February next year, the BJP is preparing a "comprehensive" campaign that will focus on issues ranging from internal security and terrorism to crime, corruption, drug abuse and unemployment.

The campaign is expected to draw from the BJP's recent electoral experience in Delhi and West Bengal, where the party sought to combine anti-incumbency with middle-class concerns and welfare messaging. In Punjab, however, the party is also looking to place greater emphasis on caste, particularly given the state's Scheduled Caste (SC) population of over 30%.

"Apart from the three Cs — crime, corruption and chitta (drugs) — which will also see the addition of the issue of caste given Punjab's SC population is upwards of 30% — reflections of our successful campaign in Delhi and West Bengal will take shape on the ground in Punjab as well," a senior BJP leader said.

Party insiders said the BJP was looking to make youth a central focus of its campaign, with drug abuse, lack of employment opportunities and what it describes as growing lawlessness likely to figure prominently. The party is also expected to high-



Union Minister Shivraj Singh Chouhan, Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini, Punjab BJP chief Kewal Singh Dhillon and senior party leaders Manpreet Singh Badal and Ashwini Sharma in a show of strength during Rakhar Punniya mela in Amritsar. **RANA SIMRANJIT SINGH**

light what it alleges is an "alarming rise" in extortion cases across the state.

At the same time, the BJP is planning a "positive outreach" around Sant Ravidas, the Dalit saint whose legacy has been a focus of the party's recent national campaign.

"The ongoing national outreach around Sant Ravidasji is a special component of the campaign. Rampant drug abuse and corruption, which neither the ruling AAP nor Congress can defend themselves against, will provide the BJP a significant vantage point against both parties," a senior BJP leader from Punjab said.

The BJP is also seeking to revive its attacks on the Congress over the 1984 anti-Sikh riots. A party leader cited the Congress's support for former party leader Sajjan Kumar as an issue that, in the BJP's assessment, could be used to target the Con-

gress in Punjab.

The AAP government, meanwhile, is likely to face attacks from the BJP over allegations of links with pro-Khalistan elements and the law-and-order situation in the state.

"AAP government will have to answer for its blatant support to Khalistani elements, whom they are garlanding and inducting openly, as well as for the fear among the people due to unbridled extortion which we had never seen before they came to power," another BJP leader said.

Sources said the BJP was currently assessing its electoral prospects and identifying issues that could form the core of its campaign. The party is likely to formally launch its Punjab campaign around Diwali.

The groundwork is also under way for a statewide programme linked to the Centre's "Nasha Mukh Bharat" initiative. The programme, expected to be

held between September 18 and 30, is likely to be led by Union Home Minister Amit Shah.

The BJP's challenge, however, is that it remains a relatively small player in Punjab's electoral politics. In the 2022 Assembly elections, the AAP won 92 of the state's 117 seats, up from 20 in 2017. The Congress was reduced to 18 seats from 77, while the Shiromani Akali Dal (SAD) won three seats, down from 15. The BJP won two seats, compared with three in 2017.

The 2022 polls saw the BJP and SAD contest separately after the latter walked out of the NDA in 2020 over the now-repealed farm laws.

Since SAD president Sukhbir Singh Badal met Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Parliament last month, speculations of the two former allies patching up have gained momentum. Sources within the BJP said the party has weighed the possible alliance in its calculations. "We will get clarity on the tie-up with the SAD by the end of September," a source said.

The Akalis remain an important factor for the BJP given their traditional support among sections of Punjab's panthic electorate, including voters associated with various deras and halqas.

"They (SAD) are keener on an alliance than the BJP but need to walk a fine balance between any sympathy for the Khalistani cause and the popularity of outfits like (Khadoor Sahib MP Amritpal Singh's) Akali Dal Waris Punjab De," a leader said.

Dalit man had paid with his life after raising questions about the availability of drugs that had affected his son.

He also reminded AAP of its national convenor Arvind Kejriwal's election promise that drugs would be eliminated within three months of the party coming to power, saying that more than four years into the government's tenure, the drug menace had only worsened.

"Today, 'chitta' (synthetic drugs) is being delivered home. You make a phone call and it is reaching every home," Pilot alleged. Congress demanded Chema's removal as well as an independent probe into Gulzar Singh's death.

own life because of this person'. Does the law not say there should be an investigation, there should be an FIR?" Pilot said.

Taking a swipe at AAP's promise of empowering Dalits, Pilot said the party had announced a Deputy CM from the Scheduled Caste before forming the government but had failed to protect vulnerable community in the state.

"What to speak of a Dalit Deputy CM, Dalits like Gulzar Singh are forced to die by suicide under the AAP regime," he said.

Pilot said Gulzar Singh's death reflected the gap between the AAP government's claims and the situation on the ground, alleging that a poor

Sachin Pilot said Gulzar Singh's death reflected the gap between AAP government's claims and the situation on the ground

mity" with Cheema but questioned why an FIR had not been registered when a dying declaration allegedly named the minister. "We have no personal enmity with Cheema sahib. But you are sitting in office, you are the finance minister. A man is taking his life and making a video saying that 'I am taking my

cross barricades, with several Congress leaders, including former MLA Kuljit Singh Nagra, sustaining injuries. Pilot, Punjab Congress president Amarinder Singh Raja Warring, Leader of Opposition Partap Singh Bajwa and other senior leaders were subsequently detained.

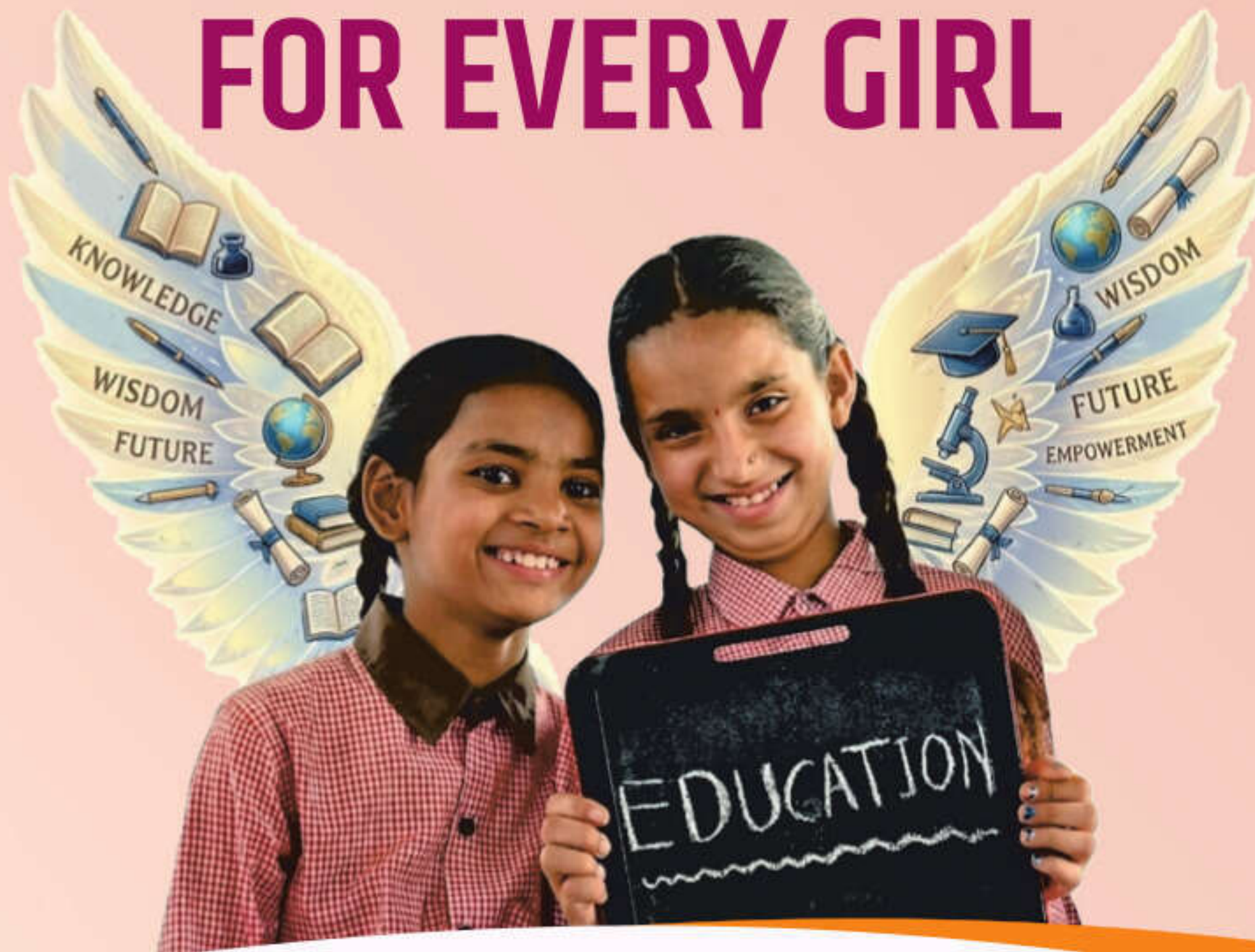
Congress has alleged that Gulzar Singh, from Dirba in Sangrur district, was driven to suicide after being harassed and subjected to casteist slurs for questioning Cheema over the availability of drugs in his area. Singh died on September 7 after allegedly consuming poison.

Addressing party workers before the march, Pilot said the Congress had "no personal en-



UTTAR PRADESH

FROM EDUCATION TO EMPOWERMENT FOR EVERY GIRL



Under the leadership of Chief Minister Yogi Adityanath, girls' education in Uttar Pradesh has become a comprehensive social movement. The government has built an entire ecosystem of opportunities for daughters through schemes such as Kasturba Gandhi Balika Vidyalayas, Mission Shakti, Meena Manch, PM Shri Vidyalayas, and the Right to Education Act. Figures like the upgrade of 746 Kasturba schools, active Meena Manch forums in 45,656 schools, self-defense training for over 10.78 lakh girls, and free education for more than 5 lakh children stand as proof of the Chief Minister's visionary policy and strong resolve. As a result, lakhs of girls are moving toward a safe, educated, and self-reliant future.

SPORTS, LEADERSHIP AND CONFIDENCE

- Under the "One KGBV-One Sport" policy, 504 girls competed at state level and 24 at national level (2025-26)
- Regular activities like birthday celebrations, alumni meets, exposure visits, and personality development programs



MISSION SHAKTI A SHIELD OF SAFETY AND SELF-DEFENSE

- Poster competitions, street plays, awareness rallies, Meena Diwas
- Bank visits, police station visits, cyber security awareness, helpline information
- Self-defense training, interactive sessions with women officers
- Active participation of lakhs of students, teachers, and parents



MEENA MANCH: A PLATFORM FOR SOCIAL AWARENESS



- Meena Manch active in 45,656 upper primary schools
- Focus on leadership skills, gender equality, life skills, and self-esteem
- 10,78,402 girls trained under Rani Laxmibai self-defense training in 38,465 schools
- 54,347 teachers given special training in life-skills education



KASTURBA GANDHI BALIKA VIDYALAYAS

THE FOUNDATION OF SAFE EDUCATION



- 746 schools upgraded to cover classes 6 to 12
- Smart classes, ICT labs, computer labs, online attendance systems
- CCTV cameras, modern kitchens, solar geysers, open gyms, and sports facilities
- Free residential education for girls from marginalized, SC/ST, OBC, and minority families

DIGITAL EDUCATION AND FINANCIAL LITERACY

- Digital learning in math and science in collaboration with Khan Academy
- UNICEF-backed 'Pankh' career guidance portal
- 57,412 girls trained and certified in digital and financial literacy



PM SHRI SCHOOLS SPECIAL FOCUS ON HEALTH AND DIGNITY

- Career guidance fairs, mother-daughter parent meets, and Meena fairs in 1,129 schools
- Distribution of self-defense kits and menstrual hygiene management programs
- Free sanitary pads provided to the girls; menstrual hygiene clubs formed



RIGHT TO EDUCATION (RTE) Removing Economic Barriers



- 1,40,784 children admitted to private schools in the 2025-26 session
- 5,12,040 children benefiting from free education; ₹276 crore reimbursed to private schools
- 4,44,771 applications received for 2026-27; 1,95,740 seats allotted, 1,49,783 admissions completed

PUBLIC NOTICE

I, G. Mahesh (जी महेश), S/o S. Ganapathy (Subramanyam Ganapathy), Date of Birth (08 July 1967), hereby declare that I had changed/adopted my name from G. Mahesh (जी महेश) to Mohan Rupa Das (मोहन रूप दास) approximately 30 years ago. Since then, I have been known and using the name Mohan Rupa Das (मोहन रूप दास). The name G. Mahesh (जी महेश) appearing in my old educational records and the name Mohan Rupa Das (मोहन रूप दास) appearing in my present identity/official documents refer to one and the same person, namely myself. The newspaper publication/ documentary record relating to the name change made approximately 30 years ago is presently not available with me. I hereby declare and affirm that my present and commonly used name is: MOHAN RUPA DAS (मोहन रूप दास) and I shall hereafter use Mohan Rupa Das (मोहन रूप दास) for all purposes, records, documents and legal transactions.

Old Name: G. Mahesh (जी महेश)
Present Name: Mohan Rupa Das (मोहन रूप दास)
Father's Name: S. Ganapathy (Subramanyam Ganapathy)
Date of Birth: 08 July 1967
Address:

Mohan Rupa Das
(Previously known as G. Mahesh)

कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, सुनिट-30
कन्स्ट्रक्शन एण्ड डिजाइन सर्विसेज
उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), की
(उपग्रो सरकार का उपक्रम)
मकान सं-02/43 आवास विकास निक्ट
एल. आई.सी. बिल्डिंग, शाहजहाँपुर।
E-mail id: pmunit30spn@gmail.com

पत्रांक: 2028/E-Tender/285
दिनांक: 15.09.2026

ई-निविदा सूचना

उत्तर प्रदेश जल निगम (नगरीय), की ओर से अयोध्याखरी द्वारा Construction Of Office Building At nagar Panchayat Rudayan Distt Budaan अनु. लागत ₹ 178.50 लाख, हेतु दिनांक 13.10.2026 को अपराह्न 16:00 बजे तक ई-निविदाएं आमन्त्रित की जाती हैं। उक्त कार्य हेतु ई-निविदा प्रार्थ दिनांक 16.09.2026 से दिनांक 13.10.2026 के मध्य उत्तर प्रदेश सरकार की e-procurement की वेबसाइट <https://etender.up.nic.in> से डाउनलोड किये जा सकते हैं तथा ई-निविदा प्रार्थ दिनांक 14.10.2026 को अपराह्न 16:30 बजे कार्यालय परियोजना प्रबन्धक, सुनिट-30, सी. एण्ड डी.एस., उ.प्र. जल निगम (नगरीय), शाहजहाँपुर में खोली जायेगी। ई-निविदा प्रार्थ का मूल्य ₹10000.00 + GST (18%) अतिरिक्त देय होगा।

निविदा से सम्बन्धित विस्तृत विवरण विभाग की वेबसाइट www.cdsupin.org एवं प्रोक्योरमेंट पोर्टल <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर उपलब्ध है। समस्त शुद्धि पत्र (Corrigendum) <https://etender.up.nic.in> पर ही अपलोड किये जायेंगे, इनका पृथक से कोई प्रकाशन नहीं किया जायेगा। निविदायाताओं को सलाह दी जाती है कि वे उक्त वेबसाइट का समय-समय पर अवलोकन करते रहें।



Noida Power Company Limited
Electric Sub Station, Knowledge Park-IV, Greater Noida-201310
(CIN: U31200UP1992PLC014506)

TENDER NOTICE Date: 16-09-2026

E Tender (Commercial & Technical) are invited for following job from all interested bidders

NIT No.	Tender Description	EMD (Rs.)	Start and Due Date & Time of Submission
NPCL/FY26-27/AI wound DTR/031 Dated 16.09.2026	RATE CONTRACT OF SUPPLY OF ALUMINIUM WOUND DTR	5.00 Lac	16.09.2026 & 30.09.2026 (up to 15:00 hours)

Cost of Individual Tender Document (Incl. GST) Rs 1180/-
For other tender details and further amendment/corrigendum, please visit our website www.noidapower.com→Procurement→Tenders

DGM (CMM)



नरेन्द्र मोदी
प्रधानमंत्री



रेखा गुप्ता
मुख्यमंत्री, दिल्ली

दिल्ली सरकार द्वारा आयोजित

महा रक्तदान शिविर

आइए, अधिक से अधिक संख्या में रक्तदान करें और मानव कल्याण, जीवन कल्याण के इस पुनीत कार्य में सहभागी बनें।

17 सितंबर 2026

⌚ सुबह 08:00 बजे से शाम 5:00 बजे तक

📍 त्यागराज स्टेडियम, नई दिल्ली

Pregnant UP woman dies after cops ‘shove’ her

Manish Sahu

Lucknow, September 15

A PREGNANT woman died after her husband was taken away by police from their home in UP's Firozabad for question-

ing in a robbery case, with her family alleging she was shoved when she tried to stop them.

Six policemen, including two sub-inspectors, have been suspended for negligence. Police also maintained that a preliminary inquiry found no evidence of any physical action against the 28-year-old woman. The incident took place on Sunday night.

According to police, a theft had taken place at a grocery shop in Labhaua village on Friday night. During probe, police suspected the involvement of two men, including Gaurav

Kumar, from the village and a team from Shikohabad police station went to pick him up.

Gaurav's elder brother, Vijay Singh, claimed, "Gaurav's wife, Anjali Verma, who was eight months pregnant pleaded with them not to take her husband away, citing her condition."

Vijay alleged she was pushed during a scuffle "after which her condition worsened and was taken to a government hospital, where she gave birth... Her condition deteriorated and she was shifted to a private hospital... where she died during treatment," Vijay said.

Detention can't rest on mere labels: J&K court on man labelled as 'Lashkar OGW'

Bashaarat Masood

Srinagar, September 15

SAYING THAT "preventive detention can't rest upon mere labels", the Jammu and Kashmir High Court has quashed the Public Safety Act (PSA) invoked against a South Kashmir resident on charges of being an "OGW (overground worker) of the Lashkar-e-Taiba".

Noting that the petitioner has already been granted bail, the court said, "Preventive detention cannot rest upon mere labels. The authority must disclose the factual position which connects the alleged activities of the detenu with the statutory purpose for which the extraordinary power is exercised."

Quashing the PSA against Ishfaq Ahmad Wani, Justice M A Chowdhary also observed in his order, "A bald assertion that a person is an 'OGW' or that his activities are prejudicial to the security of the State/UT of J&K, without sufficient particulars enabling him to understand what precisely weighed with the detaining authority, does not meet the constitutional standard."

Wani, a resident of Srigufwara in Anantnag, was booked under the PSA in April last year. In the police dossier and the grounds of detention, Wani was shown as a Lashkar OGW, and it was alleged that his "activities are prejudicial to the security of the state".

While Wani's side had argued that the basis of detention was a case against him in which he had already been granted bail by the court, the respondents argued that "preventive detention is a distinct jurisdiction which can be invoked notwithstanding the pendency of criminal proceedings or the availability of the ordinary criminal law".

While calling preventive detention an "exceptional encroachment upon the cherished rights of personal liberty guaranteed in Article 21 of the Constitution", the court ob-

served that preventive detention is "not punitive".

"Its object is not to punish a person for an act already committed but to prevent him from engaging in conduct which is apprehended to be prejudicial to the security of the State/UT of J&K or maintenance of public order, as the case may be," observed Justice Chowdhary in his judgment.

The court said that while the subjective satisfaction of the detaining authority is undoubtedly entitled to due weight, such satisfaction is not wholly immune from judicial scrutiny.

"The court can examine whether the satisfaction has been arrived at on the basis of relevant material, whether the authority has applied its mind to such material, whether irrelevant or extraneous material has been taken into consideration and whether there exists a live and proximate link between the antecedent conduct and the necessity for preventive detention," it said.

Justice Chowdhary observed that the then District Magistrate, Anantnag, had not applied his mind while passing the detention order. "What emerges is that FIR has been relied upon in support of the detention, although the said criminal case had admittedly culminated in grant of bail by the competent court of law," the court observed.

Though the respondents argued that the petitioner's representation was rejected by the government, the court observed that mere rejection of the representation cannot cure an otherwise invalid detention order.

The court said that though the permissible scope of judicial review in preventive detention is not to determine the truth or otherwise of the allegations contained in the police dossier, it is duty-bound to ascertain whether the statutory and constitutional safeguards have been observed and whether the subjective satisfaction is founded upon relevant, proximate and duly considered material.

Vaishnav flags off India's first salt container train operating in Gujarat

Press Trust of India
Ahmedabad, September 15

RAILWAY MINISTER Ashwini Vaishnav on Tuesday flagged off India's first salt container train that will operate between Shivalakha in Gujarat's Kutch to Mithapur in the state, with a special stainless steel container being used to transport this essential kitchen staple.

The minister also dedicated via video conference Gati Shakti Cargo Terminals (GCT) at Bhimasar (Kutch), Devaliya (Junagadh), Chandisar (Banskantha) and Shivalakha (Kutch), to the nation and laid the foundation stone for the GCT at Linch in Mehsana via video conference.

"When the salt produced in Kutch and other parts of Gujarat was transported to every corner of the country by filling it into railway wagons, the weight of the wagon was more than the weight of the salt. Also, the salt has a tendency to absorb moisture, so by the time the salt reaches its destination, it would become wet," he said.

A special stainless steel container has been developed for transporting salt. The use of stainless steel also achieves the required balance, he said.

Sanjukta Parasor is first woman officer to lead CRPF's CoBRA unit

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

SENIOR IPS officer Sanjukta Parasor, also known as the "Iron Lady of Assam" for her counter-insurgency work in the Northeast, has taken charge as Inspector General of the Central Reserve Police Force's elite CoBRA unit, becoming the first woman officer to head the specialised jungle-warfare force.

Parasor, a 2006-batch IPS officer of the Assam-Meghalaya cadre, brings to the post extensive experience in counter-insurgency operations, field policing and national security investigations.

The CRPF headquarters issued the appointment order last week. Parasor succeeds 1996-batch IPS officer Danesh Rana as the IG, CoBRA. "This is the first time that the 10-battalion-strong CoBRA of the CRPF will be headed by a woman officer," a senior officer said. Two CoBRA units were recently deployed by the CRPF to check armed violence in Manipur.

Parasor's appointment is being seen as significant at a time when security forces are facing complex operational challenges in forests, hilly ter-

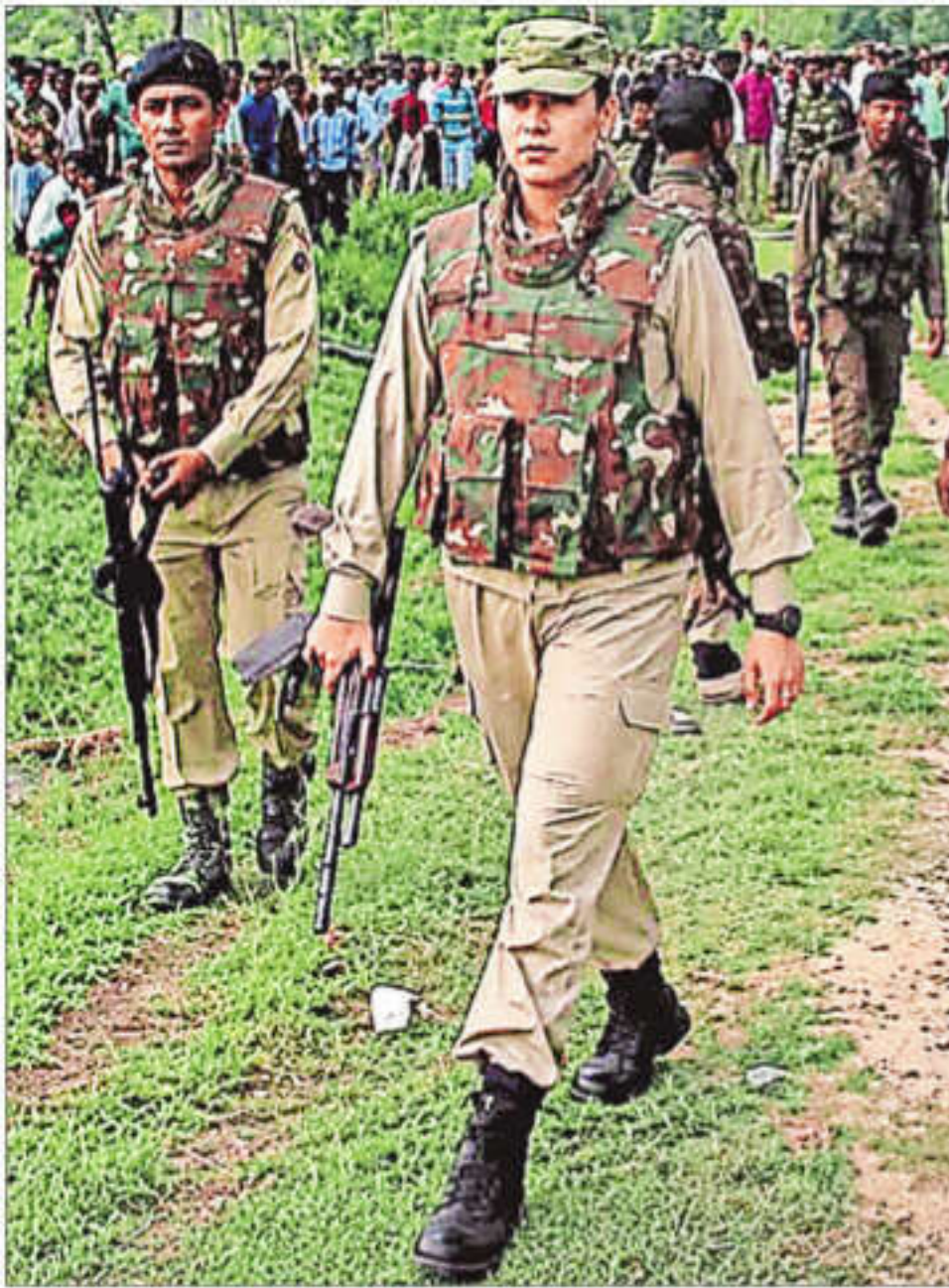
rain, border regions and areas affected by armed extremist groups.

CoBRA, or Commando Battalion for Resolute Action, is one of CRPF's most specialised operational formations. Raised for high-risk missions in jungle and guerrilla warfare environments, the force is trained for long-range patrols, intelligence-based operations, ambushes, counter-ambushes and operations in areas where improvised explosive devices pose a major threat.

The force has been deployed extensively in anti-Maoist operations across Chhattisgarh, Jharkhand, Odisha and Maharashtra, where commandos operate in dense forests and difficult terrain. Officials said CoBRA's work requires officers with strong field orientation, operational judgement and the ability to coordinate closely with other security agencies.

The Ministry of Home Affairs (MHA) credits the battalion's commandos with successful intelligence-based jungle warfare and guerrilla operations against Naxals, which led to the end of Maoist violence in the country this March.

Parasor's career has closely mirrored these requirements.



A 2006-batch IPS officer, Sanjukta Parasor is known as 'Iron Lady of Assam' for her counter-insurgency work in the Northeast. FACEBOOK

During her early postings in Assam, she served in insurgency-affected areas and

handled assignments involving armed militant groups, volatile law-and-order situations and

difficult terrain. Her work in these areas, particularly her active role in field operations, earned her public recognition and the title "Iron Lady of Assam".

Images of Parasor on social media carrying an AK-47 while accompanying security personnel during counter-insurgency operations had earlier drawn national attention.

Colleagues and observers have often noted that her reputation was built not merely on public perception but on sustained work in areas where policing required both endurance and tactical awareness.

Her first posting came in 2008, when she served as an Assistant Commandant in Makum, Assam.

Parasor's professional profile also includes experience with the National Investigation Agency, where she served as a Deputy Inspector General.

A strong academic record preceded Parasor's career in policing.

She studied political science at Indraprastha College for Women, Delhi University, before pursuing higher studies in International Relations at Jawaharlal Nehru University. She completed her MPhil and PhD in US foreign policy.

BRIEFLY



Manoj Jarange Patil's application seeking permission to protest at Azad Maidan was rejected. He has submitted another one. EXPRESS

MAHARASHTRA

Jarange leaves for Mumbai, CM says protest plea to be decided on merit

MARATHA ACTIVIST Manoj Jarange Patil on Tuesday left Antarwali-Sarati village for Mumbai, where he is expected to reach on September 19, even as Chief Minister Devendra Fadnavis said police will decide on his application to hold a protest in the city "on merit", stressing that law and order cannot be compromised, particularly during the ongoing Ganesh festival. Fadnavis said the police had rejected the protestors' first application seeking permission to agitate at Azad Maidan. He added that a second application has since been submitted and will be considered by the police. "Maintaining law and order is the right and duty of the police. The decision on the second application will be taken on merit," Fadnavis told reporters at Mantralaya. ENS

4 of family die in fridge explosion in Karnataka

FOUR WOMEN members of a family were killed and two others were seriously injured after a refrigerator reportedly exploded at their house early Tuesday, police said. The incident occurred in Chavat Galli, they said. According to police, preliminary information revealed that the fire reportedly broke out after a refrigerator exploded inside the house. The flames quickly spread throughout the premises, trapping the occupants inside. The father has suffered around 80 per cent of burn injuries, while his son sustained around 40 per cent burn injuries. PTI

Former Andhra deputy CM dies of heart attack

FORMER ANDHRA Pradesh deputy CMA Kali Krishna Srinivas, popularly known as Alla Nani, died on Tuesday due to a heart attack, and TDP leaders, including Chief Minister N Chandrababu Naidu condoled the death. Srinivas was 56. "The sudden demise of Alla Nani Garu (Kali Krishna Srinivas), former Deputy CM of Andhra Pradesh state, has deeply shocked me. It is heartbreaking that he passed away due to a heart attack at the young age of 56," CM Naidu said in a 'X' post. "I express my profound condolences to his family. I pray to God that his soul attains eternal peace." PTI

University meant for dissent... If you suppress that, how will it remain a university: Justice Dhulia

Aamir Khan
New Delhi, September 15

RETIRED SUPREME Court judge Justice Sudhanshu Dhulia has strongly defended the right of students to protest, saying, "A university is meant to raise dissenting voices."

Asked about Supreme Court judge Justice Ujjal Bhuyan's remarks terming threats of punitive action against students asking questions as "unconstitutional" and "a misuse of power", Justice Dhulia told *The Indian Express*: "University to dissent *ke liye hoti hai* (A university is a place meant for dissent)... Why should you punish dissenting students? Imagine the day you enter a university. Don't you find a difference from your school life?... It is for the first time when you enter a college or a university that critical thinking is developed."

The Supreme Court recently used its extraordinary powers under Article 142 of the Constitution to quash FIRs registered across the country against students who participated in the protests over exam paper leaks, spearheaded by the agitation at Jantar Mantar.

Justice Dhulia said: "If students in a university are dissenting, or standing in support and solidarity with something, against oppression, it speaks volumes about the awakening... *Agar aap isko daba doge, toh phir university university kahan rahegi* (If you suppress it, how will a university remain a university?)"

However, the judge who during his three years in the apex court was known for his liberal stance on cases, said: "A line has to be drawn between dissent and outright disruption or things like that, or crossing a line."

Justice Dhulia added that he was also in favour of doing away with the sedition law. "My grandfather was charged with sedition... The old colonial laws should be given up."

On judicial appointments, Justice Dhulia, who was part of a Supreme Court Bench that questioned the government over "delay" on the issue, said he backed more openness. While the collegium system is working, he said, "Some changes are needed in the manner in which judges are recommended to high courts and the Supreme Court". "Some changes are required;



Retired Supreme Court judge Justice Sudhanshu Dhulia

some transparency is required. But that is a subject for a larger discussion and debate".

At the same time, he stressed: "These appointments should not be delayed. Once a collegium recommends certain names, unless the government has very strong reasons, some reports against the judge, in normal circumstances, they should not be stopped."

One of the notable cases heard by Justice Dhulia was on the right of a student to wear hijab to school, after the Karnataka High Court upheld the then BJP state government's ban on it. Part of a two-judge Bench that gave a split verdict, Justice Dhulia approached the case through the lens of choice and access to

education, saying that "a girl child has the right to wear hijab in her house or outside her house, and that right does not stop at her school gate".

Asked about a recent order of the Allahabad High Court, where he practised as a lawyer, rejecting a student's plea to wear a hijab to school, Justice Dhulia said his hijab order was "primarily based on a fundamental Constitutional value called tolerance". "I am not in favour of hijab perse, because I would not like my daughter to wear it. But if she wants to wear a hijab, I'll be the last person to stop her. The emphasis here is on the choice of women whether to wear or reject a hijab... I respectfully disagree with the view taken by the Allahabad High Court."

On the contentious issue of death penalty, Justice Dhulia, who was on the Supreme Court Bench that referred the question of framing strict guidelines for mitigating circumstances in death penalty cases to a Constitution Bench, said: "As long as we have the death penalty in our laws, you can't say that it cannot be given."

While he had himself never given a death penalty or upheld

a death sentence, he added, "there is no grey area about what constitutes the rarest of rare cases" to warrant one. "It is well chalked out. No judge has any confusion about it... (But) When you sentence a person, that takes the entire experience, the judicial acumen of a judge. You can't fix a rule for that; otherwise, judicial discretion will go away."

On controversies generated due to observations made by judges in court, Justice Dhulia regretted that often comments "which are not even for public consumption, which have nothing to do with the order" get blown up by the media. He said "sometimes it becomes very disturbing for judges also". On whether there is any impact of this on court proceedings, Justice Dhulia said: "I don't think any judge is on social media... But their friends are there... *Kuch prabhav padhta hai* (There is some impact, no doubt)."

Justice Dhulia added that he was not in favour of court proceedings becoming live "because we are actually not prepared for that". "Sometimes things are said in a manner relevant for a particular moment."

Supreme Court indicates no relief for suspended Punjab DIG

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

TALKING TOUGH on the graft charges against suspended Punjab Police Deputy Inspector General (DIG) Harcharan Singh Bhullar, the Supreme Court Tuesday indicated that it may reject his bail plea in a corruption case registered by the Central Bureau of Investigation (CBI).

"100 per cent case of dismissal. You want (us) to dismiss it now or later?" Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, presiding over a three-judge bench, stated while adjourning the hearing on Bhullar's appeal.

The bench, also comprising Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, deferred the matter for four weeks, stating it will hear the plea after the examination of key witnesses. Bhullar's appeal challenges the August 10 order of the Punjab and Haryana High Court, which had dismissed his second bail application.

The case originates from an FIR registered on a complaint by one Akash Batta. He alleged that Bhullar, then posted as DIG, Ropar Range, demanded a bribe through a private intermediary, Krishanu Sharda, in exchange for not taking coercive action against his business regarding a case registered at the Sirhind police station.

On October 16, 2025, the central agency laid a trap and apprehended Krishanu while he was allegedly accepting Rs 5 lakh as part of the bribe from Batta. Bhullar was arrested the same day. Raids on Bhullar's premises reportedly yielded over Rs 7 crore in cash along with other valuables. The Punjab Vigilance Bureau is currently investigating a separate disproportionate assets case.

On January 23, the Ministry of Home Affairs granted sanction to prosecute the 2009-batch IPS officer under corruption and criminal conspiracy charges.

Cheque bounce cases: SC breather for Rajpal Yadav

Ananthakrishnan G
New Delhi, September 15

THE SUPREME Court Tuesday allowed Bollywood actor Rajpal Yadav's request for a "last opportunity" to deposit Rs 2 crore with its registry as part payment toward clearing dues owed to a production house.

A three-judge bench, presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant, also extended Yadav's interim protection from surrendering until October 5 in connection with cheque bounce cases in which the Delhi High Court sentenced him to three months' imprisonment. The Supreme Court had previously granted Yadav exemption from surrendering on the condition that he deposit Rs 5 crore with its registry.

CJI Kant said that the actor's past conduct in the matter failed to inspire confidence. "The thing is, he is an actor. He is perfect in doing drama and acting in Bollywood. We hope he is not acting here also."

During the hearing, Senior Advocate P S Patwalia, appearing for Yadav alongside Justices Joymalya Bagchi and V Mohana, informed the bench that



Rajpal Yadav

the actor had been unable to raise the requisite funds. He urged the court to grant two more weeks as a final chance.

The senior counsel stated that Yadav plans to dispose of some immovable properties belonging to his mother to raise the money.

"Kindly grant him some breathing time," Patwalia argued, pointing to earlier instalments Yadav had paid. He noted that the complainants ultimately want to see the "colour of money" and assured the bench that he would not defend the actor if he fails to honour his commitment within two weeks. Yadav also appeared before the bench via video conferencing. The bench has posted the matter for hearing next on October 5.

Rs 12-cr Mathura jewellery store heist: Former employee, kin held

Manish Sahu
Lucknow, September 15

AROUND 9.30 PM on Sunday, a lone figure dressed in black snuck into Jugal Kishore Jewellers in Mathura's Kosi Kalan through the roof and remained inside for nearly eight hours.

By the time he slipped out at 5.30 am, 7 kg of gold worth Rs 12 crore and nearly Rs 11 lakh in cash were gone — along with the shop's CCTV Digital Video Recorder (DVR).

On Tuesday evening, police arrested the accused, former employee Vishnu alias Pappu Soni, 27, as well as three others who allegedly helped him hide the loot — his brother Mohan, 22, his 26-year-old sister and 54-year-old mother — from Gopalbagh in Kosi Kalan.

Police said they recovered all the stolen items.

Deputy Inspector General of Police, Mathura, Shailesh Pandey, said Vishnu was the person who entered the showroom and fled with the jewellery. Police said he used to work at the store but was fired around a year ago following allegations



CCTV footage shows the accused leaving through a neighbouring house. SPECIAL ARRANGEMENT

of financial irregularities.

Officers said he opened a small jewellery shop near his home in Ramnagar but decided to take revenge.

According to police, he reached the double-storey shop's terrace by scaling the boundary wall of a neighbouring house and crossing several interconnected rooftops.

Vishnu then used a gas cutter to cut through an iron grille, officers said.

He then climbed down, entered the shop, and broke the lock of a room where the safe was kept. Police said Soni then allegedly took gold ornaments. The accused then retraced

his route: police said he went to the terrace, crossed to the neighbouring rooftop, descended into the house below, and left through the main gate.

The theft had come to light after the owner opened the store on Monday morning.

With the shop's DVR missing, police scoured 100 CCTV cameras installed nearby.

One of the cameras showed Soni carrying two bags and hiring an e-rickshaw early morning. Police found he went to the railway station, from where he went untraceable.

After more camera footage, they finally found a lead that helped them trace Vishnu.

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With price pressures, a strong case for rate hike

RETAIL INFLATION, as measured by the consumer price index, edged up to 4.8 per cent in August from 4.45 per cent in July, as per the latest data from the National Statistics Office. Price pressures are being felt across food and non-food categories. The disaggregated data shows that inflation in the food segment rose to 5.95 per cent, driven in part by items such as onion, ginger, and garlic. Core inflation, which excludes volatile food and fuel prices, has also risen. Inflation was elevated in the personal care and miscellaneous goods and services segment. Higher food and fuel costs seem to have pushed up prices in the hospitality sector. Wholesale inflation rose to 9.92 per cent in August, up from 9.78 per cent in July. All this seems to suggest that price pressures are getting broad-based. As per a study by economists at SBI, “data till August indicates that the process of inflation getting generalised has started”.

There is uncertainty over food prices. Crisil's Deficient Rainfall Impact Parameter (DRIP) suggests “elevated vulnerability in cotton, bajra, maize, tur, groundnut and soybean.” Global energy prices have also surged following the escalation in the West Asia crisis after the Houthi strikes on Saudi Arabia. Brent crude oil is currently hovering around \$106 per barrel. The price of the Indian crude oil basket has surged to \$128.7 per barrel as on September 14, up from \$90.2 in August, as per the Petroleum Planning and Analysis Cell. Higher fuel prices will spill over, even if partially, into the broader economy. Inflation is expected to continue to edge up. The RBI has projected CPI at 5.9 per cent in the year's third quarter. Ratings agency ICRA expects inflation to harden to around 6 per cent during October-November, while SBI economists believe that inflation could cross the 6.5 per cent mark, breaching the upper threshold of the central bank's inflation targeting framework.

In August, the Monetary Policy Committee had kept a status quo, keeping the repo rate at 5.25 per cent and the stance at neutral. However, given its expectations — it has projected inflation at 5.7 per cent in the year's second half and 5.3 per cent in the next financial year's first quarter — real interest rates are mildly negative on a forward basis. With resilient growth, broad-based price pressures strengthen the case for a rate hike, even as the RBI works to withdraw excess liquidity from the system.

West Bengal's wrong path to academic excellence

THE PASSAGE of the West Bengal Universities and Colleges (Administration and Regulation) (Amendment) Bill, 2026, sets a troubling precedent for higher education in the state. While the previous law allowed the transfer of teaching and non-teaching staff between colleges under the same university, the legislation empowers the state to move teaching and non-teaching employees between state universities, ostensibly to distribute experienced personnel more evenly across weaker or newer universities to help create new “centres of excellence”. But appointments, academic responsibilities and institutional affiliations are tied to the character of universities. Faculty strength, for instance, is a major criterion for NAAC accreditation. By making it conditional on government discretion — the CM has said the legislation will balance university autonomy with accountability to the government — the law risks weakening institutional independence and teaching quality.

Public universities in the state have, for years, been mired in governance-related disputes, from questions over the Governor's role as chancellor to prolonged vacancies in vice-chancellor positions and disagreements over appointments. The intra-university transfer provision adds to that history by giving the executive broad power without setting out clear criteria. The state Assembly has, in parallel, passed the West Bengal University Laws (Amendment) Bill, 2026, bringing the provident funds of employees of 21 state universities under an existing 1983 framework. These changes make clarity over service conditions and retirement-related entitlements when employees move between institutions all the more important.

Teachers' associations have protested the legislation on several grounds, including the infringement of autonomy. Vacancies exceed half of the sanctioned strength across state universities; in Calcutta University alone, over 40 per cent of teaching posts reportedly lie unfilled. Many universities announced during the second term of the Trinamool Congress government in 2017-18 have no permanent campuses or adequate infrastructure. Redeploying staff will merely redistribute an existing shortage, not address the deficit that has chipped away at the state's once-formidable higher education system. The fear of “punishment postings” also gives young academics one more reason to leave Bengal's public system altogether, for private universities and opportunities in other states, or overseas. The state requires sustained investment in filling vacancies, adequate grants, and governance structures that outlast electoral cycles. The path to centres of excellence lies not in making them more dependent on the executive but in creating conditions under which universities can attract, retain and inspire talent for the long haul.

The gibbon's song, the noise of man

IN THE jungle, the sound of silence is a cacophony. A chorus of insects, birds, mammals and reptiles talk within and across species, often to each other's benefit. The dark lar, or white-handed gibbon, is a particularly adept vocalist, and its range has been compared to an opera singer's. Like the langurs of the Subcontinent, the white-handed gibbon's calls communicate among members of a troupe and also serve as an alarm for approaching predators and intruders for other species. Unfortunately, the soprano of the simians is singing less.

A report in *The Guardian* about research by an international team on the dark lar in Malaysia shows how the animal is less vocal when it is close to human settlements. A growing body of research shows how the constant noise from “civilisation” is affecting animals. In the case of social animals like the gibbon, their silence in response to traffic could affect their community life. The greater impact may be on other species that rely on the dark lar's call as an alarm.

In the jungle, the monkey warns the deer, the vulture and dung beetle keep things running. Of course, there is no going back to a kind of nature without human influence. And people need to live, work and travel — the noise of man is its own sign of life. In some tragedies, there are no villains. And if the gibbon stops singing, it would be tragic indeed.



RAJA MANDALA
BY C RAJA MOHAN

AFTER THE BRICS summit in New Delhi, global geopolitical attention shifts to Washington, where Chinese leader Xi Jinping is headed next week. If “multipolarity” was the theme song in Delhi, “bipolarity” will be the signature tune in Washington. The second meeting between presidents Donald Trump and Xi this year is part of an intensive series of exchanges. After Washington, Trump and Xi are likely to meet in Shenzhen, China, on the margins of the APEC summit. If the current buzz of a trilateral summit proves real, Russia's Vladimir Putin could join Trump and Xi there. The focus would then turn from a G2 to a possible G3 world. Further opportunities for great-power diplomacy could present themselves in Miami, where Trump hosts the annual G20 summit in December.

Many of these multilateral gatherings, such as BRICS, APEC, and G20, are routine annual affairs. Despite the political glamour attached to these events in Delhi, significant collective progress in these meetings is rare. But these forums are useful venues where critical bilateral meetings take place. The highlight of the Delhi BRICS summit, for example, was the attempted reset of India-China relations by Prime

Minister Narendra Modi and President Xi.

What gives the multilateral summits some salience this year is the churn in great-power politics triggered by Trump's disruption of US foreign policy, relations with allies and rivals, and the American approach to the burdens of international order. Underlying that churn is the more important structural change in the distribution of global power in favour of China and America.

Both BRICS and the G7 are increasingly marked by the overwhelming economic weight of a single power — China in the first and the United States in the second. China accounted for less than half of BRICS' combined GDP when the original BRIC forum with four members was formed in 2006. Despite subsequent enlargement to eleven members, China now accounts for roughly three-fifths. Whether we like it or not, Beijing continues to outgrow BRICS in economic size and geopolitical influence.

The G7 has seen a comparable shift. America now accounts for close to three-fifths of the group's nominal output, against less than two-fifths three decades ago. Japan's stagnation, Europe's weaker growth and demographic pressures, and American advantages in energy, capital markets and artificial intelligence have widened the gap. Trump's willingness to turn harshly on America's closest partners — whether Canada or Britain in the Anglosphere or NATO and the EU — rests, in part, on this expanding American economic preponderance.

Does China's dominance in BRICS and America's preponderance in the G7 mean we are headed to a G2 world? Not necessarily. But it

Organisations like the APEC, BRICS, EU, G7 and NATO don't shape the world order. They operate within the parameters set by great-power politics

Don't let borders blind us to Himalayan risks



SRINIVAS CHOKKAKULA

THE FURY of the floods in Nepal, with the shocking social-media visuals, has made GLOF — Glacial Lake Outburst Flood — almost a viral hashtag. Emerging evidence suggests the floods were not technically caused by GLOF, but were the result of an avalanche that turned into a cascading debris-flow hazard. Instead of repeating the clichéd clarion calls about nature taking notice of the Anthropocene, we may be better off paying attention to something more elementary — geography.

The spectacle calls for a kind of geographical revanchism — a reassertion of South Asia as a geographical and ecological region, rather than a collection of disparate political territories. GLOFs know no borders. Our responses cannot be geography-blind. The manner in which the disaster unfolded should shake the territorial imaginations that we often hold onto when we engage with our neighbourhood. Rivers are central to South Asia's geographical imagination. They cannot just be seen as sources of water to be allocated; they are also carriers of shared risks. The origins of the GLOF in northern Nepal meant that it bore much of the immediate brunt. But India shouldn't be complacent.

India has experienced similar incidents, with implications for its water security. In 2014, a landslide over the same river, Bhote Koshi, led to the creation of a lake impounded by the landslide. India collaborated with Nepal to breach the lake in a controlled manner to reduce the downstream impact. In 2023, the South Lhonak GLOF in Sikkim again demonstrated the speed and scale with which Himalayan hazards can have cascading impacts across settlements and critical infrastructure.

We tend to underestimate the costs of these incidents and do not account for how they can set infrastructure, livelihoods and development trajectories back by several steps. Repeated disruptions to critical infrastructure and water systems cannot be peripheral concerns.

India is not oblivious to these risks. The Parliamentary Standing Committee on Water Resources, in its 2023 report on glacier management in the Himalaya, discussed flash floods associated with glacial melting and the risks of glacial lake outbursts. It made several recommendations on glacier management, including the need for systematic data gathering and monitoring of glaciers in

the Indian Himalayan Region to develop actionable plans. The Committee recognised transboundary coordination as a core challenge and pointed to the absence of a mechanism and the lack of provisions within existing treaties for dealing with glacier-linked risks. It urged the Ministry of Jal Shakti to urge the Ministry of External Affairs to have some kind of agreement with neighbouring Himalayan countries.

This points to a larger issue. Rivers can no longer be peripheral to geopolitical conversations. Geography determines river courses, and with them, the distribution of power and vulnerability. Risks can disrupt conventionally understood power relations, if not flip them. The Himalayan reality and its emerging risks pose the bigger question: How do countries bound by geography jointly manage trans-territorial risks?

Nepal, India, Bangladesh and other neighbouring countries need to reconsider strategies and institutions that remain organised around political boundaries, even as the risks they must manage increasingly transcend them. When it comes to risk, an upstream riparian need not necessarily have complete advantage. There is also a need to rethink water treaties from this new angle.

The Himalayan cryosphere, combined with the geography of its river systems, calls for reimagining the region itself. Regional institutions may be imperfect, but the scale of the emerging risks makes it increasingly difficult to justify marginalising them. The region is interconnected by the ecologies, river systems, and climate dynamics, but the institutions through which the countries in the region engage with one another remain largely detached from shared systems and risks.

There is an opportunity here for India to convene, to build institutions around shared risks. A Himalayan early-warning network, shared cryosphere-risk assessments, common protocols for GLOF and flash-flood alerts, and regular exercises involving disaster-management agencies could be the practical foundations for cooperation around shared risks.

The idea of imagining South Asia around shared environmental risks is not new. What is new is the urgency that GLOF-like risks bring.

The writer is president and chief executive, Centre for Policy Research, New Delhi. Views are personal

is quite evident that the world economy is developing a G2 structure, dominated by America and China. Washington and Beijing are the only states with the scale to shape global economic order, technology standards, and supply chains. They are also deeply interdependent. Each seeks to reduce vulnerability to the other, but neither can readily escape the other's market, technology, capital or industrial capacity.

The Trump-Xi meetings this year are not likely to herald a US-China condominium. Their disputes over trade, technology and Taiwan are too deep. But they are based on the recognition that Washington and Beijing must manage their rivalry through sustained high-level contact. The nature of that management, however, has implications for the rest of the world.

Unlike the clear pattern in the global economic order, the situation on the strategic front is more complex. Although economically diminished, Russia retains enough military power, geographical reach and diplomatic weight to influence the balance between the two giants across Eurasia. Unsurprisingly, Moscow has drawn Beijing closer than ever before, while Trump has made an American overture to Russia. This does not mean that the US can easily detach Russia from China. Trump's Russian play is complicated by the conflict between Moscow and Europe over Ukraine. Progress in Trump's peace initiative in Ukraine, however, could set the stage for a US-Russian rapprochement, and a G3 summit as well as Putin's presence at the G20 meeting. Unlike the G7, the G20 includes China, Russia, India, Brazil, Indonesia, Saudi Ara-

bia, South Africa and other consequential non-Western powers. Unlike BRICS, it includes the US, Europe and Japan.

The changing distribution of power has helped America and China loom larger than ever before in the G20. Differences between the US and China at the G20 finance ministers' meeting in Washington this month prevented the forum from issuing a joint statement, with China objecting to language on trade surpluses and export-led growth. When the US and China disagree, they undermine the hope that the G20 is capable of collective action on the economic front. But bilateral deal-making between Washington and Beijing could also come at the expense of other actors in the G20.

India might want a multipolar world, but we are not there yet; arguably, we might even be moving away from it. For now, Delhi must deal with the intensifying great game — whether it is G2 or G3 — that is set to define the future of the international order. Organisations like the APEC, BRICS, EU, G7 and NATO don't shape the world order. They operate within the parameters set by great-power politics. With the BRICS party over in Delhi, the Indian foreign policy elite needs to wake up from its self-indulgent reverie and pay attention to the changing global distribution of power and the geopolitical realignment between America, China, and Russia.

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Saudi Arabia is facing a two-strait dilemma



R SWAMINATHAN

YEMEN'S CIVIL war, which commenced in the aftermath of the Arab Spring, has flared up with renewed intensity. The latest Houthi offensives have resulted in their control of the Red Sea coast of Yemen and the Bab el-Mandeb Strait — the sole gateway between the Red Sea and the Gulf of Aden, providing access to the Suez Canal from the Arabian Sea, carrying roughly 12 per cent of global trade. While the Houthis have threatened the waterway with long-range weapons in recent years, occupying Perim Island gives them an unobstructed line of sight over commercial traffic.

After Saudi fighter jets attacked and damaged the Sana'a airport runway in Yemen to prevent an Iranian plane from landing without clearance, the Houthis declared a naval blockade of Saudi Arabia, followed by regular attacks on Saudi tankers in the Red Sea as well as its oil-related facilities. The lack of support from Saudi-backed forces for UAE-aligned factions deployed along the coast, aggravated by internal infighting, has enabled the Houthis to seize the Bab el-Mandeb with minimal resistance. Following the disruption in the Strait of Hormuz, Saudi Arabia has relied primarily on oil exports from its Red Sea port of Yanbu, supplied by the 1,200-km East-West pipeline from its eastern oilfields. Nearly 70 per cent of this oil was transported to Asia through the Bab el-Mandeb prior to the Houthis' naval blockade in July.

Since then, flows through the Red Sea strait have dwindled sharply as Saudi Arabia rerouted Asian shipments through the Suez Canal and around the African continent. In fact, Saudi Arabia was compelled to curtail its crude oil production to the lowest level in August this year at 6.2 million barrels per day (bpd), compared to over 10 million bpd in January. While promising intelligence, Donald Trump was said to have refused the Saudis' request for direct US involvement. The US does not wish to open another front and any direct American or Western intervention is bound to lead to the Houthis broadening their strikes, with immediate repercussions for global oil markets, a spike that Trump is keen to avoid ahead of the US midterm elections in November.

As for the Mecca Alliance partners, Pakistan and Turkey seem reluctant to get involved militarily in Yemen, except in the event of an invasion of Saudi Arabia. They are also concerned about the prospect of provoking the Houthis further. In 2015, Pakistan refused the Saudi request to take part in the Yemen war, notwithstanding their 1982 bilateral security agreement. Saudi Arabia is also confronting the reality of US reluctance to come to its rescue.

The Houthis have proved themselves to be resilient fighters. When the US targeted them in 2025, they were reported to have shot down several American drones and nearly hit a number of fighter jets. Emboldened by recent successes, the Houthis have started moving to capture Marib, east of Sana'a, the centre of Yemen's oil and gas industry, to further strengthen their bargaining position. The takeover of Bab el-Mandeb has strengthened both Houthi and Iranian leverage. Iran has added ending the “blockade of Yemen” as one of its conditions for a lasting settlement with the US. Facing a reluctant US, hesitant Mecca Alliance partners, and two-sided maritime chokepoints, Riyadh may have to concede to the Houthis' demands that it has resisted for years, unless its counterattacks are swiftly able to succeed.

The writer is former ambassador to Egypt and former permanent representative to the Arab League

The lack of support from Saudi-backed forces for UAE-aligned factions deployed along the coast, aggravated by internal infighting, has enabled the Houthis to seize the Bab el-Mandeb with minimal resistance

40 YEARS AGO

September 16, 1986



Seoul on high alert

THOUSANDS OF National Police officers, backed by military units, were put on full alert in Seoul as the government braced itself for possible further terrorist action following the airport blast. President Chun Doo-hwan personally inspected the damage at the Gimpo (International) Airport arrival terminal.

Clashes in Srinagar

SEVERAL PEOPLE were injured in Srinagar when students clashed with the police and

set a car on fire at Sheikh Bagh, near Lal Chowk. The students were taking out a procession, demanding “justice” in allotment of engineering college seats. The trouble started when students of the Regional Engineering College boycotted their classes alleging that the majority community had not been given proper representation.

Floods claim 17 lives in UP

FLOODS AND widespread rains in Uttar Pradesh claimed 17 lives, official reports said. Twelve people were killed in Rae Bareilly dis-

trict, while five members of a family were drowned while having a bath in the swollen Sarayu river at Ayodhya.

US warning to ‘smaller nations’

WHILE INDIA and other developing countries continue to gather support for their stand against the introduction of services in the new GATT round, the United States warned “smaller and export-dependent nations” that protectionist measures by industrialised countries could have a devastating effect on them.



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A politics of the young needs to open up and include, speak to new — and old



VANDITA MISHRA

SOMETHING SEEMS to be changing since the Jantar Mantar sit-in became a movement that forced the Narendra Modi government to listen, and bend. If that change is not just a short-lived excitement that fizzles out before the next election comes, if it is to go beyond the selfie-style vertical videos starring Prime Minister Narendra Modi, or the curated stage of Rahul Gandhi's "Chhatron ki Goonj" that makes space for his young audience's stories, or the Instagram duel between Congress and BJP — what would it be? Is there a new politics of the young that will survive, after young protesters' voices, amplified by social media, have faded?

The question, really, is this: Is the students' movement that speaks of education and jobs carving out new common ground and new solidarities, smudging the lines of a divided politics?

That question has a back story. In the journey of a large and diverse nation, two tendencies have coexisted imperfectly — one, that breaks down the whole into its constituent parts, and the other that puts parts together to construct a new whole.

The first effort is necessary so that all the parts feel seen and heard, so that the weaker among them are not shouted down by the dominant, and so that inequalities and injustices are not papered over in the name of an artificial unity. The first-past-the-post electoral system, which offers a powerful incentive for a catch-all politics, makes this second effort — of connecting the dots and adding up — a strategic necessity. But softening the fault-lines and stitching together more enveloping imagined communities is also a political imperative. It addresses the people's yearning for wider circles of belonging, which sits alongside their need to be acknowledged and addressed separately.

The students' movement comes after the two grand political projects of the '90s, Man-



ILLUSTRATION: C.R SASIKUMAR

dal and Mandir, broke down the whole into its parts and then could not put them back together again. At the same time, other attempts to construct new communities have been much too episodic and erratic.

The Mandal project oversaw the splitting of the polity into its constituent castes. In its best version, after applying social justice as balm and corrective, the outcome was to be the putting back together of a more equal society. But the second process was thwarted because the legitimising principle of social justice gave way to a proportional representation arithmetic — "*jiski jitni sankhya bhaari...*" This meant that castes lines became more impermeable and even when caste groups came together with others in alliances, there was little effort to forge a shared language or common understanding.

In a nation still carrying the scars and silences of Partition, a version of the Mandir project — one that may well have been a retrospective add-on, post-2014, to airbrush an inherently violent and exclusionary story — was about deconstructing a denial. It was to be about acknowledging the unaddressed challenge festering under slogans of "unity in diversity". This version of the Mandir project could, arguably, have led to a bottom-up reworking of the terms of religious co-existence — from fear, prejudice

Over the years, attempts have been made to sidestep the hardened lines of Mandal and Mandir, and forge new communities across them, on the basis of ideas that are unifying or overlapping

Two ideas of faith, a party's two faces



PAROMITA CHAKRABARTI

AHEAD OF Durga Puja, Dharendra Krishna Shastri, the godman who runs Bageshwar Dham, has called upon Bengali Hindus to abstain from eating non-vegetarian food during the festival, branding those who do as "*pakhandis*". In much of India, vegetarianism, especially around Navratri or Sawan, has become a litmus test of devotion. But in West Bengal, the line between a *bhakta* (true devotee) and a *bhanda* (hypocrite) has never rested on dietary choices.

The community *pujos* make this clear — the queues for the *bhog* are matched by those outside the plentiful non-vegetarian food stalls that dot the perimeter of the pandals. The Shakta tradition in Bengal — the worship of Shakti, the divine feminine to which both Durga and Kali belong — has historically accommodated meat, fish and animal sacrifice. Vegetarianism happens to be one of the many paths to the goddess, not a necessary precondition.

What Shastri's remark brings into focus, then, are two very different ideas of what religious faith should look like. One treats food and abstinence as markers of purity. The other sees faith as something that can accommodate different practices and forms of devotion.

His remarks were followed by a revealing sequence of responses. BJP state president Samik Bhattacharya distanced the party from it. Chief Minister Suvenud Adhikari partook in the *bhog* at the Kalighat

The Durga Puja in the state has always been less about enforcing sameness than about making room — for different rituals and even different reasons for showing up

temple, eating fish and basanti pulao on camera, even as the VHP issued "guidelines" to puja organisers to keep the sale and consumption of non-vegetarian food away from pandals to preserve the festival's "sanctity". A Congress leader who had filed a police complaint against Shastri was arrested. Within a week, the ruling party and its affiliates came to be proponents of a purity campaign and its most conspicuous violators.

This apparent anomaly can be understood when placed in context of the BJP's victory in the state in May. For a decade, the party had fought the "outsider" charge in Bengal — the Trinamool Congress' "Bengali *asmita*" campaign, which painted the BJP as a Hindi-belt import — *bohiraगतo* — with no understanding of what being Bengali entailed. The party's victory required it to shed that label; in the run-up to the elections, its campaign had focused on leaders eating fish and assuring the electorate that it was attuned to its diet and culture. And so, ahead of the state's biggest festival, the vegetarian-purity code that plays as content for a north Indian godman's YouTube audience is one

a state government must publicly breach to prove it belongs to the region it now governs. What looks like the party's own moral messaging failing when it comes in contact with Bengal is two tracks of the same movement: A portable, tele-genic orthodoxy for national branding, and a vernacular, accom-

modative face in the state. challenges. The experiments of Mayawati and Nitish used the building blocks of caste and added the cement of "*bhaichara* (brotherhood)" and "*sushasan* (good governance)", respectively, to build cross-caste and cross-community alliances. Nitish was much more successful, but his framework has not been able to survive his political exit. Mayawati's outreach has been beset with an unchecked shrinking that has all but ruled the BSP out of the race after her 2007-2012 heyday in UP.

The AAP's imaginative model has been weakened by the party's showboating, by the vindictive targeting of its government and leadership by the BJP, and by a more substantive failure that continues to chase it. Even as AAP sidesteps the old Mandal and Mandir fault-lines, it needs to find new and creative ways of engaging with caste and religious inequalities — else, it runs the risk of a friendly neighbourhood solutionism narrowing its project irretrievably.

Modi's courting of the aspirational voter on the move has, in his second and third terms, conspicuously taken second place to the BJP's no-holds-barred bid to conquer-and-occupy and its ideological fixities. Both Prashant Kishor and Vijay are a work in progress — Vijay is the outsider who has broken through while PK is still to widen the Bankipur opening. Both need to establish the contours of the idea that animates their politics — it is not an offspring of the old frameworks, and that is its strength, but if it does not negotiate with them on its own terms, it will be overpowered and defeated by their legacies.

That is also the challenge for the Gen Z movement. It has a new idea and form. It has shown unifying possibilities. But there is work to be done. It needs to find a new language to address the old and resilient issues, be it persisting caste inequalities or shrinking spaces for minorities, economic stress on uneven ground or strains in a federal polity.

If a politics of the young is not to be transient, like youth is, if it is to endure, it needs to find ways of both reimagining the whole and addressing the parts. The youth movement's idea of the future must open up and include many more — beyond the young.

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What about the father's leave? It is parenting, not just mothering



THAMIZHACHI THANGAPANDIAN

ON AUGUST 18, Tamil Nadu's Human Resources Management Minister, D Sarathkumar announced that women government employees would now receive 365 days of maternity leave for the birth of a third child, up from the earlier 12 weeks. The state government called it a step towards women's empowerment and social welfare, and framed it as a response to the state's declining fertility rate. On the surface, this is a welcome correction. The Madras High Court had also observed that the physical and caregiving demands of childbirth do not diminish because a woman is having her third child. Twelve weeks was never enough, and removing that arbitrary cap was overdue.

Yet, I find myself returning to a question this scheme cannot answer, one I suspect it was never meant to ask. Why does the father's leave never grow longer?

Tamil Nadu did not arrive at this question recently. It was Periyar's Self-Respect Movement that insisted that marriage and motherhood were matters of a woman's dignity and consent, not obligations owed to custom, or family. It shaped how Dravida Munnetra Kazhagam (DMK) governments approached women's welfare — not as a single generous gesture but as sustained, structural change. The Kalaigarnar government gave daughters equal rights to ancestral property, 16 years before the Union government followed in 2005. Free bus travel widened where a woman could go without needing a man's permission or her family's spare change. The Kalaigarnar Magalir Urimai Thogai placed a monthly sum directly into women's hands, recognising that independence requires economic control.

Historian Linda Gordon has argued that we cannot explain, or correct, women's oppression by cordoning off reproduction from how work, wages and time are organised for everyone else. Tamil Nadu's maternity leave scheme does precisely this. By speaking only in the language of welfare and care, it presents the lopsided division of parental responsibility as a natural difference between mothers and fathers.

Sweden offers a useful lesson here. In 1974, it became the first

country to replace maternity leave with a gender-neutral parental leave benefit, allowing parents to divide it between them. However, fathers' participation remained low for decades because leave could simply be transferred to mothers. Sweden eventually introduced non-transferable leave reserved for each parent. The lesson is not that fathers should be given leave, but that policy has to be designed in a way that makes caregiving a shared responsibility.



We have not even begun

this conversation. We do not have a national paternity leave policy worth the name, let alone one built on the understanding that raising a child is not a woman's assignment with occasional male assistance.

This brings me to the second, more uncomfortable part of the government's own justification: That this measure responds to a declining fertility rate. But extending maternity leave does not address why fertility is declining in the first place. Across the world, women are choosing to have fewer children because the economic and social cost of raising a child has become harder to justify. If we are serious about reversing declining birth rates, the answer is paid, mandatory, non-transferable leave for fathers.

I am reminded of Betty Friedan's *The Feminine Mystique* (1963) and how carefully, in the postwar years, domesticity was repeatedly sold to women as fulfilment rather than constraint. There is a version of that same story being retold today, dressed in the language of welfare and women's empowerment.

There is a question this scheme does not ask. A year of paid leave tied to a third pregnancy does not exist in a vacuum. A scheme that pushes women towards childbearing risks placing marginalised women in vulnerable positions while failing to address the larger question of care. A woman's body, and what she chooses to do with it, is not a lever for the state to pull in service of a fertility target.

This scheme, then, is not the full response to declining birth rates and the unequal burden of care it presents itself as. Every woman who benefits from this scheme deserves that time, and more. But if this is the full extent of the state's response, it tells us something about where Indian society still places responsibility for the next generation, regardless of who is in government. Until that changes, adding more days to maternity leave will not solve the problem it claims to address.

The writer is DMK Lok Sabha MP, Chennai South

Not shaking hands, a flawed patriotism test



MIHIR VASAVIDA

PICTURE THE Asian Games. An Indian kabaddi player shakes hands with a Pakistani opponent. A squash player does the same. Hockey players high-five each other before the anthems. Boxers touch gloves. Then, the cricket match ends, and Indian players turn around and walk away. What, exactly, would that imply? Not merely that cricket has adopted a different protocol. The visual, and the message, would imply something far more uncomfortable — the rest of you can shake hands; we are more patriotic.

This possibility was raised after India refused to accept the trophy from Asian Cricket Council President Mohsin Naqvi, after winning the Women's Asia Cup on Sunday. Ear-

lier in the tournament, Harmanpreet Kaur's team had continued Indian cricket's no-handshake policy against Pakistan.

The "policy" began with Suryakumar Yadav-led India at last year's men's Asia Cup, in the aftermath of the Pahalgam terror attack and the dramatic deterioration in ties between the two countries. India played Pakistan because it was a multinational tournament, but Suryakumar's side refused the customary handshakes. After beating Pakistan in the final, they also refused to accept the trophy from Naqvi. The women's team has now followed that template.

India has a Pakistan policy in sports. Why should cricket be distinct? The government decides the broad parameters of engagement. India does not play bilateral cricket against Pakistan, but participates in multinational events in which Pakistan is also competing. That is why India played the Asia

Cup. That is why Indian and Pakistani athletes will compete against each other at the Asian Games, starting Saturday.

But cricket has now created another distinction. You can play Pakistan. You can compete against them for a continental title. But shaking hands? That, apparently, is where patriotism begins. And now comes another line: Accepting a trophy from a Pakistani official who also happens to hold a continental sporting office.

Naqvi is, unquestionably, a complicated figure. Besides being an ACC administrator,

You can play Pakistan. You can compete against them for a continental title. But shaking hands? That, apparently, is where patriotism begins

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he is also Pakistan's interior minister and chairman of the Pakistan Cricket Board. That is why the decision to avoid him has a political dimension beyond an ordinary presentation ceremony. What happens at the Asian Games, though? What if a Pakistani sports administrator holding a continental position is asked to present medals?

The BCCI says their decision is to respect the "prevailing sentiments in the country" to align with the government. Nowhere has the government stated, at least publicly, that cricketers — or any athletes — should not shake hands with Pakistanis or not receive trophies from Pakistani officials.

The BCCI has spent decades guarding its autonomy. When questions of regulation, transparency and public accountability arise, Indian cricket is quick to emphasise that it is different from other sports. But once Pakistan enters the frame,

autonomy gives way to nationalism. It cannot work both ways.

The BCCI is entitled to argue that the India-Pakistan relationship demands caution. What it cannot do convincingly is play Pakistan when the tournament demands it, draw a line at a handshake or a trophy ceremony, and then allow those gestures to suggest a higher form of national commitment.

One day, at an Asian Games or another multi-sport event, the larger picture may become impossible to ignore. Indian athletes will shake hands with Pakistanis. Some will share a podium. Some may receive medals from officials they would not otherwise choose to meet. If the cricketers alone turn away, it won't make them look more patriotic.

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Two Kuki-Zo women killed in new attack in Manipur

Jimmy Leivon
Imphal, September 15

JUST TWO days after four Kuki-Zo civilians were gunned down by unidentified armed miscreants, two more — both women — were shot dead in a remote Kuki settlement in Manipur’s Tamenglong district.

The incident occurred around 3pm in Leijangphai near Muktokhal on Tuesday, sources said. The dead have been identified as Phalneichong (Chonga) Sitlhou, 76, wife of late Seidou Sitlhou, and Kimjalhing (Kimboi) Singson, 30, daughter of Paosei Singson.

The two were engaged in routine activities on the farm when they were ambushed by unidentified armed assailants, said sources. Singson, it is learnt, had just returned home after her nursing course to assist her parents in farming.

Officials, quoting local residents said, few kutcha farm-houses were also set on fire by the miscreants, and several villagers could not be traced following the attack.

Tuesday’s attack has once again heightened tensions between communities in the region, which is already plagued by the larger ethnic conflict playing out in Manipur.

The Jiribam-Tamenglong region alone has seen three attacks this week.

On Sunday, four people, including two women, were killed and few others injured in two separate attacks on Kuki settlements of Longpi and Tollen — also in Tamenglong district.

The Kuki-Zo Council (KZC) has condemned the attacks, calling them an alarming pattern.

“The continued targeting of civilians raises concerns about attempts to terrorise and drive Kuki-Zo communities from their settlements,” it said.

It also urged the Manipur government and the Centre to protect vulnerable communities, bring the perpetrators to justice, and take firm, lawful action against armed groups attacking civilians.

In addition, the Council has also issued a directive urging Civil Society Organisations of the Kuki-Zo community, until further notice, not to bury the victims, whom they say are allegedly killed by a rival (Naga) group.

“With immediate effect, no Kuki-Zo killed by armed Naga groups in Manipur shall be buried. The mortal remains of every such victim shall instead be preserved in the nearest available cold-storage facility until further directions are issued by the Kuki-Zo Council,” it said.

Following Sunday’s incident, the Naga Village Authority of the neighbouring Kaimai settlement described the perpetrators as an unidentified group and expressed concern that the attacks could create suspicion and division among communities in the region. It urged all to exercise restraint, and community leaders and CSOs to reaffirm peace and understanding.

Incidentally, the settlement of Leijangphai has been contested over by Jiribam and Tamenglong for jurisdiction. The ethnic conflict that erupted in Manipur in May 2023 has claimed hundreds of lives and has left thousands homeless.



Ganesh Chaturthi prayers

Prime Minister Narendra Modi offers prayers to Lord Ganesh at Union Minister Piyush Goyal’s residence in New Delhi on the occasion of Ganesh Chaturthi. **ANI**

Respect, interest, sensitivity are three mutuals guiding ties with China: India

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

INDIA ON Tuesday reiterated that Prime Minister Narendra Modi underlined to Chinese President Xi Jinping that both sides should show “sensitivity to each other’s core concerns” and be guided by the three mutuals: “mutual respect, mutual interest, and mutual sensitivity”.

The Chinese readout had said that India reiterated specific stances on Taiwan and Tibet and promised not to allow anti-China activities on its territory.

Responding to questions on

Chinese readout, the Ministry of External Affairs’ official spokesperson Randhir Jaiswal said on Tuesday, “A bilateral meeting took place between PM and President Xi on the sidelines of the 18th (BRICS) summit... as far as issue of certain issues mentioned in the Chinese readout is concerned... several issues came up during the discussions, and we have kept you updated with those, including those referred to in your question. The PM referred to Indian concerns as well, and underlined those that both sides should show sensitivity to each other’s core concerns and

be guided by three mutuals: mutual respect, mutual interest, and mutual sensitivity.”

China’s Foreign Ministry spokesperson had told reporters on Monday, “PM Modi said India has an independent foreign policy... and India will not allow any force to engage in anti-China activities on its territory. China values PM Modi’s statements.” Chinese Foreign Minister Wang Yi said President Xi and PM Modi reached “most important consensus” during their meeting on margins of BRICS summit that they should be partners, as per news agency PTI.

SC: Can PMLA authority confirm attachment orders without judicial member on board?

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

THE SUPREME Court on Tuesday asked whether there would be proper application of mind if only one member sits on the Adjudicating Authority (AA) bench confirming orders of attachment made by the Enforcement Directorate under the Prevention of Money Laundering Act, given the workload.

A three-judge bench presided over by Chief Justice of India Surya Kant posed the query as it reserved its decision on whether the AA can confirm confiscation of assets without a judicial member on board and whether it can sit as a single-member bench.

With the petitioners contending that only a small proportion of the cases booked by the ED is sent for trial while attachments would have applied in all booked cases, the bench, also comprising Justices Joy-malya Bagchi and V Mohana, asked the agency to furnish data in this regard.

Appearing for the petitioners, Senior Advocate Vikram Chaudhri contended that the AA is performing a quasi-judicial function and not an administrative one as it has to decide a provisional attachment within 180 days.

He submitted that under the Act, the Adjudicating Authority should consist of the chairperson and 2 other members.

Chaudhri said when the SC rendered its decision in the Vijay Madanlal Chaudhary case, in which it upheld ED’s powers under the Act, the court noted that the AAs are three-

member bodies headed by a district judge. He said the presence of a judicial member is a must and added that a single member had been functioning as AA for a long time and it was only recently that another member (law) was included.

The senior counsel also pointed out that the Act permits the AA to sit in benches comprising 1 or 2 members.

Senior Advocate Gopal San-karanarayanan, also appearing for the petitioners, said as per the agency’s own data, only 60 of the 8,851 cases initiated by ED during a specific period went to trial, whereas the provisions relating to attachment of property etc. would have applied in all the 8,851 cases. This would mean civil consequences in all those cases would remain for decades without them even going to trial, he said.

Justice Bagchi asked Additional Solicitor General Anil Kaushik, who appeared for the ED, how there would be proper application of mind in such a scenario.

“We are looking at a law which requires application of mind by one Tribunal in 3,000 cases in 6 months... what is happening Mr Kaushik is if law leaves a gap, then because of draconian nature, it gives a (180 days) timeline... Can you imagine the pressure which is being put on a Tribunal comprising of whatever 3, 2, or 1 member... to look into 3,000 or 5,000 cases within 6 months? Will there be a real application of mind? Or just signing on dotted lines,” Justice Bagchi asked.

Meta to report child safety cases to India’s cyber crime portal amid govt crackdown

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 15

FACEBOOK AND Instagram owner Meta agreed to report child safety-related matters directly to cybercrime portal managed by the Indian Cyber Crime Coordination Centre (I4C), as the government pushes social media platforms for stronger safeguards and greater accountability amid a crackdown on child sexual abuse material and other harmful content online.

Protecting children on the platforms is a priority for the company, “We’re committed to working with the government to ensure the perpetrators of these crimes are held responsible,” a Meta spokesperson said, “To collectively strengthen our efforts to combat this harm, Meta will now report child safety matters directly to the cybercrime portal managed by I4C”.

Meta, headquartered in the United States, is the first major tech intermediary to commit to establishing a direct reporting pipeline to Indian law enforcement. Until now, Meta has reported child safety cases to the US-based National Center for Missing and Exploited Children.

Earlier on Tuesday, government sources said Meta had agreed to report child safety-related matters to appropriate law enforcement agencies. The sources said the online safety of children is a “fundamental principle” for any social media platform operating in India and is absolutely “non-negotiable”.

Earlier this month, the National Commission for Protection of Child Rights (NCPCR) summoned the Managing Director and Head of Meta India in connection with its inquiry into alleged CSEAM-related advertisements on the platform. The child rights body had taken suo motu cognisance of a BBC Eye media report on the alleged advertisements and sought an explanation from Meta.

Lawrence Bishnoi’s aide deported from Canada, had arranged hideout for Anmol Bishnoi in US

Man Aman Singh Chhina
Chandigarh, September 15

THE PUNJAB Police’s Anti-Gangster Task Force (AGTF) took Karamveer Singh, alias Karamveer Deo, a close associate of gangster Lawrence Bishnoi, into custody at IGI Airport in New Delhi early on Tuesday following his deportation from Canada, officials said.

“Karamveer Singh had provided logistical support and a hideout to Anmol Bishnoi, brother of Lawrence Bishnoi, in the USA. He was wanted in FIR registered at State Crime police station, SAS Nagar, under relevant sections of the IPC, Arms Act and Passport Act,” Director General of Police (DGP) Gaurav Yadav said. “The accused has a criminal history involving cases related to murder, attempt to murder, robbery, extortion, Arms Act offences, and other criminal activities. Canadian and US court filings and FBI documents allege he acted as a logistical operator for the Bishnoi network, providing a hideout and support to Anmol Bishnoi in California, helping members enter the US, and being suspected of directing a 2024 shooting and arson at singer A P Dhillon’s home in British Columbia. Those claims are allegations, and he has not been charged with crimes in Canada.

Additional DGP Promod Ban said further investigations are underway to establish Karamveer’s operational connections, illicit funding channels and linkages with members of the gang.

Anmol Bishnoi, wanted in several cases, was arrested by the NIA upon his deportation from the US in November 2025.

the case was still pending.

The arrest of Karamveer, a resident of Bahadur Ke village in Ludhiana, comes near to the Punjab Police securing the extradition of fugitive criminal Amritpal Singh alias Amrit Dalam, a key operative of the Jaggu Bhagwanpuria gang, from the Republic of Moldova.

DGP Yadav said Karamveer has a criminal history involving cases related to murder, attempt to murder, robbery, extortion, Arms Act offences and other criminal activities. Canadian and US court filings and FBI documents allege he acted as a logistical operator for the Bishnoi network, providing a hideout and support to Anmol Bishnoi in California, helping members enter the US, and being suspected of directing a 2024 shooting and arson at singer A P Dhillon’s home in British Columbia. Those claims are allegations, and he has not been charged with crimes in Canada.

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Anmol Bishnoi, wanted in several cases, was arrested by the NIA upon his deportation from the US in November 2025.

Multiple cases have emerged from Punjab; some men returned after kin paid ‘ransom’

Anju Agnihotri Chaba
Jalandhar, September 15

MANPREET SINGH, 24, used to do odd jobs in Gill village in Punjab’s Kapurthala district. Some 25 km away, 27-year-old Kulraj Singh from Manak village in Jalandhar tehsil worked as a truck driver.

A local travel agent approached them, separately, with the promise of jobs in Spain’s hospitality industry. They found it reassuring that the agent was not interested in any payment. “You first reach Spain and then pay as you earn,” they were told.

On June 30, they left. But instead of Spain, the two say they found themselves in Thailand.

Then came calls reportedly to their family members from a man who identified himself as “Khan Baba”. They were asked to pay Rs 15 lakh each for release of Manpreet and Kulraj. While Mandeep’s family managed to pay up, ensuring his return, Kulraj’s family says it could not arrange the full amount. Kulraj is now in a jail in Thailand after a “wrong tip-off” by his kidnappers, they say.

Their cases are not isolated. In the last 11 months, several cases of a similar nature have emerged from Punjab. The young men were promised employment in Spain, Australia and South Korea, but ended up in Thailand, Iran, Ethiopia and

Kenya, lured by different agents. All the families told police they received calls from “Khan Baba”. All the men who were targeted belong to modest families, and were working as drivers, barbers, petrol-pump workers or labourers. Their families say they had to borrow money or sell valuables to raise Rs 15 lakh-Rs 70 lakh to secure their release.

Police officers told *The Indian Express* they were examining the call recordings given by the families of them talking to “Khan Baba” to trace him, but have had few leads so far. Kapurthala SSP Gaurav Toora says the complaints were being examined on a case-by-case basis.

Balbir Seechewal, a Rajya Sabha MP of the ruling Aam Aadmi Party, says he recently wrote to the External Affairs Ministry, Union Home Ministry and Punjab DGP, and sought Interpol assistance in the matter.

In the case of both Mandeep and Kulraj, local agent Sanjeev Kumar helped facilitate their travel, and has been named in the complaint. Sanjeev admits making arrangements, but blames one Sumrit Kumar from Phagwara, now based in Malaysia. According to him Sumrit arranged to send people to Europe, and he trusted him. “Sumrit told me the youths would travel to Thailand first, and obtain their Spain visas. After that, the families (of Kulraj and Mandeep)



A banner outside agent Sanjeev Kumar’s shop in Kapurthala. **EXPRESS**

were directed to a person in Amritsar, who collected the money to give to Sumrit in cryptocurrency,” Sanjeev says, adding he is ready to cooperate with police.

In her police complaint, Kulraj’s mother Kuldeep Kaur has named Sumrit, his mother and his sister Komal, besides Sanjeev. Kuldeep says she went to Sumrit’s house last month with Sanjeev when she got a call from Komal, who is also in Malaysia, saying, “*Paise denepadenge* (you will have to pay up).”

Police say they have recorded Sanjeev’s statement. Asked why he hasn’t been arrested, SSP Toora says probe is underway.

Promised South Korea, taken to Ethiopia

Harbans Singh, a barber from Fatehgarh Sahib, was promised a job in South Korea. He left Delhi in March this year and found himself in Ethiopia. His family says they received videos showing him being beaten up, and a call from “Khan Baba”. The demand reportedly was Rs

25 lakh. The family says it paid Rs 15 lakh, after which Harbans was released. “As instructed by Khan Baba, we handed over money to different persons in Chandigarh and Patiala,” his wife Sanjeevan Kaur says.

A police officer says the agent is in Japan right now and will be questioned once he is back.

Back to the safety of his home, Harban says he cannot forget the 26 days he spent in captivity in Ethiopia. “I thought I would never see my wife and children again.” He says his captors subjected him to “brutal torture” to force his family to arrange money. “They would beat me with sticks and iron rods.”

Food, he says, was barely enough to survive. “Most of the time, we were given potatoes and roasted rice...”

Another man sent to Ethiopia is Rohit Kumar from Fazilka. In March, he travelled through Bangkok, Sharjah and Dubai before reaching the African nation. According to his family, he was promised a job in South Korea.

Detained by Taliban, woman on solo Afghanistan trip recounts her fears

Shaju Philip
Thiruvananthapuram, September 15

INDIAN SOLO traveller Arunima I P, alias Backpacker Arunima, sparked concern after posting a distress message on social media on Monday, claiming that she had been detained by the Taliban during her ongoing trip to Afghanistan. Arunima, who had sought the help of the Indian Embassy, however, said on Tuesday that she was safe.

A native of Ottapalam in Kerala’s Palakkad, Arunima had shared a video on her YouTube channel on Monday saying that she was detained by Taliban as they do not allow women travel-

ling alone in Afghanistan. She had also put out a message stating: “Please help me connect to the Indian embassy.”

However, on Tuesday morning, she wrote: “I am safe.”

Arunima, who reached Afghanistan last month and had since been travelling alone, said her trip in the country has been attracting crowds everywhere as women were not seen at public places there.

In the YouTube video, she said people who had waylaid her could not read her travel documents and were advising her against travelling alone.

She said they were insisting on a special permit to cross every province in Afghanistan.

‘Was completely terrified’

“I spent several hours in tension that I felt I could have died. I was completely terrified. In the evening (on Monday), I hitchhiked on a truck and reached Bamyan. The very moment I got down from the vehicle, people started coming towards me because a woman would not normally be alone in Afghanistan at night,” she is heard saying in the video. “They were not ready to leave me alone to decide on where I should stay the night... They asked me to show my documents. I showed them my passport and visa. According to the law of this country, a woman cannot travel alone,” she added.



Keralite travel vlogger Arunima runs the Facebook page Backpacker Arunima. **FB**

She said she had tried to convince the local authorities that she had been travelling alone all these days, ever since

she started the Afghan journey on August 27. “According to their law, I had violated the rules. They told me that they were going to arrest me. Here, every Taliban member is like a police officer. They can do whatever they want. I asked them to deport me. They said I had violated the law and that they would arrest me. What was my crime? I had travelled alone as a woman in a country where women are not allowed to travel alone.”

Referring to her days in Afghanistan, the solo woman traveller said local authorities in Jalalabad did not issue the permit on the ground that a woman cannot travel alone. “I repeatedly asked them to give

me the permit, but they said they could not issue one without a man accompanying me, or I would have to travel with a guide,” Arunima said.

Next stop, Uzbekistan

Arunima said she would now be leaving for Uzbekistan, which is 500 km away, and raised concern over crossing the checkpoints en route.

Arunima has been exploring the world for the last six years. She had covered the entire breadth of the country in one-and-a-half-years before moving to other countries. On her social media pages, she introduces herself as “solo traveller exploring the world for 6 years, hitchhiking through

wild, risky, and forgotten routes, sharing real stories from the planet’s least-explored places.”

She wrote, “I’m deeply passionate about traveling alone. Solo journeys give me exciting experiences, freedom, and a deeper connection with myself.”

In earlier media interviews, the young traveller had stated that she had charted out a different trajectory in life after completing Class 12. Arunima, who said she loved travelling from childhood, had done sundry jobs before venturing out as a full-time solo traveller in 2020. She has around 1.2 million followers on Instagram and 731K subscribers on YouTube.

For the last few years, Islamabad has claimed that the JeM founder has been operating from Afghanistan.

Last week, however, the Taliban regime dismissed Pakistan’s repeated claims, with a senior Afghan Foreign Ministry official saying he is not in the country.

Islamabad’s fresh announcement on the reward for information on Azhar came as it faces pressure from the Financial Action Task Force (FATF) to crack down on terror groups and their leadership.

The Paris-based global watchdog, FATF, is set to review Pakistan’s anti-terrorism efforts at its upcoming plenary.

A SHARP JUMP IN SHIPMENTS TO THE US DROVE THE OVERALL GOODS EXPORTS IN AUGUST

August goods exports soar 26%

Ravi Dutta Mishra
New Delhi, September 15

INDIA'S GOODS exports in August jumped 26%, driven by a sharp jump in shipments to the US which rose by over 20% amid lower tariffs on India goods compared to last year, when heightened tensions with Washington led to 50% tariffs by August 27, 2025, according to data released Tuesday by the Ministry of Commerce.

In August, exports to the US jumped over 21% to \$8.3 billion compared to \$6.8 billion. This was the sharpest export jump to Washington this calendar year.

Depreciation in the domestic currency by over 10% also helped India's goods exports jump 26% to \$43.81 billion in August this year compared to \$34.74 billion during August 2025. Lower gold imports also helped goods imports last month grow at a slower pace of 14.05% to \$70.67 billion compared to \$61.96 billion in August 2025. This is the first time during the ongoing financial year that gold imports declined sharply to \$2.30 billion in August this year compared to \$5.44 billion in August last year.

"Goods import growth is lower than export growth. This has helped the goods trade deficit decline from \$26.86 billion in August this year compared to \$27.20 billion in August 2025,"

India's country-wise merchandise export



S.NO.	COUNTRIES	2024-25	2025-26	% CHANGE	AUGUST,2025	AUGUST, 2026	% CHANGE
1	USA	86,514	87,313	0.9	6,829	8,320	21.8
2	UAE	36,638	37,359	2.0	3,217	2,378	-26.1
3	CHINA	14,252	19,471	36.6	1,207	1,840	52.3
4	SINGAPORE	12,976	11,864	-8.6	720	1,878	161.0
5	NETHERLANDS	22,763	17,501	-23.1	1,698	878	-48.3

(SOURCE: DEPARTMENT OF COMMERCE STATISTICS DIVISION, DGFT; VALUE IN US\$ MILLION)

Commerce Secretary Rajesh Agarwal told the press.

The sharp jump in exports this August comes on a lower base, as US tariffs last year had begun impacting India. The first set of 25% reciprocal tariffs came into effect on August 7, 2025. And by August 27, additional tariffs of another 25% over Russian oil imports also came into effect, raising the overall tariffs to 50%.

Compared to August last

year, India's exports are only facing 10% tariffs. Meanwhile, economists said that the sharp rupee depreciation is also helping exports, but the benefits may be more visible in high-margin products.

An HSBC report last month said that high-tech exports (around half of core exports) show relatively higher uplift after rupee depreciation. "Within this bucket, machinery, electronics, and trans-

port show the most positive response over the two- to three-quarter horizon," the report said. "This is followed by low-tech exports, which respond modestly to the depreciating currency. Marine goods and food products show the most positive response in this category, and then have mid-tech exports (about one-third of the core exports), which show negligible response, and the results hold across categories like tex-

tiles, footwear, plastics, and stones, the report said. During the April to June quarter, high-end products such as engineering goods, electronics and pharmaceuticals grew 18.1%, 22.6% and 6.8%, respectively, and several labour-intensive sectors registered a sharp decline. Textile exports slipped 12.4%, while leather products declined 4.7%. Exports of low-margin products such as fruits and vegetables, ceramics and glassware, and jute products fell 10.3%, 25%, and 13.4%, respectively. Tea exports were under particular pressure, falling 17.5%. Of the 31 export sectors, 11 posted a year-on-year decline in April-June.

Non-petroleum and non-gems & jewellery exports in August 2026 also jumped by 22.72% to \$34.68 billion compared to \$28.26 billion in August 2025. Non-petroleum, non-gems & jewellery imports meanwhile in August 2026 were increased by 18.92% to \$49.22 billion compared to \$41.39 billion in August last year. SC Ralhan, president of the Federation of Indian Export Organisations, said the 26.12% growth in merchandise exports in August is encouraging and reflects the resilience, competitiveness and adaptability of Indian exporters.

FULL REPORT ON
WWW.INDIANEXPRESS.COM

Unemployment rate dips slightly to 5% in August

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 15

THE OVERALL unemployment rate (UR) among persons aged 15 years and above dropped slightly to 5% in August, as per the Periodic Labour Force Survey (PLFS) data released on Tuesday.

According to an official statement, the overall UR among persons aged 15 years and above declined marginally from 5.1% in July to 5 per cent in August. The UR also stood at 5.1% in August 2025.

During the same period, the rural unemployment rate decreased from 4.5% to 4.1% month-on-month, while urban UR remained almost stable at 6.8% in August compared to 6.7% in July. Compared with

August 2025, the overall UR and urban UR remained broadly stable in August 2026, whereas the rural UR declined by 0.2 percentage point to 4.1% in August against 4.3% in the same month a year ago. Since January 2026, rural UR recorded its lowest level in August, it stated.

The overall UR among males aged 15 years and above declined for the third consecutive month, reaching 4.9% in the month under review from 5.4% in May 2026. The rural male UR declined from 4.6% in July to 4.3% in August, while urban male UR marginally rose from 5.9% to 6.1% during the same period. Among females aged 15 years and above, overall UR declined for two consecutive months to 5.1% in August 2026 from 5.9% in June 2026.

Strong institutional appetite for NSE's IPO, says its CEO

Press Trust of India
New Delhi, September 15

DEMAND FOR the National Stock Exchange's (NSE) anchor book has been much higher than expected ahead of the exchange's Rs 22,569-crore IPO, Managing Director and CEO Ashishkumar Chauhan said on Tuesday, signalling strong institutional appetite for the mega issue. "Anchor book is pretty large, much more than we thought it would be," Chauhan told reporters here.

The bidding for anchor investors will take place on September 16. According to people familiar with the matter, investment majors, including Goldman Sachs Asset Management, Franklin Templeton and Fidelity International were among the early investors showing interest in the anchor book. Also, Norges Bank Investment Management, Abu Dhabi Investment Authority and GIC are likely to participate in the anchor book bidding, they said.

'YOUTH SHOULD BE WILLING TO PURSUE TRADE SKILLS'

Pvt sector must invest, hire & pay fairly: CEA

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 15

CALLING ON the private sector to "invest, hire, and compensate fairly", Chief Economic Advisor V Anantha Nageswaran on Tuesday cautioned that the country's youth should be willing to pursue trade skills instead of "conventional sources of education" which may not lead to jobs in the age of artificial intelligence (AI).

Speaking at a meeting of industry body ASSOCHAM, Nageswaran said the present was a "period of churn" and what had served India well since Independence may not be "adequate" for the next 25 years. This warrants individuals and households to "raise our game".

"...youngsters should be willing to be open-minded in pursuing trade skills as opposed to conventional sources of education, which may not find that much of employment traction given what is happening with respect to AI, etc," the government's top economist added.

He further said that given the numerous changes occurring in the world across geopolitics, supply chain, and technology, we all should be willing to embrace change. This, he said, is the "real requirement" for the Indian economy to sustain its growth.

India's economy grew by 7.8% in April-June, faster than what most experts had expected. According to Nageswaran, most actions required from the government to continue the economic momentum are in place. And while reforms to im-

CAUTIONARY NOTE

THIS IS not the first time that CEA Nageswaran has expressed concerns over wage growth in the private sector and its level of investments

IN MAY he had criticised the private sector's reluctance to invest, which he said might be contributing to demand uncertainty

UNEMPLOYMENT AMONG those aged 15-29 years stood at 15.1% in August, triple the overall rate of 5%



prove ease of living and doing business will continue, policy can't be only driver of the economy going forward. As such, the private sector "must invest, must hire, and must compensate fairly" and invest in research and development "because the next 20 years are going to be very different from the last 80 years, post-World War II." Nageswaran's warning comes amid increasing concerns about the replacement of jobs — especially entry-level ones that are taken up by new graduates — by AI models and automation.

As per data released on Tuesday by the statistics ministry, unemployment among those aged 15-29 years stood at 15.1% in August, triple the overall rate of 5%.

Meanwhile, a report by the NITI Aayog last month said that in 2021, as many as 8.7 crore people in the 15-29 age bracket were not in education, employment, or training.

Back in March, Azim Premji University's State of Working India 2026 report had said that less than 7% of male Indian graduates manage to find a permanent salaried job within a year.

The Cockroach Janata Party (CJP) led protests, too, have been cited by economists as a sign of a deeper jobs problem in the country.

This is not the first time Nageswaran has expressed concerns over the private sector not paying well or investing enough.

Back in May, he had criticised the private sector's reluctance to invest, which he said might be contributing to demand uncertainty.

Before that, in the Economic Survey for 2024-25, he had pointed out that even as corporate profitability had soared to a 15-year high in 2023-24, wage growth had lagged. This, the Survey had said, "raises concerns about income inequality".

BRIEFLY

FinMin to hold 2-day conference with states on Viksit Bharat

New Delhi: The Ministry of Finance is organising a two-day conference with state finance ministers and chief ministers on September 18-19 in Delhi focusing on 'Financing India's Journey towards Viksit Bharat'. The conference will see participation of industry leaders and secretaries from other ministries with sessions focused on macroeconomic goals, financing agricultural sector's transformation and energy transition. ENS

Adfactors wins PProvoke Media's 15 Global Agency of the Year award

New Delhi: PProvoke Media has announced the names of 15 agencies that will receive Global Agency of the Year awards at this year's PProvoke Media Global Summit in Chicago. The 15 winners were selected from among 75 agencies that will get Agency of the Year trophies in North America, EMEA, the Asia-Pacific and Latin America. Leading Indian public relations agency Adfactors was also among the winners. ENS

MARKETS

 Sensex 74,003.82 -777.94 -1.04%	 NIFTY 23,118.60 -279.50 -1.19%	 Gold ▼ ₹1,50,902	 US Dollar ▲ ₹95.96
		 Silver ▼ ₹2,28,741	 Oil ▲ \$128.70

NOTE: GOLD, SILVER RATES AS PER INDIA BULLION AND JEWELLERS ASSOCIATION GOLD PER 10G, SILVER PER 1KG; CRUDE OIL (INDIAN BASKET) AS OF SEPTEMBER 14, 2026

THE PRICE INDEX FOR SUGAR SOARED 19% IN AUGUST FROM JULY; THE YEAR-ON-YEAR INFLATION RATE WAS 24%

Sugar rush, chip price surge: RBI rate hike looms as price pressures spread

Siddharth Upasani
New Delhi, September 15

INDIA'S INFLATION — for households, wholesalers, and producers — increased in August. While the main retail inflation rate rose to an eight-month high of 4.82%, wholesale inflation rose to 9.92% and producers' output price inflation to 9.81%.

But it will be the smallest of the three numbers which will worry the Reserve Bank of India.

The central bank's inflation target is spelt out in terms of retail inflation, measured by the Consumer Price Index (CPI). And in August, CPI inflation saw some noteworthy developments which has led economists to predict the Monetary Policy Committee (MPC) will increase the policy repo rate on October 7 by 25

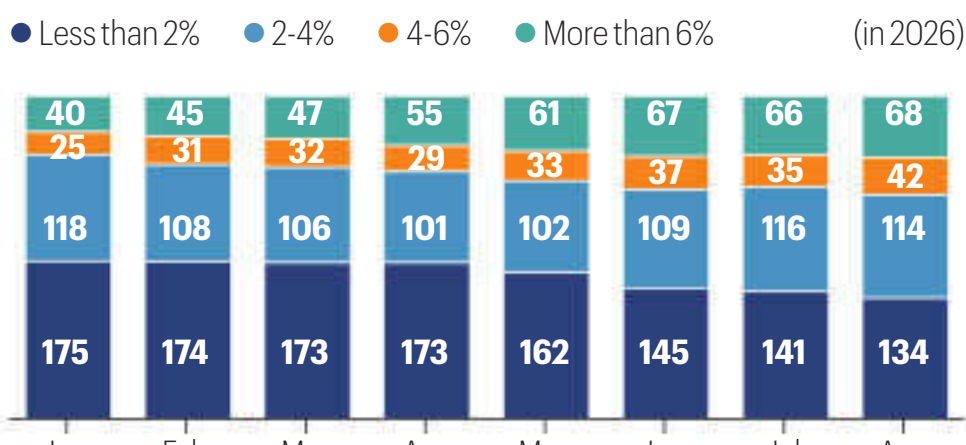
basis points (bps) to 5.5%. This would be the first interest rate hike in three-and-a-half years.

According to economists from ICICI Securities Primary Dealership, the MPC's "insistence" in August on waiting to see price pressures become more general and terming the current inflation rise as a supply shock "does not hold up to scrutiny".

"With broad array of input price pressures already showing up in PPI (Producer Price Index) measures synchronously across the world (including in China an economy known for producer price deflation), pass through to consumer prices is not a question of if but when.

"It is all the more so when underlying demand conditions are running strong like in India," they said in a report on Tuesday.

CPI basket items and their inflation rates



NOTE: RANGES ARE YEAR-ON-YEAR INFLATION RATES FOR EACH ITEM IN CPI BASKET
SOURCE: MOSPI, THE INDIAN EXPRESS CALCULATIONS

August sugar rush

The most noticeable aspect of the August CPI data was the jump in sugar prices.

The price index for sugar soared 19% in August from July; the year-on-year inflation rate was 24%. The price of jaggery was up 8% from July, candy and

misri 3%, sweets prepared with and without milk around 1.5%, cake, pastry, and breads 0.6%, and jams 0.5%. On the whole, the price index of the 'sugar, confectionery and desserts' category of the CPI rose 7.6% from July to August and was up 10.8% from last year. And even though this category only ac-

counts for just 1.4% of the entire CPI basket, it was "one of the largest drivers of food price momentum" and contributed around 15 bps to the headline inflation rate of 4.82%, according to Emkay Global Financial Services. With major festivals just around the corner, sugar is a crucial ingredient at this time of the year. With an eye on this, the government last month allowed duty-free imports of up to 10 lakh tonnes of raw sugar until October 31 after domestic prices spiked due to lower-than-expected production and multi-year-low inventories.

But prices have continued to rise in September. According to the Department of Consumer Affairs, the all-India average retail price of sugar was up 10% in the first half of September at Rs 60.85 per kg.

Chip price surge

Another small portion of the CPI that is now seen contributing to higher inflation is goods that contain memory chips.

The price of Dynamic Random Access Memory, or DRAM chips — used in everyday electronics — are expected to be up over 400% from the start of 2024 to the end of 2026. This is in stark contrast to the previous 70 or so years, when DRAM prices fell 90% every five years. This newspaper has been pointing out for several months that the spiralling price of memory chips used to make consumer electronics — or 'chipflation' — will soon reflect noticeably in the headline retail inflation rate. It has finally happened.

Inflation for the 'information and communication equipment' category rose to

2.95% in August after its price index rose on a sequential basis for the ninth month in a row. Expand this pool to include other key consumer electronics that require memory chips — refrigerators, washing machines, and air conditioners — and the price rise caused by the global AI boom can't be ignored.

Inflation for the broader 'information and communication' category more than tripled to 2.01% in August from 0.63% in July, with the relevant price index jumping 1.4% from one month to the next.

Price pressures spreading

The 'sugar, confectionery and desserts' and 'information and communication' categories together make up only about 5% of the CPI. So why do they matter for policymakers? Because these higher prices

can spread to other parts of the CPI. We have seen stark examples of this 'generalisation' of prices in the recent past: with the West Asia war making commercial cooking gas expensive, restaurants and cafes sharply increased their menu prices. Spreading of price pressures across the CPI can also be seen in the various items the consumption basket contains.

The number of items whose inflation was more than 4% has increased from 65 in January to 110 in August. While 110 may look like a small portion of the CPI basket since it contains 358 items, consider the following: prices of 314 of the 358 items were higher in August compared to July. In February, this number was 236. Clearly, it's not just sugar and consumer electronics that are becoming more expensive.



A passenger train hit by a Russian drone in Volyn region, Tuesday. REUTERS

Russia and Ukraine exchange fire despite Trump’s call for truce

Reuters
Kyiv, September 15

RUSSIA HIT petrol stations in Kyiv on Tuesday and Ukraine struck a Russian oil refinery, as the warningsides carried on with strikes on each other’s energy sites despite an announcement by US President Donald Trump that they had agreed to stop.

Russia launched 200 drones at Kyiv and other cities in overnight attacks, killing two people. In addition to petrol stations in Kyiv it struck energy and port infrastructure in other regions, Ukrainian officials said.

For its part, Ukraine hit a Russian oil refinery in Syzran in Russia’s Samara region on the Volga River, and also drone production facilities in the Taganrog and Oryol regions, President Volodymyr Zelenskyy said.

“Russia continues to attack our energy sector, regular logistics and critical infrastructure. And our responses to them for this are tangible,” Zelenskyy said on the Telegram app.

Trump said on Monday that Ukraine and Russia had agreed to halt strikes on each other’s energy infrastructure, which he

says are the main factor in a global fuel shortage that has driven diesel prices in the United States to record highs.

Zelenskyy said that Ukraine was ready to halt such strikes but required credible guarantees from its partners that Russia would also stop.

As Moscow’s attack on Ukraine was under way, neighbouring Poland held military aviation operations as a preventive step, Poland’s Armed Forces said, adding later that there was no violation of its airspace.

In Lithuania, a NATO fighter jet shot down a drone early on Tuesday, the National Crisis Management Centre said. It did not say the origin of the drone. Similar incidents in the Baltic region in recent months have involved Ukrainian drones that Kyiv says were steered across NATO borders by Russian signal jamming.

In Denmark, a Russian frigate fired two flares towards a Danish military helicopter sent to photograph it in international waters off Denmark on Monday, with one narrowly missing the aircraft, the Danish military said.

• BRIEFLY

UNITED STATES

Maduro ally Alex Saab pleads guilty in federal money laundering case



Alex Saab (right) with former president Nicolas Maduro. FILE

A CLOSE ally of ousted Venezuelan President Nicolas Maduro pleaded guilty Tuesday to a single count of money laundering tied to an alleged bribery conspiracy to win lucrative government contracts in Venezuela. As part of the plea deal, Alex Saab agreed to cooperate in continuing federal probe and forfeit \$195 million in criminal proceeds from the scheme. Saab, 54, was deported in May by Venezuela’s acting President Delcy Rodriguez to the US, which has been targeting the businessman for more than a decade. AP

TURKEY

150 detained for protest over LGBTQ+ arrests

TURKISH AUTHORITIES detained at least 150 people on Tuesday after police intervened at a gathering outside Istanbul’s Caglayan courthouse, where demonstrators had planned to protest about recent detentions targeting LGBTQ+ groups. On Tuesday, group gathered to make a press statement, but police prevented them from doing so outside courthouse. REUTERS

ISRAEL

Israeli airstrikes in Gaza kill two, including a child

ISRAELI AIRSTRIKES hit a vehicle, killing at least two Palestinians, including a child, and wounding seven others in Gaza on Tuesday, the territory’s health officials said. The Israeli military said it had struck a militant in the area, without elaborating. Witnesses said some of casualties resulted from a second strike that hit near a group of people who rushed to help. REUTERS

SAUDI-BACKED YEMENI GOVT SAYS HOUTHIS MAINTAIN CONTROL OF WEST COAST

Saudi, Houthis trade strikes as Yemen conflict intensifies

Saudi Arabian civil defence issues brief alerts over threats to cities across nation

Ismaeel Naar
Dubai, September 15

SAUDI ARABIA and the Iran-backed Houthis in Yemen on Tuesday accused each other of launching attacks at their territories, with reports of casualties on both sides, days after the Iran-backed militia seized key areas of Yemen’s Red Sea coast.

A Saudi military spokesman, Maj. Gen. Turki al-Malki, said that the Houthis had targeted three cities across the kingdom, injuring 13 people, without specifying when the attacks happened. The Houthis have not commented on those attacks.

Also on Tuesday, the Houthi-run Health Ministry in Yemen’s capital, Sanaa, said in a statement that Saudi airstrikes had killed three people, including two children, in Taiz province. The Saudi government did not respond to a request for comment regarding the strikes.

The Saudi Civil Defence issued emergency alerts overnight



Egypt President Abdel-Fattah el-Sisi, right, with Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman at Presidential Palace in Cairo on Tuesday. AP

in several cities on the country’s western coast, including Jeddah, Yanbu and Taif, and issued additional emergency alerts on Tuesday afternoon for Mecca, Jeddah and Taif.

Officials from a Saudi-backed Yemeni government, which is based in the south of the country and opposes the Houthis, said the Saudi and Yemeni air forces had been responding to Houthi advances by stepping up aerial bombardment of Houthi targets. But the Yemeni officials acknowledged that the Houthis had now taken effective control over almost the entire western coast of the

country along the Red Sea.

“The Houthis are being put under heavy pressure. They in turn are putting more and more pressure on the Saudis, increasing their campaign of missile and drone attacks,” one of the Yemeni officials said.

Meanwhile on Tuesday, Saudi Arabia’s Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman met Egyptian President Abdel Fattah al-Sisi in Cairo on Tuesday. A statement from the Egyptian presidency after the meeting said the leaders stressed the need to ensure freedom and security of navigation in the Bab el-Mandeb and the Red Sea.

78th PRIMETIME EMMY AWARDS

Widow’s Bay sets record with 14 wins, including best comedy

Reuters
Los Angeles, September 15

• WINNERS AT 78th EMMY AWARDS



Cast of Widows Bay with the Outstanding Comedy Series Award

 BEST COMEDY ACTRESS Jean Smart, <i>Hacks</i>	 BEST DRAMA ACTRESS Rhea Seehorn, <i>Pluribus</i>	 BEST DRAMA ACTOR Noah Wyle, <i>The Pitt</i>
 BEST ACTOR, LIMITED SERIES OR MOVIE Matthew Rhys, <i>The Beast in Me</i>	 BEST ACTRESS, LIMITED SERIES OR MOVIE Sally Field <i>Remarkably Bright Creatures</i>	 BOB HOPE HUMANITARIAN AWARD Michael J. Fox
BEST LIMITED OR ANTHOLOGY SERIES: DTF <i>St. Louis</i>		
BEST DRAMA SERIES: <i>The Pitt</i>		

awards on Monday for supporting actress, directing and writing. Combined with technical and other awards handed out earlier this month, the show earned 14 Emmys, a record for a comedy in a single season.

HBO Max murder mystery *DTF St. Louis* won best limited series.

Best drama actress went to Rhea Seehorn, who plays a misanthropic woman at war with an

unfailingly kind alien hive mind on *Pluribus*, another win on a big night for Apple TV.

The academy honoured Michael J Fox during the ceremony for his advocacy for Parkinson’s disease research and treatment.

Speaking from a wheelchair, Fox said support from Hollywood allowed him to keep acting after his diagnosis with Parkinson’s. “It’s because you stood up for me,” he told the crowd.

UK, Netherlands, US flag Iranian spyware threat

London: Britain, the United States and the Netherlands on Tuesday issued a joint cybersecurity advisory detailing spyware they say is used by Iranian state-linked actors to target dissidents, activists and journalists.

Britain’s National Cyber Security Centre said Iranian state-linked cyber actors had used spyware known as “CHOSEN BRICK” to steal emails, messages and other sensitive information through spearphishing campaigns on WhatsApp and Telegram.

The malware can collect contact lists, emails and social media information, capture screen content and access a device’s microphone. REUTERS

The crown prince met the US regional military commander, Admiral Brad Cooper, in Jeddah on Monday, and phoned President Donald Trump last week seeking military support, which so far has been limited to intelligence aid. NYT WITH REUTERS INPUTS

US strips millions in military aid from Europe and West Asia to back Trump-aligned nations in Americas

Associated Press
Washington, September 15

THE TRUMP administration is stripping tens of millions of dollars in US military assistance from countries in Europe and West Asia to support conservative-leaning governments in Central and South America.

The State Department on Tuesday notified Congress that it will reprogram \$52 million in foreign military financing from Slovakia, North Macedonia, Tunisia and Iraq to Panama, Peru, Ecuador and Colombia.

Secretary of State Marco Rubio visited Colombia, Ecuador and Peru last week and pledged to them additional support as the Trump administration has prioritized the Western Hemisphere in its foreign policy with an emphasis on combating drug trafficking and illegal immigration.

It is just the latest in a series of moves that have reduced either money or troop deployments to Europe in response to President Donald Trump’s complaints about NATO allies not



Secretary of State Marco Rubio

spending enough on their defense budgets and other matters. Both North Macedonia and Slovakia are NATO members.

The State Department said the funds would be used to “combat narcoterrorism in our backyard and help continue to secure the Panama Canal,” adding that the Western Hemisphere has been historically neglected in US military assistance.

“These funds will prevent adversaries from establishing strategic footholds in our hemisphere,” the department said in a veiled jab at China, which has increasingly sought to boost its presence in Latin America.

US admits for the first time putting weapons in space

Washington: The United States has confirmed for the first time that it has deployed weapons in space. Air Force Secretary Troy Meink told the Air and Space Cyber Conference in Maryland on Monday that the US has fielded “on-orbit space control weapons capable of defending the Joint Force against hostile adversary action.”

Meink did not detail what the weapons were or how they work. In 2024 the US said Russia was developing a new anti-satellite weapon that could be launched from space. At the time the White House said the danger wasn’t imminent.

But reports of the anti-satellite weapon reflected longstanding worries about space threats from Russia and China, given that much US infrastructure is dependent on satellite communications. AP

Italian Senate clears Meloni’s electoral reform amid opposition resistance

Rome: A contested reform of Italy’s electoral law won Senate approval on Tuesday amid fierce opposition criticism, as rivals accused Prime Minister Giorgia Meloni of changing the rules to improve her chances of winning re-election next year.

Meloni’s conservative coalition, including Brothers of Italy, the League and Forza Italia, has

put forward a fully proportional voting system that would guarantee a parliamentary majority to any alliance winning more than 42% of the vote. The measure still needs final approval from Italy’s lower house.

Under the current system, most lawmakers are elected through proportional representation, while a third are chosen in

first-past-the-post constituencies that analysts say may favour the centre-left opposition. The reform would abolish these.

The coalition said the reform, approved by 113 votes to 71, would ensure political stability. Meloni took office in 2022 and this month became the leader of Italy’s longest-lasting administration since WW II.

• THE REPORT RELEASED A NUMBER OF ALARMING FINDINGS— A.I. HAS CAUSED ‘MAJOR SHIFTS IN CAMPUS CULTURE, ISOLATING STUDENTS WHO ARE SKIPPING OFFICE HOURS AND DITCHING COMMUNAL STUDYING

As AI takes over more of our thinking, an MIT report warns of ‘cognitive surrender’

Mark Arsenault, Dana Goldstein, Alan Blinder & Sarah Mervosh
September 15

THE WORRIES that artificial intelligence is degrading education have been building for months. Students are using it for everything, including cheating, and a recent report out of MIT said it is triggering “cognitive surrender.” Many university leaders are embracing AI with enthusiasm anyway.

As AI leaders warn about the dangers of their own technology, the dissonance between the optimism of university leaders and the fears of many students and professors may increase. Profes-

sors and students are often in a bind about what they should do: Use more AI to stay relevant, or dial back to preserve learning and thinking?

While some politicians and AI leaders are warning about possible doomsday scenarios for humanity as AI models advance, many campus leaders are focused on existential threat the technology poses to universities.

The committee at the Massachusetts Institute of Technology studying AI use released a number of alarming findings, including that the technology has caused “major shifts in campus culture,” isolating students who are skipping office hours and ditching communal studying.

Getting answers from a bot can create “the illusion of learning” for students who reach for AI “at the first hint of struggle,” the MIT committee wrote in its August report.

At the same time, “the potential of these technologies to augment work across campus is immense,” the committee wrote.

The MIT report crystallized some of the thinking in higher education about AI, but top administrators have been embroiled in debates for several years. Administrators have often been the most eager to champion AI efforts, while faculty and students remain skeptical.

“I think you have to lean in, but you have to do so in a way



Some varsity leaders say schools must embrace AI to stay relevant. NYT

that’s thoughtful and ethical and asks the right questions,” said Wendy Hensel, the president of the University of Hawaii, where

she presented an AI strategy to regents in July. “The right answer to AI is not just ‘no.’ It can’t be. It has to be approached

with curiosity and understanding of the implications.”

The hodgepodge of policies universities have created to respond to AI often reflect the confusion about how to proceed — with some clear dos and don’ts, but often a lot of wiggle room for faculty and students to figure it out on their own.

For a motivated student, an AI chatbot can function as a sort of tutor. Chatbots can break down the steps in a math problem, surface unexpected sources for research papers and offer feedback on writing.

Still, a growing body of research suggests that AI use can also harm learning.

A recent study of 26,000 Chi-

nese secondary-school students found that AI adoption led to an 18 percent increase in homework scores, but a 20 percent decline in scores on secure exams. The implication was that rushing through homework with help from chatbots degraded the deeper learning needed to perform well when the technology was not available.

One 2025 study out of MIT found that people who used chatbots as writing assistants struggled to remember what they had written only minutes after finishing their essay. “You basically didn’t engage any of the memory networks that would actually help you remember,” said Nataliya Kos-

myrna, a MIT researcher who worked on the study.

Other research has shown that people who have greater trust in AI and rely on it more are more likely to have lower cognitive engagement. But AI can be hard to avoid. Chatbots are embedded within the Google Classroom suite, which is nearly ubiquitous in schools, and within many online learning systems used by universities.

Some tools block outright cheating or plagiarism and allow professors to toggle specific AI capabilities on and off. But the most popular chat bots among students will complete entire assignments, including research papers, on student’s behalf. NYT

The Big Picture

WEDNESDAY, SEPTEMBER 16, 2026

15



Pavan. Akshat. Arpit. Abhishek. Yuvraj.

ONCE THERE WERE 5 STUDENTS

They came from Auraiya, Dewas, Durg, Katni, Jhansi — 17-19-year-olds who thought Delhi would help them spread their wings far beyond their small towns. Until, one day, the big city came crashing down on them. PRAGYNESH, TABSHIR SHAMS & JAYPRAKASH S NAIDU tell their stories

TO BE a 17-year-old in Delhi. For Pavan Yadav, that meant visits to gaming arcades, eyeing a super car in a mall, tucking into Dolma Auntie's momos that tasted so much better than the ones in his small-town Auraiya in Uttar Pradesh, and borrowing deep into his new Murakami book that he wouldn't let his sisters touch.

"At home, he used to be so picky about food, but in Delhi, he had something good to say even about the mess food. He loved the city," says Aparna, 25, the eldest of his four siblings.

But like many teenage loves, this wasn't meant to be. The quiet boy from Auraiya, with a head full of curls and a love for all things tech, died on September 6 when the private hostel building they stayed in collapsed in Delhi, burying seven, five of them Delhi University (DU) students like him. Delhi had failed him, a little over a month after he had discovered the city.

"Even as a child, Delhi was the only city he wanted to visit. And once he moved there, he would talk about his friends, how they were exploring the city. He was living out his dream," says Aparna, an economics teacher at a private school in Auraiya.

In July, Pavan followed his sister Priyanshi, 19, into Delhi University, enrolling for a BSc (Computer Science) at Motilal Nehru College.

The family worried for him. How would the shy boy find his space in a city where people spoke louder and harsher than needed?

"He wouldn't talk a lot. Not even with his school teachers. He was mostly by himself. He would watch videos related to tech and fast cars," says Priyanshi, a second-year BSc student at Daulat Ram College in DU's North Campus.

When Pavan moved into Hostel Daze, a paying guest accommodation at Delhi's Satya Niketan, the family was reassured that at least Priyanshi was around for him. "He would call on video from his room, show us the car stickers and anime posters on his walls," recalls Aparna.

Satya Niketan is a cluster of paying guest facilities that cater to students in the university's South Campus colleges. It's relatively more open than the city's other student hubs, including Kamla Nagar near North Campus, where Priyanshi lived. What they didn't know was that like many of the other buildings in Satya Niketan, Hostel Daze stood on unsteady ground. Built to be a two-floor structure, it was illegally extended to five floors, and construction was on in the basement to make more rooms.

That Sunday noon, September 6, Priyanshi was in her hostel room, scrolling through Instagram when she came across a video of the building collapse at Satya Niketan.

"I didn't know what to do. I was trembling. I called the operator of the building, but he didn't answer. I called Pavan, but his phone was switched off. I rushed to Satya Niketan by 4 pm. I told the rescue personnel that my brother was inside, but they wouldn't let me in," says Priyanshi.

She then rushed to AIIMS. By then, some people had been rescued from the debris. Two bodies were found, neither of them Pavan's.

Priyanshi then rushed back to Satya Niketan, showing Pavan's photo to those who assembled at the site.

Aparna says, "A Blinkit ambulance driver then told Priyanshi that he had taken Pavan to AIIMS. So she rushed back to the hospital. There, after much pleading, a nurse confirmed that Pavan's body was in the mortuary."

In the days since then, Pavan's father Vishambhar Nath, a retired doctor, and mother Meera Devi have gone silent. They now plan to file an official complaint against the government and 'Hostel Daze' for their son's death.

The family last got together for Raksha Bandhan, after which Priyanshi and Pavan had travelled back to Delhi together. This time, she will have to make that journey alone.

'I wanted him to fall in love'

In Akshat Singh's house in Katni, Madhya Pradesh, is a world he left behind. A wooden table sits pushed against the wall. On it, a shelf with stacks of NCERT books, BCom Business Studies textbooks, a copy of the Constitution, Arundhati Roy's *The God of Small Things*, Jostein Gaarder's *Sophie's World* and *Secret* by Rhonda Byrne. On a lower shelf, two swords rest side by side, one still in its brown sheath. Above them, a row of toys — a T-Rex, and Iron Man and Captain America figurines.

Akshat's father Manta Singh speaks of his first born as someone far wiser than his

Yuvraj had moved into Hostel Daze only on September 1, five days before it collapsed. Soon, he was sending his family videos — of his room that looked "posh", of the view from his balcony, of his daily thali



19 years — the class topper who played chess like a dream, the one the family turned to for advice, the son who never needed to be told what to do.

While being enrolled at Delhi's PGDAV College, where he was a second-year BCom student, Akshat prepared for the UPSC exams. "You need to be 21 to sit for the exam. But he started preparing a year ago. *Usko aasan raasta pasand nahi tha* (He never took the easy way out)," recalls Manta Singh, an architect who runs his own business.

Akshat's self-imposed dedication, says the father, led him to often isolate himself while studying. "When his friends came to see him, he would ask his mother to tell them he wasn't home. He was already writing Mains-level answers, that too very fast — 250 to 280 words in five minutes, sometimes," says his father.

In Class 10, Akshat scored 90%. In Class 11, he took up kho-kho, fencing and later, chess, which took him all the way to state-level championships in Bhopal.

Then, sometime in his first year of graduation, he decided he wanted to be a civil servant. "He read a lot of philosophy, took life so seriously, I used to tell him to relax a little," says Manta Singh, his voice low. "But he was clear that he wanted to become a Chief Secretary some day."

Since his first year of college, Akshat had been living in Delhi's Hostel Daze, managing a monthly budget of around Rs 20,000. "When he joined the hostel last year, I dropped him off after paying the rent and brokerage. He handled everything else," says Manta Singh.

"I didn't want a lot from him. I just wanted him to fall in love, enjoy his life, go



(Clockwise from above) Akshat (in teal T-shirt) and Arpit (striped shirt) at Navneet's birthday party in Hostel Daze; Arpit with his mother Pushpa; Akshat's books at his home in Katni, Madhya Pradesh; Pavan's collection of model cars at his home in Auraiya

on trips, be with his friends."

Singh would be happy to know his son did let his hair down sometimes. A photograph that his friend Navneet shared with *The Indian Express* shows Akshat at Navneet's birthday party, splotches of cake on his face and his T-shirt. He isn't smiling, but strikes a goofy pose.

'Called mother five times a day'

Arpit Jaj, 19, is in the photograph too, wearing a striped T-shirt. Akshat and Arpit were part of a group of six, says Navneet. Akshat, Arpit, Sarthak, Krishna, Shrestha and Navneet — all in different DU colleges but shared the same hostel and hung out together.

On the day of the collapse, Navneet had gone to Meerut with his family, and Shrestha and Sarthak were visiting a relative. Krishna had moved out to another flat in Satya Niketan only two months earlier. Arpit and Akshat were trapped, and later declared dead.

If Akshat was quiet, Arpit, a second-year BCom student at DU's Atma Ram Sanatan Dharma College, was outgoing, extroverted, the life of every gathering.

"Arpit and I shared a room at the hostel. Everyone used to hang out in our room, and Arpit would entertain them. We would talk for hours, play games, and put on music," says Navneet.

Arpit's friends say the boy from Dewas, Madhya Pradesh, walked through every door that DU opened, making sure he never

missed a music society event, debate, or dance fest. Every Saturday night, he organised a small get-together in his room. His evenings ended with a walk through Satya Niketan's lanes.

But he always found time to call his mother Pushpa — "at least five times a day," says Arpit's father Bhupendra Jaj, a taxi driver in Dewas. "He was very close to her, shared everything. He would call her soon after waking up, then again while on his way to college, once after coming back, and then before sleeping."

He says Pushpa now simply sits staring at her phone. The last time Arpit called her was around noon on September 6, two hours before the building collapsed.

Arpit, who was preparing for his Cost and Management Accountancy exam, had already cleared the foundation level. He loved anime and rap songs, topics he could talk about for hours with anyone willing to listen.

"Most of us were school toppers," Navneet says of the group of six. "We came to DU to study, to make a mark in life. Now only four of us remain." He hasn't found the courage to go back to Satya Niketan, to the lanes they once called home.

'Learn to adjust, I told him'

A year ago, Abhishek Kumar put his foot down — he would study in Delhi University, nowhere else. "His sister studies in Jhansi, his elder brother is in Kota. Abhishek had got into Banaras Hindu University as well, but he wanted to study in DU and prepare for MBA. Delhi has good MBA coaching institutes, he would keep saying," recalls his father Santosh, a machine operator in a factory in Jhansi, Uttar Pradesh.

His "dream city" disappointed him soon enough. "He would sometimes tell me about the small rooms in the hostel, the bad food. But I would always console him, saying no place was perfect," says Santosh.

Santosh would remind his youngest child of his larger goal. "I would tell him that he had been one of the best students in school, that he was working towards what he wanted. Learn to adjust, I told him. And then, this..." he says, breaking down.

'I called him 50 times that day'

For Yuvraj Soni — "Honey" to his family — staying away from home was difficult. So when he left Chhattisgarh's Durg after securing a seat in DU's Motilal Nehru College, the 19-year-old found a way to keep his home close to him: daily video calls and a steady stream of photographs.

He could talk for hours, especially to his mother Kavita, 45, and sister Siddhi, 13.

"After he went to Delhi on July 27, 2025, he would get very emotional and say he did not want to live there. We encouraged him, saying it was just a matter of a few years," says Kavita.

Growing up, Yuvraj gave them no reasons to complain: he cracked the CA foundation exam all by himself, and willingly stepped up for the family. "He would take care of our needs from Delhi, with banking work, paying bills or his sister's project work. While home, he would play cricket or spend hours taking care of his plants on our terrace," says the mother, holding back her tears.

He had moved into the Hostel Daze only on September 1, five days before it collapsed. He earlier stayed in a room in DU's North campus, but it took him two hours to reach college. The hostel looked good: Rs 14,000 for a room on the fourth floor, with food served four times a day. His college was just 15 minutes away.

Soon, he was sending his family videos — of his room that looked "posh", and the view from his balcony of students performing bhajan at a nearby Bholenath temple. He also sent photographs of his daily *thali* of dal, curry, vegetables and roti, all of which, he told his mother, "tasted good".

On September 6, around 1.20 pm, Yuvraj was on the phone with his childhood friend Gunjan Sahu — who, like him, had made the journey from Durg to DU — when the call ended abruptly. That was the last time anyone had spoken to Yuvraj.

Gunjan then contacted Kavita, before rushing to the site. Back in Durg, Kavita started making frantic calls. "It has never happened that he did not answer calls. I called 50 times that day," she says.

Finally, around 5.30 pm, a policeman answered Yuvraj's phone and told Kavita to rush to Delhi.

Days after the tragedy, it's all quiet at the Soni household in Durg's Panchsheel Nagar. "The day we lost Yuvraj was my daughter's birthday. She says she will never celebrate her birthday," says Kavita.

The medical store that Yuvraj's father Kanhaiya ran from the ground floor of their house remains shut. "I will continue to fight till my son gets justice," he says.

A photograph of Akshat at Navneet's birthday party in Hostel Daze has him with splotches of cake on his face and T-shirt. Akshat isn't smiling, but strikes a goofy pose

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If there are questions of current or contemporary relevance that you would like explained, please write to explained@indianexpress.com

• POLICY

Kishau dam pact inked: The long delay in project, stakes for 6 states

Saurabh Parashar & Harikishan Sharma
Shimla, New Delhi, September 15

THE CHIEF ministers of six states on Tuesday signed a memorandum of understanding (MoU) to pave the way for the implementation of the long-pending 422 MW Kishau Multipurpose Project.

Himachal Pradesh Chief Minister Sukhvinder Singh Sukhu signed the MoU for the Rs 15,000-crore project with Uttarakhand CM Pushkar Singh Dhami, Uttar Pradesh CM Yogi Adityanath, Haryana CM Nayab Singh Saini, Rajasthan CM Bhajan Lal Sharma, and Delhi CM Rekha Gupta. Union Home Minister Amit Shah and Union Jal Shakti Minister CR Patil were present. The Union Cabinet will now have to approve the project.

What is the Kishau Multipurpose Project?

The Kishau Multipurpose Project is a proposed dam and hydropower project on the Tons River, a major tributary of the Yamuna, along the border shared by Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. The project envisages a 232.6-metre-high concrete gravity dam that will generate 1,476 million units of clean hydropower.

The project site straddles Himachal Pradesh's Sirmaur district and Uttarakhand's Dehradun district. The two states signed an MoU to form a joint venture in June 2015, and Kishau Corporation Ltd was incorporated in January 2017. The project is intended to generate electricity, create irrigation potential of about 97,076 hectares, and provide drinking and industrial water to the beneficiary states, Haryana, Delhi, Rajasthan and Uttar Pradesh.

Why was the Kishau Dam required?

Kishau Dam was one of three storage projects planned in the upper reaches of the Yamuna and its tributaries following an MoU signed on May 12, 1994 by the Yamuna basin States — undivided Uttar Pradesh, Haryana, Rajasthan, Himachal Pradesh, and the National Capital Territory of Delhi — regarding the allocation of Yamuna water.

The other two projects were Lakhwar and Renukaji, for which the MoUs have already been signed and are under implementation. These projects were required because there are no storage facilities constructed on the Upper Yamuna — from its source, Yamunotri glacier, in the lower Himalayas to the Okhla barrage in Delhi — a catchment area of about 30,000 square kilometres. As per the 1994 MoU, an interim seasonal allocation of the annual utilisable flow of river Yamuna was made among these five states.

Why was the signing of the MoU delayed?

For eight years, Himachal Pradesh held out on signing the MoU for two key reasons — the project cost burden, particularly the power component, and concerns that the state would not enjoy proportionate benefits.

Under an earlier arrangement, the previous BJP-led Himachal government agreed to contribute about Rs 800 crore towards the project cost. The current Congress-led government rejected that arrangement, saying it was not in Himachal's financial interest, and that it would suffer substantial land submergence and displacement.

Indeed, the project will result in substantial submergence in both Himachal Pradesh and Uttarakhand. According to a 2020 feasibility study, around 2,950 hectares of land would be submerged, affecting 17 villages and about 5,500 people, across the two states.

How was a solution reached?

A breakthrough was achieved in June 2026 when the Centre announced that it would bear 90% of the project cost, with the six states sharing the remaining 10%.

A senior Himachal Pradesh officer told *The Indian Express*: "This project will have a storage capacity of 1,786 million cubic metres (MCM) of water but will actually store 1,324 MCM. As per the joint agreements... Haryana will get 633 MCM; Uttar Pradesh will get 411 MCM; Rajasthan will get 124 MCM; Delhi will get 80 MCM; Himachal will get 42 MCM and Uttarakhand will get 34 MCM for drinking and industrial purposes."

• SCIENCE

US's orbital weapons: The limits of global pacts governing space militarisation

Amिताabh Sinha
New Delhi, September 15

THE US on Tuesday said it had active weapons deployed in space, the first such public admission by any country, sparking a fresh debate. The US did not reveal the nature of weapons deployed, or when they were deployed.

"Today we continue to ensure we remain ready to meet the challenges of evolving threats wherever they exist. This is why the US now has on-orbit space control weapons capable of defending the joint force against hostile adversary action," US Air Force Secretary Troy Meink said at a conference in Maryland, according to *CNN*.

There was immediate reaction from China and Russia, two countries that the US considers its space adversaries. "We urge the US side to stop expanding its military capabilities and preparing for war in outer space," Chinese foreign ministry spokesman Guo Jiakun told reporters, according to *AFP*.

That same report also quoted Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov calling for keeping space free of any weapons. "We are counting on broad international consolidation to continue working toward the com-

plete demilitarisation of space," he said.

Interestingly, the US accuses China and Russia of improving their space capabilities with the objective of tracking and targeting US forces. "China and Russia are also testing and fielding sophisticated counter-space capabilities with the intent to disrupt and degrade US space-enabled capabilities," reads a factsheet on space threats, published on the website of the US Space Force, set up in 2019.

Weaponisation of space

Although this is the first time a country has publicly admitted to deploying weapons in space, the capabilities to do so are neither new nor a revelation. The military use of outer space covers a wide variety of capabilities: the ability to launch a missile from Earth to destroy enemy satellites or other space-based assets, the ability to send weapons from space to destroy ground-based targets, or the use of space-based weapons to target space-based assets. It is not clear which of these categories the US's newly-acknowledged weapons fall into.

But the weapons need not be "kinetic" — they need not necessarily be able to cause physical destruction of enemy targets. The ability to disrupt or jam the

• STAR WARS

Use of weapons in space can take different forms. They can be used to either **destroy**, or to **jam**, equipment.

EARTH-TO-SPACE	SPACE-TO-SPACE	SPACE-TO-EARTH
Anti-satellite tests	Co-orbital satellites	Weapons deployed in space
• Involves launching missiles from earth to destroy space-based assets	• One satellite can be programmed to crash into an enemy satellite	• Satellite-based weapons can deorbit, enter atmosphere, and strike Earth-based targets
• Four countries demonstrated this	• Soviet Union reported to have tested this during the Cold War	• Not demonstrated
• Earth-based systems can jam or 'blind' signals of enemy satellites	• Using space-based assets to jam or block the signals or comms of enemy satellites	• Use of space-based systems to interfere or disrupt functioning of radars, missiles or aircraft
• Many have this capability	• No known capability	• Not known

enemy's communications between its space and Earth-based systems, or attack their cyber-networks, can also be extremely effective in a conflict situation.

Several countries have developed some, or all, of these capabilities, though not every such capability has been tested and demonstrated.

The most open demonstrations of such capabilities have been the anti-satellite tests, in which countries send a missile to destroy a satellite in space. Four countries — the US, Russia, China and India — have demonstrated this. Though the countries

targeted their own non-functional satellites during the tests, this ability to completely destroy any space-based asset happens to be the most dramatic use of weapons in space to date.

There have been examples of non-kinetic methods as well. Just before the Russian attack on Ukraine in February 2022, Russian hackers gained control over ground stations of the Viasat satellite that was being used to provide internet services to Ukrainian subscribers, including their military agencies. There are also reports of attempts by Russia to block GPS signals in Ukraine.

Legal ambiguity

All countries emphasise on peaceful uses of space and call upon each other not to militarise space. But there is no international law that explicitly prohibits the deployment or use of such weapons or tactics in space. The Outer Space Treaty of 1967, an old but still the most relevant international law on this subject, bars countries from carrying or placing nuclear weapons or "other kinds of weapons of mass destruction" in space, but it is silent on conventional weapons, or those that target physical infrastructure in space. It does not say

anything about earth-to-space weapons, the development of which was still some distance away in the 1960s.

Attempts to create an international legal framework to regulate the deployment and use of weapons in space were made, but support from all the major space powers was lacking. Around 2008, China and Russia had together proposed the idea of a "Prevention of the Placement of Weapons in Outer Space" treaty banning the deployment of all weapons — not just nuclear and other weapons of mass destruction — in space, but this too left out earth-to-space weapons. This idea never came to fruition.

An ongoing discussion on "Prevention of an Arms Race in Outer Space" at the UN Conference on Disarmament has also not led to any international law or treaty.

Meanwhile, the Artemis Accords, an initiative of NASA and the US State Department, is a voluntary code of conduct on exploration of space. It has over 70 signatory countries, including India. All cooperative activities are meant to be for peaceful purposes, but there is nothing that prevents signatories from deploying or using weapons in space.

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• ECONOMY

Why rising US govt bond yields are worry for world



UDIT MISRA

OVER THE PAST few months, there has been a growing worry about the rise in government bond yields worldwide. On Tuesday, the 10-year US bond yield hit a two-decade high.

A government bond is a document in which it acknowledges that it is taking a loan from someone and details how much it will pay back and by when. The government borrows money to meet the gap between its spending (defence, subsidies and more) and earnings (levying taxes).

The "yield" on a government bond is the interest that the government pays. Rising yield means that the government will have to shell out more money as interest payment; it is similar to your car or home loan EMI increasing when the bank tells you that interest rates have risen. In both cases, the borrower (the government or you) has to keep aside more money next month to pay back.

Another direct fallout is that the borrower will have less money left for other activities, be it the government spending on welfare or infrastructure, or you having money to shop or travel. Beyond a point, however, rising payments on the same loan amount reach a tipping point that makes it nearly impossible for the government or an individual to manage their respective budgets.

What is the problem with high yields?

The apprehension today is that the world is nearing that tipping point.

There is an additional sting when interest rates go up for the government, in that they go up for everyone (including you) in the economy. Why? Because lending to the government is the safest kind of lending there is. As far as the ability to pay back a loan is concerned, a government has the superpower to print its own money, unlike every other borrower.

If the interest rates on the safest loan are rising, lenders start demanding higher rates from all others as well. This not only means higher EMI for existing car or home loans but also for newer loans of all manner. An entrepreneur wanting to start an innovative business will find that either the funding has dried up or become too costly. Thus, beyond a certain point, a rise in government bond yields can drag down the whole economy.

Here's a further kicker. If the government in question is the United States government, then the ramifications of higher yields on US government bonds are not limited to just its US economy; they start affecting other economies and people in a land far, far away from Washington DC.

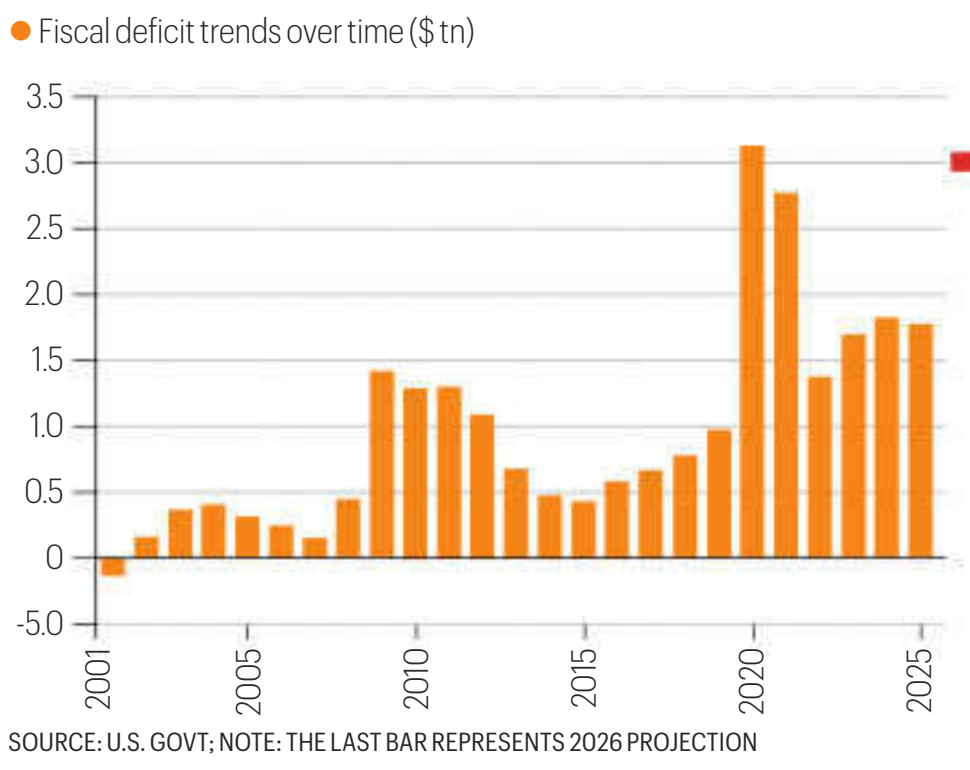
That's because while a government is the safest entity to lend to in any economy, at a global level, there is a gradation for governments. Not all governments are equally credit-worthy and they can default on their loans. Imagine lending money to the Pakistan government for a 10-year period in 1965.

The US government is the safest borrower in the world. It has been considered so safe that parking your savings in US government bonds — that is, lending to the US government — has often been considered as safe as investing in gold.

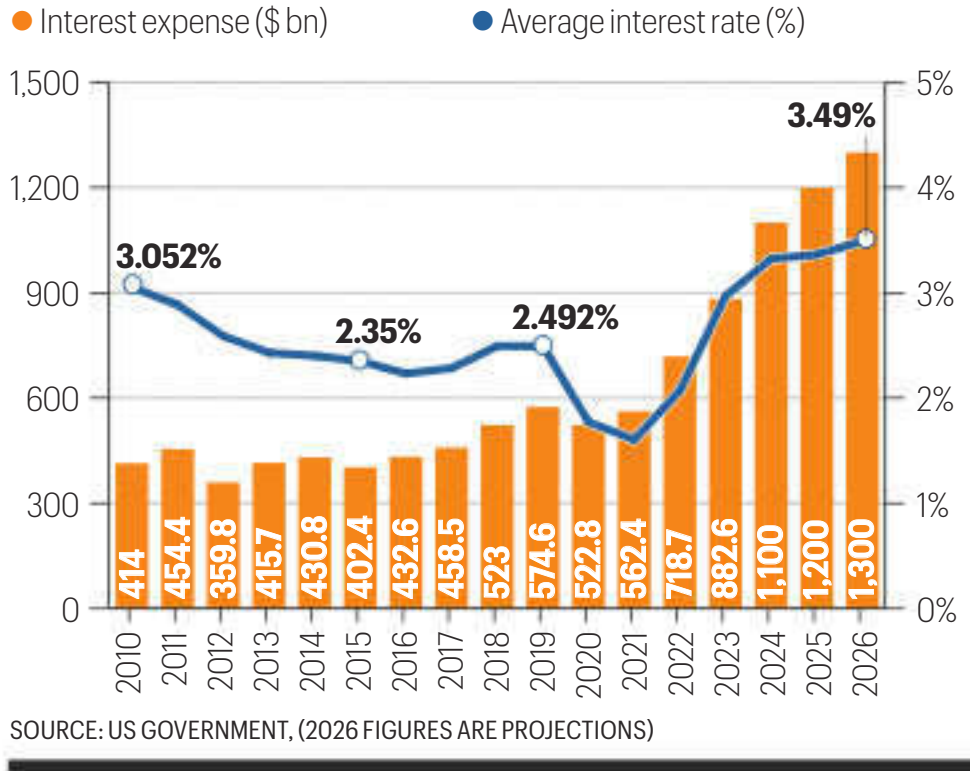
So when the yields go up for US government bonds, lenders typically ask for higher interest rates from everyone and every government on the planet because the whole spectrum is riskier.

And that is what is happening at present. Data shows that US bond yields are rising to the highest level since the global financial crisis of 2007-08. In fact, bond yields

1: US's annual deficits are growing... It is increasingly dependent on borrowings to meet expenses



4: ... and increasing interest expense US interest payments on debt have ballooned to \$1.3 tn



are rising similarly across most big economies, be it Japan, the UK or Germany.

The evidence feeds into the apprehension that the global bond markets (basically a collective term referring to all the investors who lend money to governments) are in the mood to punish governments by asking for a higher interest rate.

In fact, the rise in bond yields was so sharp that, when asked about it on August 21, US President Donald Trump threatened military action against the bond markets. "The ultimate intervention is our military. And if we have to use that, we will," he said.

But given the way the bond markets work, Trump's statement eroded the US government's credibility and willingness to play by the rules, and consequently, yields went up even further.

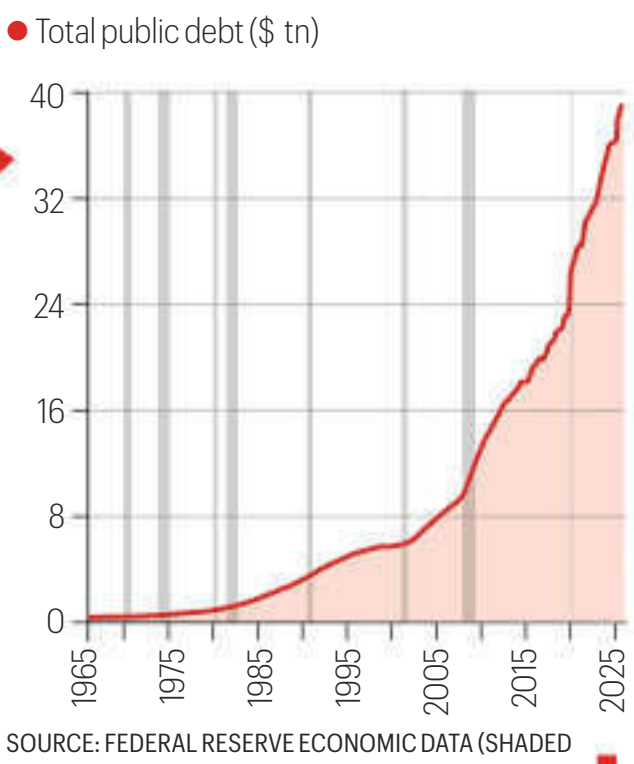
How do bond markets work?

A bond is essentially a formal I-O-U (or I owe you) between the government issuing the bond and the entity lending the money. The government states the money it is borrowing — say \$100 — the period for which it is borrowing — say 10 years — and the additional money that the government will pay to the lender each year over and above the \$100 at the end of the tenure.

This additional money is called the coupon and, crucially, it is an absolute amount — say \$10. In other words, instead of saying that the government will pay 10% interest each year, the government says it will pay \$10. This distinction matters because government bonds are tradable in the open market. A person can lend the money to the government, get the bond in return, and then sell the bond in the open market — the proverbial bond market.

It is when the bonds start trading that bond yields come into the picture. If the

2: ...pushing overall debt... US debt has crossed a record \$40 tn



3: ...driving up yields... Bond yields have been rising since 2020



Tipping point danger

The 'yield' on a government bond is the interest that the government pays for borrowing.

Rising yield means the government will have to shell out more money as interest payment; it is similar to your car or home loan EMI increasing.

In both cases, the borrower (the government or you) has to keep aside more money to pay back. Beyond a point, rising payments can reach a tipping point.

to honour the promise.

Given the scale of the market, even single basis point increase in government bond yields — 100 basis points make a full percentage point — raises the interest payment (recall EMIs) by billions of dollars for governments.

That is why governments are worried about yields rising sharply.

The chart shows how the US government's average borrowing cost have gone up as the yields have risen in the recent past. This has meant that the US government has had to make higher interest payments each year. This year it is expected to spend \$1.3 trillion from its budget just to pay interest on existing loans.

Why are government yields going up?

Sticking to the US, there are two main problems.

First is the sheer amount of debt in the market. The US continues to borrow more and more each year. This annual budget deficit keeps adding to the stock of total US government debt, which has now crossed \$40 trillion.

The second problem is the falling credibility of the US government. Typically, a higher amount of debt can be countered if it is used to grow faster. That way, the debt-to-GDP ratio does not go up.

But be it the *ad hoc* imposition of punitive tariffs last year or launching the war in Iran in February, the Trump administration's actions are raising inflation and hurting growth while continuing to borrow more.

Adding nervousness to this scenario is the lack of commitment — at least as the bond market participants saw it — on the part of Kevin Warsh, the new Fed Chair, to contain inflation by raising interest rates.

To be sure, if central banks don't raise interest rates to contain inflation in the short term, bond investors get understandably spooked about the state of the economy over longer terms, between five and 30 years.

What has made matters worse in the past few months is that the Trump administration and his latest appointment to the US Federal Reserve, Kevin Warsh, have made statements and taken decisions that have betrayed a sense of desperation and denial of the problem.

For instance, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent has tried to manipulate the bond markets to reduce yields by announcing a buyback of US bonds. The way this is intended to work is that the US government buys back its own bonds of longer tenure (and hence higher yields) and brings them money to do this by selling bonds of shorter tenure (and hence lower yields). Bessent expected a net result where overall borrowing costs come down. But bond markets saw through the desperation and yields shot up further.

What is the solution to calming the bond markets?

- 1. FISCAL CONSOLIDATION**
The US and, for that matter, most of the so-called rich countries, are sinking in debt. The first and foremost thing to do is reduce borrowings.
- 2. FOCUS ON GROWTH**
Debt matters, but a country can get out of a debt trap if it grows fast enough to bring down the debt-to-GDP ratio.
- 3. RE-ESTABLISH POLICY CREDIBILITY**
On Wednesday, the US Fed will have a chance to raise interest rates in the face of continually rising inflation in the US. Even more importantly, Warsh would have to convince bond markets that he is committed to the US's 2% inflation target.

On the fiscal policy side, Trump and Bessent have to ensure that they sound and look like they want to improve the situation be it on growth or inflation.

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Office of Superintending Engineer,
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad

E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

No. 5359/E-Tender/MBD Circle/26-27

Dated: 05-09-2026

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> from registered contractors from **24-09-2026 at 10.00 am to 03-10-2026 at 12.00 Hrs.** Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on **03-10-2026 at 12.30 P.M.** in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 5 & 7 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.

2.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of Work	Estimated cost including mantinance (Rs.in Laacs)	Bid Security (Rs.in Laacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST	Category of Bridge contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8
Year 2026-27 Construction of Minor Bridge work							
1	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Construction of minor bridge over the Sot River at the Km 2 of the Nagla Khakam to Khetapur link road in District Sambhal. (5x8.00 Mtr. Span Box Culver)	330.00	18.50	12 Month	2354.00	A Bridge Work

3. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software. URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahar> On opening of the website Prahari login page will open in which user type Contractor is to be selected. User name and password for login on Prahari shall be same as used for contractor's registration on Chnakaya Portal. Bidders have to upload all the basic information and required document on Prahari as given in Prahari in detail. If a bidder does not upload information and document on Prahari technical evaluation of the tender shall not be done and the bidder will be responsible for that.

Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website <http://etender.up.nic.in> and <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahar>.

(Er.Suneel Prakash)
Executive Engineer
Provincial Division PWD
Sambhal

UPID-256085 Dt. 14.09.2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP
Mob No. 9557104999
Mail ID:- semoradabad13@yahoo.com

Office of SUPERINTENDING ENGINEER,
RAMPUR CIRCLE, P.W.D. RAMPUR

Short Term E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

Ref.No. 5049 /E-Nivida-Rampur/26-27

Dated :-05 -09-2026

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work on percentage rates are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Rampur Circle, PWD Rampur online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> from Bridge Category registered contractors from date 22.09.2026 at 10.00 am to 28.09.2026 at 12.00 noon. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 28.09.2026 at 12.30 pm in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders' who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day.

2. Details of the works are following:

Sl. No	NAME OF WORK	Estimated cost (Rs.in Lakh) (Ex GST)	Bid Security (Rs.in Lakh)	Cost of tender documents including GST (RS.)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Address of Executive Engineer executing the work	Address of Superin ending Engineer	Address of Chief Engineer	Category of contractor eligible	
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11
1	Construction work of Minor Bridge of 3x18 m span approach road over Ghughra River between Chidhawali Hussaingang road to Noorpur Puswada road in distt. Rampur	380.00	21.00	2354.00	12 Months	अधीकारी अधिकार, जलनीय खान, लो-निधि, लुगु	अधीकारी अधिकार, लो-निधि, लुगु	मुराद अहमद, मुहम्मद अहमद, लो-निधि, लुगु	Bridge Category 'A'.	

➤ The defect liability period shall be 02 year from the actual date of completion of work

➤ The Rates adopted in the BOQ are including all other taxes but excluding GST.

➤ The Bid Security and tender cost should be deposited online through Net Banking as per Column 5 & 6 in the table.

All terms & conditions can be seen on website <http://etender.up.nic.in>. Additional Security will be payable as per rule at the time of Agreement and according to G.O. No 86/2026/649/2026/23 - 7099/106/2025 लोक निर्माण अनुमान-7 दिनांक 23.05.2026. The bidder have to login on Prahari URL <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahar> to upload required documents as per Government order879(1)(1)/रैंस-7-2020-176 (सं)/06 लोक निर्माण अनुमान-7 दिनांक 25.08.2020 & E.N.C./H.O.D.'s uppwd letter No. 417/13 रैंस-7-2020-176 (सं)/20 दिनांक 28.08.2020.

Executive Engineer
PD, PWD, Rampur
Ph. 01342-262776
Email – pdrampur@gmail.com

UPID-256080 Date 14/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
Rampur Circle, PWD, Rampur
Ph. 0595 – 2351163
Email – pdrampur@gmail.com

झारखण्ड सरकार, कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय

ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

ई- अल्पकालीन निविदा आमंत्रण सूचना

ई-निविदा सं० :- RDSPL/SD/HZB/31/2026-27

1. कार्य की विस्तृत विवरणी:

गुप सं०	आईई-टीफिकेशन संख्या / पैकेज संख्या	प्रखण्ड	योजना का नाम	प्रारंभित राशि	अग्रघन की राशि	परिमाण विपन्न का मूल्य	कार्य पूर्ण करने की अवधि
1.	RDSPL/SD/HZB/31/01/2026-27	बरही	विजया चौक से ओपरता रिमाना तक पथ निर्माण।	24874400.00	497500.00	10000.00	10 माह
2.	RDSPL/SD/HZB/31/02/2026-27	चौपारण	ग्राम चयकला के जाराडोओ रोड से करमा आहर पिण्ड होले हुए मटवाचक तक पीसीसीओ पथ निर्माण।	24685700.00	493800.00	10000.00	10 माह
3.	RDSPL/SD/HZB/31/03/2026-27	बरही	बरही तिलैया रोड से केसरी धर्मशाला होले हुए फोरलेन तक पक्की सड़क का निर्माण।	12651800.00	253100.00	10000.00	04 माह
4.	RDSPL/SD/HZB/31/04/2026-27	बड़कागांव	ग्राम पलाण्डू स्थित पलाण्डू पुल से रामनगरी मेला टांड तक पीसीसीओ पथ निर्माण।	10796300.00	216000.00	10000.00	04 माह

2. वेबसाइट में निविदा प्रकाशन की तिथि — 25.09.2026

3. ई-निविदा प्राप्ति की तिथि एवं समय — दिनांक 25.09.2026 से दिनांक 03.10.2026 को अपराह्न 5:00 बजे तक

4. ई-निविदा खोलने का स्थान — कार्यपालक अभियंता का कार्यालय, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमण्डल, हजारीबाग

5. ई-निविदा खोलने की तिथि एवं समय — 05.10.2026 अपराह्न 2:00 बजे

6. ई-निविदा आमंत्रित करने वाले पदाधिकारी का नाम एवं पता :- कार्यपालक अभियंता, ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल, हजारीबाग

7. ई-निविदा प्रकोण्ड का दूरभाष सं० — 9934523795

8. परिमाण विपन्न की राशि घट—बढ़ सकती है तदनुसार अग्रघन की राशि देय होगी।

9. कार्यपालक अभियंता Online Mode द्वारा स्वीकार्य होगी।

10. निविदा शुल्क एवं अग्रघन की राशि का ई-मुगतान जिन खाता से किया जायेगा, उसी खाते में अग्रघन की राशि वापस होगी।

विस्तृत जानकारी के लिये वेबसाइट www.jharkhandtenders.gov.in एवं कार्यालय की सूचना पृष्ठ पर देखा जा सकता है।

कार्यपालक अभियंता
ग्रामीण विकास विशेष प्रमंडल,
हजारीबाग

PR.NO.389774 Rural Development(26-27):D

Office of Superintending Engineer,
Moradabad Circle, P.W.D. Moradabad

No. 5233 /E-Tender/MBD Circle/26-27

Dated: 31-08-2026

E-Procurement Notice Inviting Tenders

1. On behalf of the Governor of UP, tenders for following work are invited by the Superintending Engineer, Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad online on website <http://etender.up.nic.in> from registered contractors from 21-09-2026 at 10.00 am to 28-09-2026 at 12.00 Hrs. Technical bid /Prequalification of tenders shall be opened on 28-09-2026 at 12.30 PM. in office of undersigned by tender committee in presence of authorised representatives/bidders who wish to be present. Financial bid of the tenders who qualify in technical bid shall be opened on date and time as specified by a notice in the office of undersigned. In case of Government holiday the required process shall be carried out on next working day. Amount mentioned in column 5 & 7 shall be mandatory deposited by net banking only on E-Tender Portal.

2.

Sl. No	DISTRICT	Name of work	Estimated cost including Bidder (Rs. in Laacs)	5 Year maintenance cost (Rs. in Laacs)	Total Cost of Work (Rs. in Laacs)	Bid Security (Rs. in Laacs)	Time of completion of the work (Including rainy season)	Cost of tender documents including GST	Category of road contractor eligible
1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10
Financial Year 26-27 Under Re-Construction Work (Chini Mill)									
1	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Asmoli Chini Mill Gate to Kisan Inter college Asmoli road	47.00	1.2	48.20	4.41	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
2	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Saidpur Jaskoti Bilalpat link road	38.00	2.90	40.90	4.05	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
3	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Saidpur Jaskoti to Garwara link road	35.00	2.60	37.60	3.76	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
4	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Matpur to Dhaktora link road	43.00	2.00	45.00	4.25	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
5	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Makarapur to Sini Banaila link road	36.00	1.70	37.70	3.77	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
6	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Guretha to Bhawati link road	44.00	3.30	47.30	4.37	6 Month	2354.00	A B & C Road Work
7	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Asmoli link road	52.00	3.40	55.40	4.77	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
8	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Rajpura Babula road to Nagaria link road	41.00	1.90	42.90	4.15	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work
9	Sambhal	Year 2026-27 Under Reconstruction of Rajakpur road to Barahani road	40.00	2.00	42.00	4.10	6 Month	2354	A B & C Road Work

3. In PWD technical evaluation of tenders is to be done by Prahari Software. URL for Prahari is <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahar> On opening of the website Prahari login page will open in which user type Contractor is to be selected. User name and password for login on Prahari shall be same as used for contractor's registration on Chnakaya Portal. Bidders have to upload all the basic information and required document on Prahari as given in Prahari in detail. If a bidder does not upload information and document on Prahari technical evaluation of the tender shall not be done and the bidder will be responsible for that.

Rules/conditions & details of the tender are available at website <http://etender.up.nic.in> and <http://wms.uppwd.gov.in/Prahar>.

(Er. Suneel Prakash)
Executive Engineer
Provincial Division PWD
Sambhal

UPID-256084 Dt. 14/09/2026
www.upidadv.gov.in

Superintending Engineer
Moradabad Circle, PWD Moradabad.
For and on behalf of Governor of UP
Mob No. 9557104999
Mail ID:- semoradabad13@yahoo.com

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SRL No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF MEDICAL DRUG CONSUMABLES TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP C (FOR 28 ITEMS)	15.09.2026 06.10.2026	3,21,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	0172-478822 hmschenders@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	ONLINE TENDER FOR THE RATE CONTRACT FOR THE SUPPLY OF MEDICAL DRUG CONSUMABLES TO VARIOUS HOSPITALS OF GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA FOR A PERIOD OF TWO YEARS FOR GROUP C(FOR 27 ITEMS)	15.09.2026 06.10.2026	12,24,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	0172-478822 hmschenders@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No- 492833HRY

GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA

TENDER NOTICE

SRL No.	NAME OF BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE (TIME)	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE BOARD/CORP/ AUTH	NODAL OFFICER/ CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATOR FOR STORAGE OF REAGENT (150-200 L) ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	14.09.2026 28.09.2026	1,08,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com
2	HARYANA MEDICAL SERVICES CORPORATION LIMITED	NOTICE INVITING TENDER FOR THE SUPPLY, INSTALLATION AND COMMISSIONING OF REFRIGERATOR(CRYOPRECIPITATE) WATER BATH ON 2 YEARS RATE CONTRACT AS MENTIONED AGAINST ITEM IN SCHEDULE OF REQUIREMENT	14.09.2026 21.09.2026	15,00,000/-	www.hmscl.org.in	8929299829 equipmentsgm2020@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT : www.haryanaeprocurement.gov.in or www.etenders.hry.nic.in

No- 492783HRY

POST GRADUATE INSTITUTE OF MEDICAL
EDUCATION & RESEARCH CHANDIGARH

NOTICE INVITING TENDERS (NIT)

On behalf of Director, PGIMER, Sector 12, Chandigarh 160012, the undersigned invites sealed tender to make Rate Contract of following items for the period of one year as per the details given in the table below. The bidders offers their minimum rates as per terms and conditions contained in the tender form. The sealed tender with Technical Bids & Financial Bids (Price Bids) duly drafted in the name of Director, Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education & Research, Sector 12, Chandigarh 160012, and addressed to Officer Incharge (HPD) may be submitted as per schedule given below:

Tender Enquiry Number & Date	Brief Description of Goods	Amount of Bid Security (EMD) (INR)
Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/405 Dated:	Purchase of Whole Wheat Atta, Refined Oil, Mustard Oil, Long Grain Rice, Parnal Rice and Basmati Rice through Rate Contract for the period of one year.	Rs. 1,80,000/- (Rupees One Lac Eighty Thousand only)
Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/406 Dated:	Purchase of Double Toned Milk through Rate Contract for the period of one year.	Rs. 3,60,000/- (Rupees three lac sixty thousand only)
Closing date & Time for receipt of Bids	On or before 07.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M	
Date, time and place for opening of technical bids	07.10.2026 at 3:00 P.M at Procurement Branch (HPD), Central Store, 2nd Floor, Nehru Building, PGIMER, Sector-12, Chandigarh.	
Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/404 Dated:	Purchase of Yogurt Cups through Rate Contract for the period of one year.	Rs. 21,000/- (Rupees Twenty one thousand only)
Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/407 Dated: The Pre-Bid Conference ****	Tender for outsourcing dietary services from Advance Cardiac Centre (ACC) Kitchen for the period of 10 years 5+5.	Rs. 7.00 Lac/- (Rupees Seven Lac only)
Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/408 Dated:	Tender for purchase of Mitral Valveulaplaty balloon rate contract for the period of two year	Rs. 20,000/- (Rupees Twenty thousand only)
Closing date & Time for receipt of Bids	On or before 08.10.2026 at 12:30 P.M	
Date, time and place for opening of technical bids	08.10.2026 at 03:00 P.M at Procurement Branch (HPD), Central Store, 2nd Floor, Nehru Building, PGIMER, Sector-12, Chandigarh.	

**** The Pre-Bid Conference* against the tender Inquiry No. Proc. Indgn. (HPD)/2026/407 scheduled to be held on 24th September 2026 at 3.00P.M in the Committee Room, M.S.Office, Nehru Hospital PGI, Chandigarh. Only firms who have brought the tender document for the concerned items shall be allowed to participate in the "PRE-BID CONFERENCE"

1. The bidders may download the tender documents directly from the website of the Institute www.pgimer.edu.in or CPP Portal (www.eprocure.gov.in). The bidders should specifically sign scribbled, "Downloaded from the Institute's website" on the top left corner of the outer envelope containing Technical Bid & Financial Bid separately. The bids submitted by the bidders not following the above procedure will summarily be rejected.

2. The Bid Security (EMD) for an amount mentioned in this NIT will have to be deposited & submitted with Technical Bid in the form of an Account Payee Demand Draft/ Banker's Cheque/Deposit at call receipt or an ETD/TDR/Bank Guarantee in original duly pledged in favour of Postgraduate Institute of Medical Education and Research, Sector-12, Chandigarh and having its validity for at least One Year and issued by a Scheduled Commercial Bank. This bid security (EMD) may be attached with the Technical Bid. FDR/TDR issued for less amount or issued by Banks before the date of floating this NIT shall not be accepted & bids received with such FDR/TDR shall summarily be rejected.

Micro Small & Medium Enterprises as also startups as recognized by the department of MSME are exempted for submission of EMD on production of requisite certificate.

3. It is the responsibility of the Bidders to ensure that their bids, whether sent CPP Portal or by Regd. Post/Courier/in person, are to be delivered in Procurement Branch (HPD), 2nd Floor, C-Block, Central Store, Sector-12, PGIMER, Chandigarh" & are received by on or before closing date and time stipulated above for receipt of bids, failing which the bids would be considered late bids and will be rejected. The bids dropped in the other branches/departments/Centers of PGIMER, will not be considered as submitted and such bids will be summarily rejected.

4. The date and time for opening of the Financial Bids (Price Bids) shall be intimated later after evaluation of the technical bids.

5. In the event of any of the above mentioned dates being declared as a holiday/closed day in the PGIMER, Chandigarh, the bids will be received/opened on the next working day at the prescribed venue and time.

6. This tender document is not transferable.

7. This tender document, consist of pages 1 to 33 pages. The bidder is required to submit a tender acceptance letter on company letter head duly signed and stamped as per annexure V along with other documents as mentioned in Para 37 (1) of the NIT.

8. Offers not on the prescribed form shall not be considered.

NOTE: Please visit our website at www.pgimer.edu.in for further details of this tender.

Officer Incharge (HPD)

कार्यालय अधीक्षण अभियन्ता,
सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, ग्रामीण वृत्त जोधपुर

क्रमांक: 1772

दिनांक: 07.09.2026

अल्पकालीन निविदा सूचना संख्या: 06 वर्ष 2026-27

NIB No. PWD2627A2644

राजस्थान के राजपाल महोदय की ओर से विभिन्न सड़क का निर्माण कार्य हेतु उपयुक्त श्रेणी में सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग राजस्थान में पंजीकृत संवेदकों एवं राज्य सरकार/केन्द्र सरकार के अधिकृत संयन्त्रिक/केन्द्रीय लोक निर्माण विभाग/राज्य एवं दूर संचार विभाग / रेलवे इत्यादि में पंजीकृत संवेदकों, जो कि राजस्थान सरकार के उपयुक्त श्रेणी के संवेदकों के समकक्ष हों, से निर्धारित प्रपत्र में इंस्ट्रक्शन प्रक्रिया हेतु ऑनलाईन निविदाएं आमंत्रित की जाती हैं। निविदा से सम्बन्धित विवरण वेब साइट <http://dlpr.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> व <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर देखा जा सकता है। सम्पूर्ण निविदा प्रक्रिया <http://eproc.rajasthan.gov.in> पर ऑनलाईन सम्पादित की जायेगी। कार्यवार यू.बी.एन सूचना निम्नानुसार है।

PWD2627WSOB11742	PWD2627WSOB11744
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हस्ता./-
(डी आर मास्टर)
अधीक्षण अभियन्ता,
सा.वि. ग्रामीण वृत्त, जोधपुर

DIPRC/15835/26-27

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Invitation of Tender through E-Tendering
(E-Procurement Systems)

NIT No.	57-2026-27-WV
Name of work with its location	Replacement of Glued Joint & Switch Expansion Joint in the section of SSE/P Way/HNZM under ADE/N/HNZM. Similar nature of work: Any type of track work.
Approx Cost of work	Rs. 5499990.88
Earnest Money Deposit	(It should be in the form of net banking or payment gateway Only. Note:- FDR will not be accepted as EMD for tender invited on IREPS as per Railway Boards letter no 201025/CE-I/C7/5/1 dated 31.08.2016) Rs. 110000.00
Completion period of Work	09 Months
Date and time for submission of tender and opening of tender	Upto 15.00 hrs. on 08.10.2026 Opening of tender at 15:00 hrs. On 08.10.2026
Website particulars notice board location complete details of tender can be seen and address of the office from where the tender form can be purchased etc.	Above tender available on IREPS site i.e. www.ireps.gov.in
No. 128-W/280/OET/2026-27/N-VINIT-57-2026-27 Date : 15.09.2026	3189/2026
Serving Customers With A Smile	

CENTRUM HOUSING FINANCE LIMITED

Registered Office : Unit No. 301, Third Floor, Harbhatjan Commercial Premises Co-operative Society Ltd., CST Road, Opp. BPCL Petrol Pump, Kalina, Santacruz (East), Mumbai – 400098. CIN: U65922MH2016PLC273826

peoplehome

GOODS REMOVAL NOTICE

To: Aabid Ali (Borrower) Aasiya Ali (Co-Borrower)

Plot of khasra no-2010, Adm. 95.55 Sq. Mtr., A Residential Vacant plot situated at Abado Sardhana Dehat, and Presently Allotted New and underdeveloped Colony (Under Boundary of Nagar Palika Parishad), Tehsil - Sardhana, District - Meerut-250342, Uttar Pradesh.

Dear Sir/Madam,

This letter formally demands the removal of all goods and personal property belonging to you from the immovable property located at in the pieces, right and parcel of immovable property- Plot of khasra no-2010, Adm. 95.55 Sq. Mtr., A Residential Vacant plot situated at Abado Sardhana Dehat, and Presently Allotted New and underdeveloped Colony (Under Boundary of Nagar Palika Parishad), Tehsil - Sardhana, District - Meerut-250342, Uttar Pradesh. Boundaries:- East :- Plot of Meera, West - Khet of Ameesha, North:- Road 12' wide South:- House of Salim.

As you are aware, the previously mentioned property possession was lawfully taken on 10th of September 2026 as per the DM order passed on 11-07-2025 on pursuant to SARFAESI Proceeding initiated in the loan code MTCHMT21006208. At the time of possession, several items of personal belonging to you remain on the premises. The inventory Panchnama has been attached herewith.

You are hereby required to remove all your personal goods and belongings from the premises within the next 15 days from the date of this notice. Please contact Authorised officer Mr. Vartul Pandit (9627704548) to arrange access to property for removing your belongings. You will be required to provide identification and sign a release form during removal of items from the property in possession. Please be ensure that all the items are removed by 5th October 2026. If you fail to remove your belongings by the specified deadline, after this date, any remaining goods will be considered abandoned and may be disposed of or transferred to the new owner at their discretion, without further notice to you. Please note that you will bear all costs associated with the removal of your goods. CHFL disclaims any liability for damage that may occur during the removal process and/or disposed of and/or transferred to the new owner in event of failure to removal from premises by above mention deadline. Thank you for your prompt attention to this matter.

Yours sincerely,
For Centrum Housing Finance Limited

NORTHERN RAILWAY

Attention Advertising Agencies

Applications are invited from INS accredited advertising agencies for empanelment on Northern Railway for Public Relations works and Publicity activities: Application forms can be downloaded from our website : www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in from 17.09.2026 to 08.10.2026 till 12:00 noon or can be obtained from the office of Chief Public Relations Officer, Northern Railway, NDRC Building, State Entry Road, New Delhi-110055 on any working day from 10:00 AM to 05:30 PM from 17.09.2026 to 07.10.2026 and upto 12:00 hrs. on 08.10.2026 after which applications will not be accepted. This information is also available on Northern Railway website www.nr.indianrailways.gov.in No. 11/PR/5/2026/II/Empanelment Dated: 15.09.2026 3182/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

S. E. RAILWAY – TENDER

DRM/ENGG, South Eastern Railway, Chakradharpur acting for & on behalf of the President of India invites E-Tenders against Open Tender. Manual Offers are not allowed against these tenders and any such manual offer received shall be ignored. Sl.No.-1. Tender Notice No.: CKP-WEST-26-27-24. Name of work: Reconditioning of wheel-burnt/scabbled rails/cupped welds by using RDSO approved technology such as Micro Flow metal spray powder technique or robotic welding technology under the jurisdiction of Sr. DEN (West)/Chakradharpur (2nd Call). Tender Value: ₹ 1,33,91,131.02. EMD: ₹ 2,67,800. Date of Opening: 05.10.2026. Sl.No.-2. Tender Notice No.: CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-41. Name of work: Chakradharpur Division-Execution of Cess Repair work under the jurisdiction of DEN/Central/Chakradharpur. Tender Value: ₹ 4,05,05,030.83. EMD: ₹ 8,10,100. Date of Opening: 12.10.2026. Sl.No.-3. Tender Notice No.: CKP-CENTRAL-26-27-42. Name of work: Through Ballast Renewal Works of points and Crossings between Barabambo to Bondamunda A Cabin under the jurisdiction of DEN/Central/Chakradharpur (2nd call). Tender Value: ₹ 1,24,53,736.86. EMD: ₹ 2,49,100. Date of Opening: 12.10.2026. Cost of Tender form: ₹ 0 (for Sl.No. 1 to 3 each). The tender can be viewed at website <http://www.ireps.gov.in>. The tenderer/ bidders must have class-II Digital Signature Certificate & must be registered under on IREPS Portal. Only registered tenderer/bidder can participate on e-tendering. All relevant paper must be uploaded at the time of participating in e-tendering. (PR-767)

epaper.indianexpress.com

New Delhi

कार्यालय अधिशाषी अभियन्ता, सार्वजनिक निर्माण विभाग, खण्ड नोखा

क्रमांक: 1553-59 दिनांक 03.09.2026

Short Term Notice Inviting Bid - 09/2026-27

Bids for Repair/Maintenace and Construction of Various Road are invited from interested bidders upto 07.09.2026 [09:30 AM] to 18.09.2026 [06:00PM], other particulars of the bid may be visited on the procurement portal <http://www.pwd.rajasthan.gov.in> & [eproc.rajasthan.gov.in](http://www.pwd.rajasthan.gov.in) & <http://sppp.rajasthan.gov.in> of the state and departmental website. The approximate value of the procurement is Rs. 295.86 Lakh.

NIB CODE No.: PWD2627A2631

UBN: PWD2627WSOB11698 PWD2627WSOB11699
PWD2627WSOB11700 PWD2627WSOB11701
PWD2627WSOB11702 PWD2627WSOB11703
PWD2627WSOB11704

Sd/-
Executive Engineer
PWD Dn. Nokha

DIPR/C/15812/2026

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

AMM/EMU/GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India Invites E-Tender against TenderNo. 46265431 The details are as under

1. Name of work	Cylindrical Roller Bearing Rivet less Cage NU-328 used on Pinion End of TM to RDSO Spec. No. MP.0.2402.03, Rev. - 04/Apr.2021
2. Approx. cost of work	Rs. 7926768/-
3. Quantity	240 nos
4. Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
5. Date & Time of opening of tender document	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.irops.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railways E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.irops.gov.in (ii) Please refer to the tender document for all terms and conditions. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable. NIT No.46265431 Date: 12.09.2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE 3178/26

Advertisement for Volunteer for Fogging Machine Operator O/o Civil Surgeon, Nuh (Health Department, Haryana)

The application is invited from eligible candidate for 5 (Five) Volunteer Fogging Machine Operator for the period September 2026 to 30 November 2026. The Honorarium will be paid @645/- per day and if fogging work is not carried out on any given day, they will perform the duties of a breeding checker, for which a daily rate of Rs. 586 will be paid. Maximum working 20 days per month. The basis of selection for volunteers is First-Come, First- Serve. It is clarified that Volunteers are doing this community service on their own interest and it is not a job and honorarium is not a salary. All candidates are requested to submit their Resume/Curriculum Vitae (CV) along with self-attested copies of their PAN Card, Aadhaar Card, and Bank Passbook/Cancelled Cheque through email at idspmwt@gmail.com on or before 4:00 PM on 17.09.2026.

No application will be accepted by hand under any circumstances. Applications received after the prescribed date and time shall not be considered.

Sd/-
Deputy Civil Surgeon
(VBD), Nuh.

No. 49260/HR

Government of Jharkhand
URBAN DEVELOPMENT & HOUSING DEPARTMENT
State Urban Development Agency
Ground Floor, JUPMI Building, Dhurwa, Ranchi-834004
Phone: 0651-2446640, E-Mail: suda.goj@gmail.com

Notice Inviting Tender (NIT)

NIT No: 15 Dated: 15.09.2026

The Detailed schedule of events is as follows:-

1.	Name of the Project	Selection of Consultancy Agency / DPR Consultant For Establishment of State Integrated Solid Waste Management Monitoring and Governance Platform (Preparation of Detailed Project Report, Technology Architecture, Cost Estimate, Implementation Framework and Bid Documents) for Jharkhand
2.	Date of Publication of RFP on website	15/09/2026, 17:00 hours
3.	Mode of submission of bids	e-Tendering (https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in)
4.	Pre-Bid Meeting	21/09/2026, 15:00 hours
5.	Date of Start of Submission of RFP (Online)	22/09/2026, 17:00 hours
6.	Last Date/Time for submission of RFP (Online)	12/10/2026 up to 17:00 hours
7.	Pre-Bid Submission	Request to submit the pre-bid queries in the following e-mail Id: suda.goj@gmail.com by 19/09/2026 by 14:00 Hrs. The queries will be uploaded on the website under Tender section. Prospective bidders are advised to attend the meeting to seek clarifications regarding the scope of work, technical specifications, and contractual conditions. Amendments/clarifications, if any, arising out of the pre-bid meeting shall form part of the Tender Document.
8.	Tender Document fee	Rs. 10,000.00 (Ten Thousand Only); Payable Online
9.	Bid Security/Earnest Money Deposit	Rs. 5,00,000.00 (Five Lakhs Only); Payable online
10.	Date of Technical Bid Opening (Online)	13/10/2026 at 16:00 hours
11.	RFP submission address (Online)	https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in
12.	Contact Details	Director, SUDA, Ranchi: e-mail ID – suda.goj@gmail.com ; Phone No. 0651-2446640

Note: Only online submission of Tender will be accepted. Further details can be seen on website <https://jharkhandtenders.gov.in>

Sd/-
(Director)
State Urban Development Agency

PR 389797 Urban Development (26-27)#D

Modern Coach Factory, Raebareli

No.- MCF/RBL/Med/Dental Surgeon/2022-23 Date:- 11.09.2026

INDICATIVE NOTICE

Sub:- Engagement of 01 dental Surgeon at Railway Hospital Modern Coach Factory Raebareli on contract basis for one year.

Principal Chief Medical Officer Modern Coach Factory will engage part time 01 Dental Surgeon on contract basis for one year.

Note:- For detailed term & condition of the notice, please visit our website:- <https://mcf.indianrailways.gov.in>

Principal Chief Medical Officer

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

Sr. Divisional Electrical Engineer/Traction Distribution, DRM's Office, State Entry Road, New Delhi for & on behalf of President of India, invites open e-tender for the under noted work:

1. Name of Work with its location: Part-A: Provision of AEC wire & S.S. Bonds for earthing improvement of OHE in DUK section in connection with Strengthening of existing TRD assets in DUK section	
2. Approx. Cost of work: Rs. 5.32,17,329.96/-	
3. Earnest Money Deposit: Rs. 10.64,400/-	
4. E-Tender Bid Online Submission Period: 24.09.2026 (00.00 Hrs.) to 08.10.2026 (15.00 Hrs.)	
5. E-Tender Bid Submission End Date & E-Tender Open Date & Time: 08.10.2026 (15.00 hrs.)	
6. Fund Allocation: RRSK (PH-36)	
7. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen: www.irops.gov.in	

No.: 17B-TRD-NDS-2026-27 Dated: 15.09.2026 3188/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

The Shipping Corporation Of India Ltd. (A Government of India Enterprise)

T&OS Division, 5th Floor, Shipping House, 245 Madame Cama Road, Mumbai-400021 (India) Tel No. +91-22- 22853556 / 22772182 Email: amit.valkar@scil.co.in dirlos.sect@scil.co.in Website: www.shipindia.com • Twitter: @shippingcorp • CIN No.: L63030MH1950G0I008033

TENDER FOR ACQUISITION OF 6 NO. (2 FIRM + 4 OPTIONAL) NEW-BUILDING CONTAINER CARRIERS OF 8000 TEU @ 14.0 T CAPACITY

The Shipping Corporation of India Ltd is interested in acquisition of 6 No. (2 Firm + 4 Optional) New-Building Container Carriers of 8000 TEU @ 14.0 T Capacity. Bidders are requested to visit our website www.shipindia.com or www.eprocure.gov.in for further details. The participating bidders would have to submit their offers latest by 12.10.2026, 1700 hrs (IST) to the Director (T&OS) on the above mentioned address.

TRANSPORTING GOODS. TRANSFORMING LIVES.

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

EOI for inviting participation from eligible/interested firms, manufacturers, agencies and other competent entities having the requisite technical expertise and experience.

The EOI pertains to: "Complete Reconstruction, Manufacture, Testing, Commissioning and Delivery of One Heritage A-Class Steam Locomotive."

The EOI is intended to assess the availability and capability of suitable agencies for undertaking the above work and for deciding the further course of action regarding procurement/manufacture of the Heritage A-Class Steam Locomotive.

The details for publication are as under:

- EOI no with date : M/TD/01/Class/A dated 04/09/2026
- Last date of offer submission : 09/10/2026
- Complete postal address: Office of ADME/Tindharia, Hill Cart Road,Tindharia-734223
- Email id : Director.dhr@gmail.com & adme.tdh@gmail.com

The EOI document containing the scope of work, eligibility criteria, technical requirements, experience criteria, submission procedure and other terms & conditions has been uploaded on the N.F. Railway's official website www.nfr.indianrailways.gov.in → News & Updates → Notification.

Director, Darjeeling Himalayan Railway, Kurseong

NORTHEAST FRONTIER RAILWAY

"SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE"

उपसिदा उ०प्र० राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण

ई-निविदा सूचना

एतद्वारा सूचित किया जाता है, कि निम्न औद्योगिक क्षेत्रों के अन्तर्गत विकास /अनुसूचण /उत्पत्तिकरण कार्य हेतु सरकारी निम्नो/सार्वजनिक उपक्रम/निगमों/प्राधिकरणों/परिषदों /नगर निकायों में कार्यरत फर्म/ट्रैकेदारों से ई-निविदाये आमंत्रित की जाती है, जिसको अपलोड करने की समयसीमा निम्नवत् है—

- क्रमांक 1 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 16.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 23.09.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिन्हें दिनांक 23.09.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (अन्यथाकारित)
- क्रमांक 2 से 4 पर अंकित कार्य की निविदा दिनांक 16.09.2026 को पूर्वाह्न 11.00 बजे से दिनांक 06.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.00 बजे तक अपलोड की जा सकती है, जिन्हें दिनांक 06.10.2026 को अपरान्ह 5.30 बजे खोला जायेगा (पूर्वकारित)

निविदादाताओं द्वारा केवल शब्दपरवी की मूल प्रतियों निविदा प्रपत्रों में उल्लिखित दिनांक तक कार्यालय में जमा की जा सकती हैं। ई-निविदा के माध्यम से आमंत्रित की जाने वाली निविदाओं का विवरण निम्नवत् है—

क्रमांक	कार्य का नाम	अंदाजित लागत (रु.)
1	Maintenance & Upgradation of Existing Drain in I.A. Sector A-1, A-2, A-3, A-4, A-5/6 at I.A. TDS City Ghaziabad	298.53
2	Annual Maintenance of Roads, Surface Dressing, Road Cleaning and Drain Repairing at I.A. Sikandra Site-A, Site-B, Site-C, EPIP & Foundary Nagar Distt-Agra.	256.43
3	Maintenance/Upgradation of Bituminous Concrete Road and Interlocking Tile Works of Road No-4, 5, 6, 7 & 8 of I.A. Bhogaon Distt- Mainpuri.	285.47
4	Maintenance And Upgradation of parks in Residential sector B-1, B-5/6, C-2, C-6, C-7, C-8 & C-9 I.A. TDS city, Ghaziabad	285.47

नोट:- निविदादाता अपनी निविदाओं में सम्मत् कर सहित दूरें अंकित करें। जीएएसटीडी अलग से देय होगा। निविदा सम्बन्धी विस्तृत जानकारी प्राधिकरण की website: <https://beta.upsidamarkeplace.com> पर स्थित ई-लिक एवं यूट्यूब चैनल की website: <http://etenderup.nic.in> पर देखी जा सकती है। अन्य जानकारी हेतु कार्यालय के परिसर प्रत्यक्ष (विशेष) के श्री प्रवीण कुमार सलीमिया मोबाइल नं० 9871090100 पर सम्पर्क किया जा सकता है।

प्रधान महाप्रणयक, उ०प्र०राज्य औद्योगिक विकास प्राधिकरण, कागपुर

NORTHERN RAILWAY

E-TENDER NOTICE

AMM/EMU/GZB acting for and on behalf of President of India invites E-Tender against Tender No. 46265432 the details are as under:

1. Name of the work	Set of Differnet Modules for Medha EMU Coaches as per Annexure attached.
2. Approx. cost of work	Rs. 77.89,225/-
3. Quantity	01 Set
4. Last Date & Time of Submission of tender bid of tender	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
5. Date & Time of Opening of tender document	10.10.2026 (11:00 Hrs.)
6. Website particulars where complete details of tender documents can be seen	www.irops.gov.in

Note: (i) The tenderers must be registered on the Indian Railways E-Procurement System (IREPS) site i.e. www.irops.gov.in (ii) Please refer to the tender document for all terms and conditions. (iii) No manual offers are acceptable.

NIT No. – 46265432 Date: 12.09.2026 3179/2026

SERVING CUSTOMERS WITH A SMILE

DISTRICT POLICE

HEADQUARTERS SAMBA

LOOK OUT NOTICE

As intimated by SDPO Bari-Brahmana vide letter No. SDPO/BB/26/7925 dated 08.09.2026, that one lady namely Ful Kumari W/o Bhola Kumar along with daughter Suhani Kumari 03 years R/o Jhundo Tola P/o Sono District Jamui Bihar A/P Dholiya, Bari-Brahmana has been missing from Bari-Brahmana and her missing report has been entered vide DDR No.10 dated 01.05.2026 of PS Bari-Brahmana. Her search was conducted but not traced out till date. Through the medium of this LOOK OUT NOTICE, it is informed to all the Police Establishments/General Public that any information related to the missing lady may be communicated on following contacts:

- PCR Samba :-01923-246333, 9541649001
- SSP Samba's email ID :- sspsamba@jkpolice.gov.in
- SHO PS Bari-Brahmana: 8713023636

The description roll along with photograph of missing lady is as under:-

Name:	Ful Kumari along with daughter Suhani Kumari 03 years
w/o	Bhola Kumar
Permanent Address:	R/o Jhundo Tola P/o Sono District Jamui Bihar A/P Dholiya, Bari-Brahmana
Age:	24 Years
Height:	5 Feet 04 Inch
Complexion:	Fair
Face:	Oval
Body Structure:	Thin
Languages known:	HINDI
Attire:	Salwar Kameez

No. CB/L.ook/2026/ Sr. Superintendent of Police, Samba

Dated: -.09.2026

DIP NO. DIP/J-10513/26 DATE 15.09.2026

JAMMU AND KASHMIR POLICE

DISTRICT POLICE HEADQUARTERS JAMMU

0191-2561578 (O), 0191-254780 (F), email-sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in

LOOK OUT NOTICE

SHO Police Station Bagh-e-Bahu, Jammu has intimated that one Reena Kumari W/O Late Ashok Kumar R/O House No. 21, New Colony, Bahu Fort, Jammu missing since 18.08.2026. Accordingly, her missing report was entered at Police Station Bagh-e-Bahu, Jammu vide DDR No.29 dated 07.09.2026. Despite thorough search her whereabouts are still unknown.

As such photograph of above named missing is being published for the information of Police establishments/public in general and if anybody having any clue related to his whereabouts /present location, kindly communicate the same on the below mentioned contact/Telephone numbers.

Description Roll :-

Name :	Reena Kumari
W/O :	Late Ashok Kumar
Address :	House No. 21, New Colony Bahu Fort, Jammu
Age :	39 years
Height :	05 feet
Face :	Round
Dress :	Red Salwar Kameez, & Chapel

Contacts/Telephone Numbers:-

- DPO, Jammu 0191-2547807, 0191-2561578
- SSP Jammu Mail L.D sspjammu@jkpolice.gov.in
- PCR Jammu 0191-2605949
- SP City South 0191-2433778
- SDPO City East 01912447400
- P/S Bagh-e-Bahu 0191-24559777

Sr. Superintendent of Police Jammu

DIP NO. DIP/J-10512/26 DATE 15.09.2026

"IMPORTANT"

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GOVERNMENT OF HARYANA TENDER NOTICE

SR NO	NAME OF DEPARTMENT	NAME OF WORK NOTICE TENDER	OPENING DATE CLOSING DATE	AMOUNT / EMD (APPROX.) IN RUPEES	WEBSITE OF THE DEPARTMENT	NODAL OFFICER/CONTACT DETAILS/EMAIL
1	PWD B&R, KARNAL	SPECIAL REPAIR JUDICIAL COURT IN DISTRICT KATHAL (PDG, ELECTRICAL APPLIANCES) + 2 WORKS	15.09.2026 21.09.2026	86.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0184225696 pwd-eeed-karnal@hry.nic.in
2	PWD B&R, HISAR	STG. OF 08 NOS. ROADS(1) GANGWA TO KAIMRI RD 3.300 TO 3.850 (10797) (2) MANGALI BYE PASS TO BISHNOT MANDIR ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.300 (5087) (3) APP. ROAD DAHA MANDIR ROAD 0.00 TO 0.220 (4780) (4)BURE HARIDAN CHOPAL ROAD RD 0.00 TO 0.500 (4781) (5) HISAR MANGALI SHARWA ROAD TO DHANI JATTAN ROAD 0.00 TO 0.650(5083) (6) MANGALI BHARA APP. ROAD 0.00 TO 0.320(5086) (7) MANGALI AKLAN TO MANGALI MOHBATPUR ROAD 0.00 TO 0.510(5084) (8)HARIATA SCHOOL APP. ROAD RD 0.00 TO 1.405(4778)(NALWA CONST. WP 2026-27(G.NO.2) + 1 WORKS	CLOSING DATE 24.09.2026	805.69 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9878384499 pwd-eeepd1-hissar@hry.nic.in
3	PWD B&R, KATHAL	CONSTRUCTION OF GOVT. VETERINARY HOSPITAL(GVH) IN RASINA, DISTT KATHAL	CLOSING DATE 21.09.2026	32.90 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9466390260 pwddeepd2kth@gmail.com
4	PWD B&R, AMBALA	SPECIAL REPAIR BY PROVIDING WDG. AND STG. FOR VARIOUS 13 NOS. LINK ROADS (I.E. ROAD ID 260, 261, 263, 264, 267, 268, 271, 276, 279, 287, 294, 9251 AND 10531) UNDER THE JURISDICTION OF PROVINCIAL DIVISION NO.2, PWD BANDR BR., AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTRICT (UNDER WORK PROGRAMME 2026-27) (MULLANA CONSTITUENCY) (GROUP-1) + 1 WORKS	12.09.2026 22.09.2026	833.89 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eeepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
5	PWD B&R, AMBALA	BALANCE WORK FOR CONSTRUCTION OF HOMEOPATHIC COLLEGE WITH INTAKE OF 100 STUDENTS AND 25 BEDDED HOSPITAL AT VILLAGE CHANDPURA AT AMBALA CANTT IN AMBALA DISTRICT (COLLEGE AND HOSPITAL BLOCK).	08.09.2026 29.09.2026	3160.74 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9417362462 pwd-eeepd2-ambala@hry.nic.in
6	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE :- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 23 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 23 ITEMS).	15.09.2026 21.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
7	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE :- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 30 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 30 ITEMS).	15.09.2026 21.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
8	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE :- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 04 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 04 ITEMS).	15.09.2026 21.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
9	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE - LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 87 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 87 ITEMS)	15.09.2026 21.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
10	DIRECTOR GENERAL, SUPPLIES & DISPOSALS PANCHKULA, HARYANA	DESCRIPTION OF STORE :- LIST COMPRISING OF ITEMS FROM SR. NO. 01 TO 629 ITEMS (SINGLE LOT OF 626 ITEMS)	15.09.2026 21.10.2026		https://etenders.hry.nic.in	0172-2570122 Supplies@hry.nic.in
11	PANCHAYATI RAJ, GANAUR	CONSTRUCTION OF KALA (BABA SAMADH) TO RAJBIR S/O SHRI PRITHI J AT VILLAGE BAJANA NALBA DIST GANAUR SONIPAT NAME OF SCHEME YATNGI	CLOSING DATE 21.09.2026	6.71 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	7015717521 sdoprganaur1@gmail.com
12	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADR	RECONSTRUCTION OF VR BRIDGE AT RD 24800, RD 97620 AND CONSTRUCTION OF VR BRIDGE AT RD 39800, TRASH RACK AT RD 45500 AND ADDITIONAL BAY AND REPAIR AND MAINTENANCE OF PUMP HOUSES OF BADIWANA DISTY	10.09.2026 24.09.2026	450.29 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	9992377270 xenilvdsdri@gmail.com
13	IRRIGATION & WATER RESOURCES DEPARTMENT HARYANA, CHARKHI DADR	CONSTRUCTION OF V.R. BRIDGE AT KM 0.600 OF SATNALI FEEDER, + 1 WORKS	14.09.2026 28.09.2026	199.30 LACS	https://etenders.hry.nic.in	8059375563 xenimgcdd11@gmail.com

FOR FURTHER INFORMATION KINDLY VISIT www.etenders.hry.nic.in No.49281/HRY

GORKHA RIFLES

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9420361 Late Rfn Diwakar Tamang of 3/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP VIJAY (Kargil) on 16 Sep 1999.

11 GORKHA RIFLES REGIMENTAL CENTRE

Indian Army and 11 Gorkha Rifles Salutes its brave heart, No 9418636 Late NK Dorjee Bahadur Tamang of 3/11 GR, who made supreme sacrifice during OP RAKSHAK on 16 Sep 1999.

Colonel 11 GR & Sikkim Scouts and All Ranks

BORDER SECURITY FORCE

	INSPECTOR SUBHASH CHAND MISHRA SHQ BSF BANDIPUR 25.07.1954 – 16.09.1993	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Subordinate officer Inspector Subhash Chand Mishra on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries during a counter terror Operation in area of Wazipura, Bandipur (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.
	CONSTABLE RAJESH KUMAR 11 BN BSF 03.04.1973 – 16.09.1999	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Rajesh Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal injuries in an IED blast triggered by militants in Bandipur area (J&K) and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty.
	CONSTABLE PARAMHANS YADAV PMG 54 BN BSF 01.07.1976 – 16.09.1996	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Paramhans Yadav on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, he sustained fatal bullet injuries while fighting with militants in area of Batpura, Kupwara (J&K). He put up a tough fight to militants and made ultimate sacrifice in the line of duty. His sacrifice and gallant action have been aptly recognized by GOI by awarding him with PPMG (Posthumously).
	CONSTABLE DEEPAK KUMAR 116 BN BSF 02.03.1992 – 16.09.2025	Director General and all Ranks of Border Security Force remember its gallant Jawan Constable Deepak Kumar on his Balidan Diwas. On this day, made ultimate sacrifice while on operational duty in Koraput, Odisha.

INDO-TIBETAN BORDER POLICE(ITBP)

Constable Deep Kumar

ITBP salutes its braveheart Constable Deep Kumar of 8th Battalion, who made the supreme sacrifice in the line of duty on this day in Jammu & Kashmir in 2000.

ARMY PUBLIC SCHOOL, SHANKAR VIHAR (NEAR MAHIPAL PUR) DELHI CANTT – 10

TELE NO – 011-26153558/9

EXPRESSION OF INTEREST (EOI)

EOI is solicited from professional agencies for providing House Keeping Services to Army Public School, Shankar Vihar. Only service providers with necessary Govt. Licenses need apply. Details for the above and EOI form are available at school counter against DD/POS machine/UPI of Rs 1000/-. Forms duly filled be submitted by 26 Sep 2026.

Chairman

HARYANA ELECTRICITY REGULATORY COMMISSION

Bays No. 33-36, Sector - 4, Panchkula-134109

Telephone No. 0172-2582531; Website: - <http://herc.org.in>

PUBLIC NOTICE

Inviting comments/objections from stakeholders/ general public on Petition under Section 43, 86(1) (i) & (k) of the Electricity Act, 2003 read with Regulations 3, 8, 9, 10 and 11 of the HERC (Duty to supply electricity on request, Power to recover expenditure incurred in providing supply and Power to require security) Regulations, 2016 and Regulation 4, 16 and 17 of HERC (Electricity Supply Code) Regulations, 2014 seeking issuance of Clarifications/ Directions/ Guidelines and/or suitable Amendments to be carried out in the said Regulations regarding the procedure for dealing with the application for electricity connections submitted by the occupants of flats constructed on a single floor, where such construction of multiple dwelling units on a single floor i.e. sub- division of floor, is in violation of the Haryana Building Code.

All general public/stakeholders are requested to submit their objections/ comments/ suggestions on the above-mentioned petition No. 28 of 2025 available on Commission website i.e.(<https://herc.org.in/>), to the Secretary, Haryana Electricity Regulatory Commission, Bays No. 33-36, Sector-4, Panchkula-134112 either in person or through post or e-mail at secretary.herc@nic.in. The last date of submission of objections/ comments/ suggestions is 30/09/2026 till 05:00 P.M. The public hearing will be held on 05/10/2026 at 11:30 AM in the court room of the Commission.

Sd/-
Secretary, HERC

No. 49289/HR

Government of Jammu & Kashmir (UT)

OFFICE OF THE EXECUTIVE ENGINEER

Machinery Division Kashmir, Mechanical & Hospital Engineering Department, Kashmir

[Fax No: 0194-2497093 | email - xenmds-kmr@jk.gov.in |

Corrigendum for Date Extension

S.No.	e-Nit no., Date and tender Id.	Extension No.	Description	Previous Dates	New Dates.
01	MDSK/TS/2025-26/10 Date:25-06-2025 132025_PWDJK_279744_3 232025_PWDJK_279744_4	27	Last date of downloading/ submission of bids Date of opening of bids online	14-09-2026 upto 06:55PM 15-09-2026 upto 2:00PM	05-10-2026 upto 06:55PM 06-10-2026 upto 2:00PM
02	MDSK/TS/2025-26/11 Date:27-06-2025 Tender Id :- 2025_PWDJK_279966_1)	30	Last date of downloading/ submission of bids Date of opening of bids online	14-09-2026 upto 06:55PM 15-09-2026 upto 2:00PM	05-10-2026 upto 06:55PM 06-10-2026 upto 2:00PM
03	MDSK/TS/2025-26/14 Date:02-07-2025 Tender Id :- 2025_PWDJK_280311_3)	26	Last date of downloading/ submission of bids Date of opening of bids online	14-09-2026 upto 06:55PM 15-09-2026 upto 2:00PM	05-10-2026 upto 06:55PM 06-10-2026 upto 2:00PM
04	MDSK/TS/2025-26/15 Date:02-07-2025 Tender Id :- 2025_PWDJK_280324_3)	30	Last date of downloading/ submission of bids Date of opening of bids online	14-09-2026 upto	

ASIAN GAMES | AICHI-NAGOYA | SEPTEMBER 19 TO OCTOBER 4

Protagonist, Paraphernalia & Podium: It takes three elements to complete sport. *The Indian Express* presents the stories about the personality, the equipment and the opponent who will bring the slash of strokes and dash of colour to the Asian Games

From understudy to regular: Bichu's journey under the posts

Having learnt from Savita, one of the best custodians, the Manipuri can be relied upon to guard the citadel as India strives for an automatic Olympic spot

Prithish Raj
New Delhi, September 15

AS BICHU Devi Kharibam stretched to her left for a last-gasp save against England in the Women's Hockey World Cup and kept India alive in the competition, veteran Savita Punia jumped like an excited kid in the dugout.

The reel went viral on social media platforms with many Indian fans discovering Bichu's shot-saving prowess for the first time. However, according to Savita, this was just one of the many big moments Bichu is likely to enjoy in her career.

"She has been my understudy for three years and I can tell you she is one of the best goalkeepers around," Savita told *The Indian Express*. "Whenever we are playing, Bichu pushes me to the limit and I try to do the same. Our bond off the field helps us get better on it knowing that we have got each other's back."

Talking about that viral moment that took India to the second round of the World Cup, Bichu said, "The communication between me and Savitadi is like telepathy. As it was the last quarter, I was nervous and constantly looking at her. She asked me to calm down with her hand gestures. Once that assurance came, I just did what I had to do."

Savita, the 36-year-old goalkeeper from Haryana who is in the autumn of her career, can speak for hours about her bond with the 25-year-old Manipuri, who can duly return the favour.

Timely upgrades

If someone had asked a younger Bichu where she wants to be in 2026, she would have happily said it was the Indian women's football team. But as fate would have it, there were no vacancies by the time she made it to a local training academy. After crying her eyes out, she took her father's suggestion and picked up hockey.

Bichu's career has gone through several phases, and she has had to update herself regularly to get to where she is right now. Bichu started as a forward before P Nilakomol Singh, the understudy to goalkeeper Romeo James at the 1984 Olympics and one of the earliest Manipuri Olympians, asked her to switch roles after looking at her frame.

"I barely knew anything

about hockey. When I switched, I was a striker but Nilakomol sir asked me to become a goalkeeper. I had no idea what I would do," Bichu recalls.

In 2015, Bichu shifted to the Madhya Pradesh Hockey Academy to take her game to the next level. While she honed her goalkeeping skills, she also had to brush up on her Hindi.

"Trust me, learning Hindi seemed more difficult than goalkeeping at that time. But it was needed for me to understand the coaches better and communicate with my teammates. I learnt Hindi by watching TV news channels," said Bichu.

However, all the minutes spent in front of the TV and the hours spent under the goalpost paid off when she made her senior India debut in 2022. But she was largely an understudy to Savita, one of the best goalkeepers in the world.

Aggressive to patient

Bichu has had a lot of waiting to do in her career.

Be it her transition from the juniors after the Youth Olympics medal in 2018 or the time it took for her to be a regular in the senior team. But the wait has shaped her personality to the point that she faces the best in the world without flinching.

Any goalkeeper has to be patient. There is nothing a goalkeeper can do apart from waiting for the ball to arrive. I have played games where the ball didn't even come into my circle. So those kinds of matches teach you patience and also keep you alert," explained Bichu.

However, she was not always this patient. When Bichu started in the sport, she was an aggressive player. "It can be both good and bad but I had a lot of aggression in my early days," she recalls. Savita and former coach Janneke

would make a huge difference towards the mental aspect. It would give me more confidence and belief that I can have a good match and beat some of the top players," Anahat told *The Indian Express* earlier this year.

Gold Standard
Ranked ahead of Anahat are Malaysia's Sivasangari Subramaniam (WR 5) and Japan's Satomi Watanabe (WR 6), but there are others in a deep field who have the ability to hurt the Indian's chances. Aira Azman from Malaysia and Sin Yuk Chan from Hong Kong will both be in the reckoning once the squash events begin at the Nagoya Kinjo-Futo Arena from September 23 onwards.

But it's the threat of Sivasangari and Watanabe that Anahat will be looking at particularly closely. She has suffered losses to both this year,

Bichu Devi Factfile

AGE: 25
POSITION: Goalkeeper
SENIOR DEBUT: 2022 in FIH Pro League

HONOURS
2018
YOUTH OLYMPICS SILVER MEDALLIST

2022 & 2025
FIH NATIONS CUP TITLE

2023, 2024
ASIAN CHAMPIONS TROPHY WINNER

2023
BRONZE AT ASIAN GAMES

Schopman played an important role in shaping the patient version of Bichu. "Although calmness comes with experience, *Savitadi* helped a lot. Whenever she would come back after a game, I used to ask her many questions," said Bichu.

"I would want to know what she was thinking at a certain moment or how she dealt with a counter-attack or what was going inside her head during a penalty corner. All these learn-

ings helped me massively as I got first-hand experience without entering the field," she added.

To curb her aggression and get more patient, Schopman asked Bichu to read self-help books. "I used to read books like *'30 Days, 30 Challenges'* and perform the challenges mentioned in it to keep myself calm. All of it helped." When current coach Sjoerd Marjine was asked about Bichu, all he said was "Rock Solid".

And that's the ideal way to sum up her performance at the World Cup where the Indian women's team registered a historic fifth-place finish ahead of the likes of Germany, China and England.

As the Indian team flies to Japan for the Asian Games and a shot at Olympic qualification, Bichu's patience, shot-saving ability and strong mindset will be central to its prospects.

Any goalkeeper has to be patient. There is nothing a goalkeeper can do apart from waiting for the ball to arrive. I have played games where the ball didn't come into my circle. So those kinds of matches teach you patience and also keep you alert.

BICHU DEVI, ON BEING PATIENT

Learning Hindi seemed more difficult than goalkeeping. But it was needed for me to understand the coaches better and communicate with my teammates. I learnt Hindi by watching TV news channels

ON HER STRUGGLES WITH HINDI

SPORT LAB

Why tuning a bow is the most important aspect of compound archery

Nitin Sharma
Chandigarh, September 15

A COMPOUND archery bow has its own snappy elastic limbs.

They make it easier for the archer than a more complex Recurve bow. Simultaneously, this factor has kept Compound Archery away out of the Olympics until its inclusion for Los Angeles. Because the bow was considered too simplistic, and far too enabling to test absolute string-drawing and precision-aiming skill. It was being too helpful. But with its inclusion as a mixed-team event, the focus is on what sets apart the top archers in Compound, from the rest in an event that still makes demands on tiny detailing.

The force required to draw a Recurve bow using fingers is almost always in excess of 60 pounds. The compound bow has inbuilt mechanised pulleys so the maximum draw weight, has a ceiling of 60 pounds. This holding weight required at full draw is 60-75% percent less than Recurve. Compound archers aim with far less strain.

The bow design, which sees use of a levering system of pulleys and cables, thence relies more on its own stretched limbs than the archer's massive shoulder/back power.

The arrows are clipped on the bow string against a nocking point. A short loop is connected to the release strings sitting on top of the arrow rest — which was added only in 1995. The arrow sits in this loop, and the archer doesn't need to adjust it on the string manually. It's like a gun resting on a tripod, not needing to be adjusted and ready to fire.

Coach and Olympian Sanjeeva Singh who brought Compound bows to India in 2003, says the wheeled bow is all about tuning, draw lengths and archer position. "The position of peep sight changes based on draw length, bido and head positions

Compound vs Recurve

● The Compound bow uses a system of pulleys and cables making shooting faster and more accurate than a Recurve bow.

● The bow was invented in the USA in the 1960s, as a mechanically efficient equipment than Recurve.

● Tuning involves adjusting of the arrowhead as well as the

spine of the arrows, which are stiffer as compared to Recurve arrows.

● While the archer's fingers do not touch the arrow, the bow also uses a vibration-reducing stabiliser along with dampers to lend more balance to the action — making it much simpler than the back-breaking precision needed in Recurve.

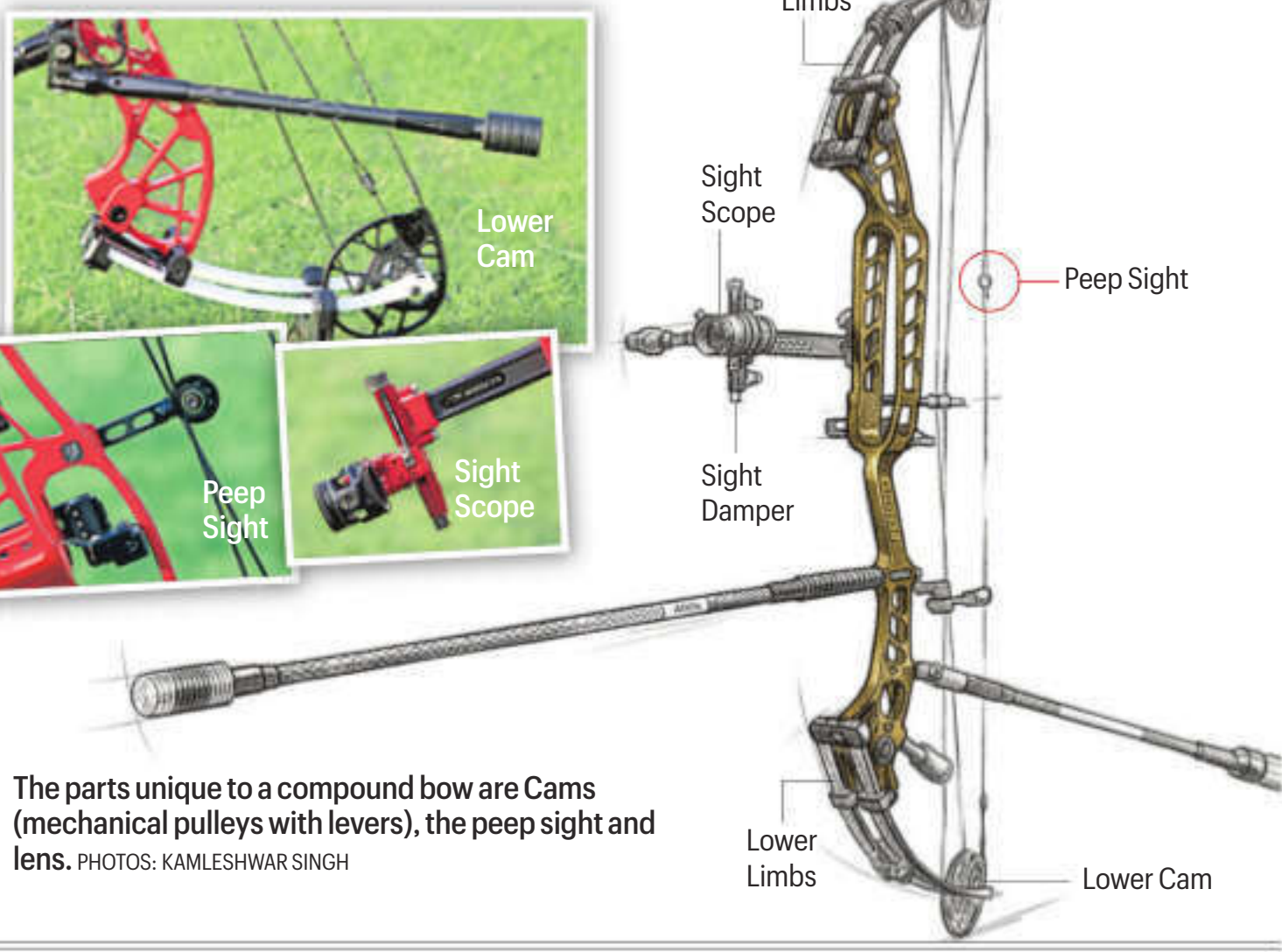
of archer, as the stiffness of the (bow) limbs. The draw length and position changes due to the mechanical release. It took me a year to learn and our efforts paid off when Paltan Hansda won the junior world title in 2006," adds Singh. Worlds silver medallist Jyothi Surekha Vennam, who

The compound bow has inbuilt mechanised pulleys so the maximum draw weight has a ceiling of 60 pounds. This holding weight required at full draw is 60-75% percent less than Recurve.

won three gold medals in last Asian Games, uses a bow with a draw length of 27.5 inches while her Asian games team-mate Prithika Pradeep's draw length is 25 inches. Vennam has a poundage of 55 pounds before the mechanical stop triggers the release aid.

"While mechanical cams are the same, we have to adjust the bow limbs as per the poundage. The draw length once set, does not change and the string will stop at the set length. Then we also have to adjust the long stabiliser as well as the short Vibra-

COMPLEX MECHANISM



PATH TO GOLD

Young Anahat, in her second Asiad campaign, ready to target elite tour opponents

After winning the Jr Worlds recently, the 18-year-old Indian squash player has now launched herself into podium territory

Shashank Nair
New Delhi, September 15

ANAHAT SINGH was merely 14 years old when she became the youngest Indian to be part of a multi-sport contingent, heading to the Commonwealth Games in 2022. Four years later, ranked 20th in the world, the 18-year-old squash player heads to the Asian Games in Aichi-Nagoya, with a handful of wins over Top 20 opponents. Winning an individual gold at the Asian Games automatically qualifies her for the 2028 LA Olympics, the goal that she and her camp had set out to achieve when the sport was announced as a part of the upcoming Games.

The ascent has been rapid,

but her path to the podium could depend on how quickly her physical development catches up with her precocious talent.

By rankings, the Indian is third in Asia. But in a tournament where matches come thick and fast, there are still elements of her game that need developing.

After winning the Jr World Championships recently, Anahat spoke to this paper about how physicality was an aspect she was working on and that adding muscle mass could unlock the next version of her game.

"My coaches say I'm good at the fancy stuff but maintaining a level and being strong and consistent throughout the tournament... I think that

would make a huge difference towards the mental aspect. It would give me more confidence and belief that I can have a good match and beat some of the top players," Anahat told *The Indian Express* earlier this year.

Gold Standard

Ranked ahead of Anahat are Malaysia's Sivasangari Subramaniam (WR 5) and Japan's Satomi Watanabe (WR 6), but there are others in a deep field who have the ability to hurt the Indian's chances. Aira Azman from Malaysia and Sin Yuk Chan from Hong Kong will both be in the reckoning once the squash events begin at the Nagoya Kinjo-Futo Arena from September 23 onwards.



Ranked third in Asia, 18-year-old Anahat Singh is a medal hope at the Asian Games. WORLD SQUASH

But it's the threat of Sivasangari and Watanabe that Anahat will be looking at particularly closely. She has suffered losses to both this year,

with Sivasangari dispatching the Indian in three games in a 17-minute drubbing in the London Classic quarterfinals.

Sivasangari trained closely

with former Malaysian world champion Nicol David in her formative years and battled adversity when she was almost out of the sport after an acci-

dent in Kuala Lumpur. Now ranked fifth in the world, the Malaysian is the strongest challenge to Anahat's path to gold.

Watanabe, on the other hand, may have beaten the Indian, but Anahat's stock rose in the loss. Watanabe moved to Malaysia from Japan all alone at the age of 12, when she realised that there was a lack of sparring partners in her home country. Anahat, freshly transitioning from the juniors to the seniors circuit, took the Japanese trailblazer — the highest-ever ranked women's player from her country — to five games.

The top-ranked Indian, for her part, has made a convincing start to her nascent senior career. She beat Hana Moataz on the way to winning the JSW Indian Open and then took down World No. 9 Gina Kennedy in the Squash on Fire Open final — two wins that have

shown just how much of a problem she is becoming for higher-ranked players.

Even in certain losses — she took a game off Hania El Hammam at the El Gouna International — Anahat showed that she had a foundation that could be built upon and levelled up. What has been missing, though, is the experience and know-how of playing against players consistently ranked in the Top 30, something that will only come with time at the senior level.

At the Asian Games, her seeding has ensured a direct start from the Round of 16. The quarterfinals could see her go up against compatriot Tanvi Khanna, and a win there would lead to a potential semi-final against Watanabe, who is on Anahat's side of the draw. Victory in the semis and a possible final against defending champion Sivasangari await.

Indian team left without rooms for hours in Samarkand

Mayank Chaudhary & Amit Kamath
New Delhi/Mumbai, September 15

THE INDIAN team for the 46th Chess Olympiad was hit by a serious accommodation crisis, with several players left without hotel rooms for a long time after their arrival in Samarkand.

The two captains for the Indian teams, Srinath Narayanan and Swayams Mishra, confirmed that many of the players waited for hours to be given individual rooms at the 'Silk Road by Minyoun' hotel.

"We were told that the hotel was overbooked and the reservation wasn't sent by the local organising committee to the hotel," Srinath told *The Indian Express* from Samarkand.

Laying out a timeline of how things unfolded, the Indian women's team captain Mishra told this paper that the contingent arrived in Samarkand at 9.30 am and reached the hotel in an hour. One room was allotted around 12.30 pm and another half an hour later.

Since only two rooms had been made available for the entire Indian contingent initially, all the members of the open team — including world champion D Gukesh and R Praggnanandhaa — were sent to one of them to get refreshed and some rest while the women players and the mothers of Pragg and Vantika Agrawal took the other room. The six coaches, meanwhile, waited for the hotel staff to make more rooms available.

According to the coaches, the Indian contingent was supposed to get about 16 rooms, and had been given 14 by late evening. "All players now have their individual rooms, some did not get the preferred rooms they had mentioned to the organisers. But the support staff will be adjusting for a couple of days," Mishra added while pointing out that three coaches were bunking together in a room for the time being.



Captain Srinath Narayanan took to social media to express his frustration. **FIDE**

Samson 'shuts out the noise' to keep negative comments away

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 15

"MAIN WIFI off kar deta hu (I switch the WiFi off)," quips Sanju Samson, on being asked how he reacts to negative comments. This was not the first instance of the Indian wicket-keeper-batter's wit sparking a wave of laughter during a press conference. It was also not the first instance of Samson justifying his selection in the Indian team — battling waves of criticism in the process.

That he effectively took India to a successful defence of the T20 World Cup crown earlier this year — with match-winning knocks in the quarter-final, semi-final and final — was reduced to little consequence when he accumulated merely 43 runs in his last five T20Is. Yet, upon being re-integrated into the team for the three-match T20I series against Afghanistan, Samson showcased his value with a 22-ball 57.

Candid, as he almost always is, he responded to a query on the recent challenges by saying "I think after a few failures, you definitely go through a lot. Being an India cricketer, it's not easy to face failures, but that's where my experience comes in. I try to shut out the noise and be confident. I come out and still keep scoring at a high strike rate — even taking chances, knowing that if I fail again, I'll be facing a lot of noise again. But that's the way we are built in Indian cricket, and I just go out

India, last time's hunters, turn hunted

From the previous Chess Olympiad to now, the performances of Indian players have dipped, barring Pragg, but that's also because opponents sat up and took notice

Mayank Chaudhary
New Delhi, September 15

INDIAN CHESS is about to enter one of the most defining stretches in its history. The time has come for this generation to prove that its golden run is more than just a moment. Over the next few months, D Gukesh will defend his world title, R Vaishali will chase India's first women's world crown, and both national teams will fight to retain their Olympiad gold. It all begins on Wednesday, in the ancient and picturesque Uzbek city of Samarkand, at the 46th Chess Olympiad.

For a side that boasts the reigning world champion, the winner of the two most competitive tournaments in the Grand Chess Tour and Norway Chess, R Praggnanandhaa, a player who reached 2800 in Arjun Erigaisi, a Candidates participant in Vidit Gujrathi, and short-format specialist in Nihal Sarin, it might sound like overkill. But this time, the path will not be smooth for the Indian men's team.

India, seeded second in the event, must defend their gold in a country that is just as passionate about chess and just as strong on the board. Uzbekistan has Javokhir Sindarov, the reigning World Cup and Candidates winner, who will challenge Gukesh for the world title. They also have Nodirbek Abdusattorov, a player who has troubled Gukesh on numerous occasions.

From 2024 to now, the performances of Indian men's players have certainly dipped, barring Praggnanandhaa, who peaked in classical chess with his Grand Chess Tour & Norway titles. For Gukesh, Arjun Erigaisi, and Nihal Sarin, a title in a big-ticket event has remained elusive.

Does this mean Indian men's chess is on a decline? Five-time World Champion Viswanathan Anand has a pragmatic way of looking at things. "Fundamentally, yes. Anybody not familiar with chess will look at 2026 and 2024 and leap to conclusions. At that point, we seemed unstoppable in Budapest. But Toronto was a very good sign. Singapore was a very good sign. And we have three players on the men's side

“After 2024, people started taking them seriously. ‘Okay, I have to block two days for Arjun. I have to take a couple of days off for Pragg and make sure I’m well prepared against him.’ VISWANATHAN ANAND, ON INDIAN PLAYERS



The FIDE Chess Olympiad gets underway on Wednesday in the ancient Uzbek city of Samarkand. **FIDE**

doing very well. You can always count on at least one of them," Anand said.

"But it's in the nature of things that others react. After 2024, people started taking them seriously. 'Okay, I have to block two days for Arjun. I have to take a couple of days off for Pragg and make sure I'm well prepared against him.' That effect comes in. It's very hard to maintain such a streak for very long."

Anand remains optimistic about India's chances in Samarkand, while acknowledging the strength of teams like Uzbekistan and the top-seeded USA. "There's nothing saying they won't win Samarkand either. But there are other very good teams. The Uzbeks have jumped a lot since 2024. The Turks are there. The Americans and the Chinese also have very good teams. So there will be others," he said.

Assembling a team

With Praggnanandhaa occupied with GCT, Gukesh busy with his World Championship preparation against Sindarov, and other top Indian players tied up with their schedules, it was a difficult task for captain Srinath Narayanan to assemble everyone.

But Srinath managed it by going virtual, holding a five-day preparatory online camp to set the tone for the event.

"The camp was great. Getting those five players together

Quick facts

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Teams in the Open section and 192 teams in the Women's event.

India are defending champions in both sections after winning the Hamilton-Russell Cup for the open section, the Vera Menchik Cup for the women's section and the Nona Gaprindashvili Trophy for the overall title at Budapest 2024, the previous Chess Olympiad.

in today's intensely busy schedule was quite an achievement. But we managed to achieve it by having it online," Srinath told *The Indian Express*. Srinath, the coach and non-playing captain who led India to the historic gold in Budapest, says the team is in high spirits and right where they were in Hungary two years ago.

"The players were also very enthusiastic about joining the training sessions, spending time together. Pragg came in right after the Sinquefeld Cup. Gukesh came in the midst of his World Championship preparation," he said.

"All these things bode very positively for the team. And the team is also having a lot of fun with each other, even outside of chess, informally.

Which is again a very positive thing. So, in terms of team spirit, we are right where we left in Budapest."

The big question

The biggest question Srinath must answer, with help from Sankalp Gupta and Vaibhav Suri, is the board order. In 2024, Srinath's punt of playing Arjun Erigaisi on board three, despite him being the highest-rated Indian player, worked wonders. With Gukesh on top board, Praggnanandhaa on second, and Arjun on third, India demolished their opponents.

This time, with Gukesh's form a concern, will India still field him on the top board? Playing on board one is not just a matter of prestige. It means facing every opposition nation's top player at the Olympiad.

Srinath is in no mood to reveal the board order. "We have discussed it internally. But everyone will know on the last day. As long as we have the deadline, we'd like to keep the flexibility. None of the teams have revealed their board order. So, we don't see why we have to do it either," he said. "I have been thinking about it and following the players and events closely for about three to four months now. I have also spoken to all players. I understood what their comforts are. We have taken into account all these different things."

'Women's team stronger than when they won in 2024'

Amit Kamath
Mumbai, September 15

OVER THE last month or so, one of the hardest things Swayams Mishra has had to do is to find a window to bring the entire Indian women's team together for a training camp. The upcoming Chess Olympiad will see the women's team defend gold and it was a measure of how much these players have grown in stature and ambition that they play relentless chess around the year. But it made Mishra's job of finding a slot where all five of his players were available at the same time tricky.

Divya Deshmukh, Vaishali Rameshbabu and Koneru Humpy were in the USA for the Cairns Cup. Then, Deshmukh and Humpy were at the Global Chess League in Bengaluru. Vaishali was in long training camps of her own to prepare for her maiden challenge for the Women's World Championship crown. The final two players of the team, Vantika Agrawal and Savitha Shri, were competing in tournaments in Europe.

Eventually, Mishra found a five-day window to conduct an online camp where the players logged in from different parts of the world. The mood in the camp was light. Some decisions were made about the board order of the team, where India had three contenders to play on board 1 in the form of Humpy, Deshmukh and Vaishali. They also indulged in friendly games of Kahoot, an online game, by tweaking it and giving it a *chess ka tadka*.

The one conversation, Mishra says, that never came up was the impending gold medal defence.

"We never discussed things like *gold medal jeetna hai, defend karna hai*. Of course our target is to win gold. It's clear in everyone's mind. I don't think speaking about it would help the players personally," says Mishra, who will have the support of grandmasters Arjun Kalyan and Diptayan Ghosh as a three-member coaching staff.

Mishra says that challenging India's spot on the top step of the podium will be nations like Georgia, Kazakhstan, and the USA. Poland and Azerbai-



Vaishali Rameshbabu (L) and Divya Deshmukh now have their own coaches and seconds, which was not the case in 2022. **FIDE**



jan are also tricky opponents, he added.

Another perception that Mishra debunked is that one of two players of the team are given instructions to churn out draws while the others are given free reign to go for the kill.

"All these players are so strong that they can win against anyone. So we don't tell players about what results they should look for. But based on openings, and how comfortable we are against an opponent and the playing style of the player, we take some calls about what openings to play," he added.

The conversation, coach Swayams Mishra says, that never came up was the impending gold medal defence

Mishra has been with the Olympiad team for three cycles now and he says it's not just the players' ratings and their tournament workload, but even their way of preparation that has changed now.

He explains that in 2022, players like Deshmukh and Vaishali were still young and were not playing at top-tier invitational events, so they did not have full-time coaches and seconds working for them. So the team's coaches had much more on their plate in terms of making opening files for them to play across the 11 rounds. But now, most of the players have their

own coaches and seconds to help them with that.

"The way most of our team prepares is much different to how they used to prepare in 2022. Even players like Vantika and Savita. There is a significant improvement and they have developed in their preparation and overall playing strength as well," he said.

Mishra says that for most of the coaches, the workload at the Olympiad is slightly more relaxed in the first half of the 11-round event, but rises significantly when the second half begins because the competition gets tougher and players want to try newer moves on the board.

He recollected an occasion at the previous Olympiad when a player told him she wanted to try something completely out of the book against an opponent, because her preferred openings would be too predictable and had been played previously in the tournament.

"When it comes to the important games some players want to play something completely new, so the amount of work to be put in becomes more. So there was one night that I slept at 6 AM and then I had to wake up at 8 to explain that opening to the player who wanted to try something new. Then I waited for the game to start to see how the players played that opening. And once the game entered the middle game phase, I slept for sometime, before again waking up for the endgame to see how it was finishing," says Mishra.

AFGHANISTAN VS INDIA, 2ND T20I

No surprises between friends in Friendship Series

Shuvaditya Bose
New Delhi, September 15

THE FIRST over set the tone for the remaining 33.5.

A sharp outswinger resulted in the swing of the bat meeting nothing but air. An inswinger very nearly kissed the inside edge. A yorker only toe-ended to safety.

Six deliveries, six illusions from a magician with the ball. The first over that Jasprit Bumrah bowled on Tuesday — that set the stage for India's seven-wicket win that sealed the three-match T20 series against Afghanistan — didn't yield a wicket. And yet, in that over of near-misses, he showed once again how he regularly makes batsmen look like novices.

Bumrah, for the first time in his career, opened the bowling for India with a maiden over — on the cusp of becoming only the sixth Indian to reach a hundred T20I caps. It came in a series stripped of any intensity or animosity, but coming on his return from a knee injury, had significance of his own.

However, Tuesday's triumph was less about individualism and more about collectivism. Bumrah's mastery with the new ball was matched — or perhaps, even eclipsed — by Arshdeep Singh, who lived up to his status as India's leading T20I wicket-taker. In his first over, he removed opener Rahmanullah Gurbaz.

That was the only wicket in the first eight overs. Ibrahim Zadran did what any captain worth his salt is meant to when the chips are down — shoulder



Sanju Samson scored 57 runs off just 22 balls to power India's chase of a 160-run target. **PRAVEEN KHANNA**

the burden, crafting a defiant 37 off 33 balls before holing out to deep midwicket off Nitish Kumar Reddy.

The all-rounder could be considered one of India's biggest tick marks on the night.

The last time Reddy took a wicket in T20I cricket, captain Shreyas Iyer could not find a place in the team, shirts with 'Sooryavanshi' on the back were yet to be printed, and Gautam Gambhir was yet to win an ICC trophy as India's head coach. With injury proving to be an increasingly familiar companion for Hardik Pandya, even a flicker of dependability from a seam-bowling all-rounder would have been a gift

to India in this series.

Yet, with 30 runs off two overs, Reddy's performance did not offer any optimism on Sunday. Tuesday's numbers of 3-0-24-3 — his best figures in international cricket across formats — was a much better return. Nearly every bowler did his job, the sole blemish being Shivam Dube's lone over of 13. Beyond the bowling itself, Iyer deserved credit too for the shrewdness of his resource management.

Optimum utilisation

At 43/5 a couple of nights ago, Iyer perhaps got carried away to overuse his main wicket-takers earlier than

usual. It resulted in three of the last seven overs having to be bowled by non-regulars, of which 46 runs were scored. This time, both Arshdeep and Bumrah were held back after their opening burst.

Afghanistan, on a deck that had no demons but for the psychological ones posed by the Indian bowlers, could only score 159/8.

Over the next hour or so, Sanju Samson would showcase an accurate portrayal of his capability — one that was on display at the T20 World Cup. Following the three near-centuries which earned India their second crown in this format, Samson had aggregated just 33 in his

next four T20Is, leading to his exclusion from the squad for the series against Zimbabwe in July.

Tuesday's 22-ball 57 was his seventh half-century in this format, but would rank much higher in terms of significance once the layer of context is added — he now has stern competition for his role in the form of a 15-year-old. His batting approach made it evident. As many as 91.23% of Samson's runs came in boundaries alone, and his strike rate — 259.09 — was his highest-ever in a knock of more than 25.

As with the bowling, India's batting was a concerted effort. In Samson's shadow was Sunday's protagonist, Abhishek Sharma, who scored a 19-ball 39. The Powerplay yielded 82 runs — anything that happened post that period was academic in nature.

In that exercise, should the microcosmic facets of the game be reflected upon, Shreyas Iyer lost his wicket to a Rashid Khan delivery for a run-a-ball 11, his sixth consecutive T20I knock where he could not get to 30. Ishan Kishan remained unbeaten for a 23-ball 38, as India chased the target down with 31 deliveries to spare.

In the series of friendship, Afghanistan have yet to face anything but hardship. And they still have another 40 overs of this to deal with.

BRIEF SCORES: Afghanistan 159/8 in 20 overs (Ibrahim Zadran 37; Nitish Kumar Reddy 3/24) lost to India 163/3 in 14.5 overs (Sanju Samson 57; Rashid Khan 3/35) by seven wickets.

Hockey India factions should resolve mess: Sports ministry

Express News Service
New Delhi, September 15

THE FIGHTING between two factions of Hockey India (HI) has caught the sports ministry's eye. The ministry will wait for the warring factions to resolve their differences before thinking of an intervention.

The two factions, led by HI president Dilip Tirkey and secretary general Bholanath Singh, have been locked in an impasse ever since the body was criticised for changing the national teams' jersey colour from blue to saffron before the recent World Cup.

Tirkey has maintained that he was not consulted before the decision. On Saturday, he stripped director general RK Srivastava of all his powers citing a trip to the World Cup last month, the selection of a saffron jersey, a lack of disciplinary action over players' misconduct on the South Africa tour last December, and the "unavailability" of ICC/POSH records in a case involving a federation staffer.

Meanwhile, Bholanath has called an Emergent Board Meeting on September 18 to discuss the current situation.

One of the sources in the ministry said that they need to resolve it among themselves. "Whether ministry intervention is needed would be decided once it is clear that the situation is not getting resolved," the source said.